WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 23, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 22 PAGES

₹7.00 (₹8 RAIPUR, ₹15 SRINAGAR) • www.indianexpress.com

DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

SPIRIT OF VICTORY

Radico
SPIRIT OF EXCELLENCE

1965 IS MORE THAN A CHAPTER IN HISTORY.

IT'S THE FOUNDATION OF INDIA'S SPIRIT OF VICTORY.

In 1965 Indo-Pak War, the courage of the Indian Armed Forces gave India more than a historic victory. It gave a nation the confidence to dream bigger, stand stronger, and march further.

This Vijay Diwas, we salute their unmatched bravery with pride and gratitude.

INDO-PAK WAR

HONOURING THE MARTYRS & WAR WIDOWS AND THANKING ALL OUR SOLDIERS FOR ALWAYS SAFEGUARDING US & OUR MOTHERLAND

SCAN TO WATCH
1965 WAR CHRONICLES
Stories of Courage. Stories of Victory.

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

The World

WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 23, 2026

WHILE OTHERS HAVE SPOKEN OF PEACE, I HAVE MADE PEACE, SAYS PRESIDENT

In UN address, Trump says he faces a choice to make a deal or annihilate Iran

US President urges nations to enforce complete economic isolation of Tehran, expects deal after the midterm elections

Reuters
New York, September 22

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump used his UN General Assembly speech on Tuesday to make the case for his war on Iran, arguing he has prevented Tehran from obtaining a nuclear weapon and warning he could "annihilate the Islamic Republic" if no deal is reached to end the conflict.

While predicting his administration would strike a peace deal with Iran following the November 3 US midterm elections, Trump called on other nations to join America in isolating Iran economically to force it to the negotiating table. "I call on all nations to help to enforce the complete economic isolation of Iran," he said.

"I have a big decision to make. Will a deal be made with Iran that lets them rebuild and create a far greater country than it ever was before?" Trump said. "Or do I annihilate the Islamic Republic and do it quickly, never giving them a chance to kill and destroy people and countries again?" Trump added: "Do I drive them into hell with no chance of survival and no hope of future greatness or generations? But I believe we'll make a deal right after the election."

Since returning to office last year for a second term, Trump has waves through global order, joining Israel to attack Iran, ordering a raid on Venezuela that captured country's leader, and threatening to seize Greenland.

In a 37-minute speech, Trump laid out his foreign policy vision, contending war with Iran would spare world threat of a nuclear-armed menace while maintaining US military dominance in the Western Hemisphere was essential to preventing crises from taking root.

"Our actions in Venezuela are proof that the United States will no longer permit threats to America to gain a foothold anywhere in the Western Hemisphere," Trump said. "While others have spoken of peace, I have made peace."

Trump brushed aside suggestions the midterm elections, in which his Republican Party risks losing control of Congress, could constrain his handling of the war. Some analysts have argued that a Democratic takeover of the legislature would weaken his leverage in the conflict.

"What they don't realize is that I'm not running," Trump said, referring to the leadership in Tehran. "I did that already, and won in a landslide. We won in a giant landslide, and I'll be here for 2-1/2 years."

Ahead of a UN Security Council meeting on AI and international security on Wednesday, Trump acknowledged the challenges of the new technology but said "I'm not going to stifle growth of something that will be bigger than Industrial Revolution."

The speech kicked off a day of high-level diplomacy at the United Nations, where Trump was due to meet more than a dozen world leaders as wars in West Asia and Ukraine continue to test his foreign policy agenda.

After his speech, Trump was scheduled to meet with no fewer than 11 world leaders, including British PM Andy Burnham, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, Venezuela's interim leader Delcy Rodriguez, and the representatives of the Gulf states of the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Oman, Bahrain, Kuwait and Qatar.

US President Donald Trump speaks during the 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly at the UN headquarters in New York on Tuesday. AP

> **"I have a big decision to make. Will a deal be made with Iran that lets them rebuild and create a far greater country than it ever was before. Or do I annihilate the Islamic Republic and do it quickly, never giving them a chance to kill and destroy people and countries again"**
>
> **DONALD TRUMP,**
> PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES

Iran hints at Hormuz dialogue with US as Houthis advance in Bab el-Mandeb strait

Reuters
Dubai, September 22

A SENIOR Iranian official said Tuesday Iran could reopen the Strait of Hormuz to Gulf shipping within days if the United States lifts its blockade, describing the UN General Assembly as a "golden opportunity" to revive diplomacy with Washington.

US President Donald Trump and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian will attend UN General Assembly in New York, their first shared event since Trump launched "Operation Epic Fury" against Iran in February.

The Iranian official said Iran's delegation had full authority to revive potential talks, although no direct meeting between the two presidents was planned. No direct Iran-US meeting is known since July, when an interim agreement to end the war collapsed weeks after Trump and Pezeshkian signed it.

"The US needs to announce that it wants to resolve the issue diplomatically, make that official, and then agree on a timeline for how the process will move forward," the Iranian official said, adding Iran had sent its proposal to Washington through mediators on September 16.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio told NBC's *Today* show that the US was open to speaking with Iran at the General Assembly, "especially if it has the prospects of leading to something positive" and ultimately achieving the goals of the war.

Gulf countries are keen to restore shipping through the Strait but wary of giving Iran, their rival, too much influence.

Saudi Arabia has been drawn deeper into the conflict this month, with Iran-aligned Houthi fighters advancing in Yemen, routing forces of a Saudi-backed government and threatening Saudi oil exports through the Red Sea. The Houthis aim to control Bab el-Mandeb Strait, the southern entrance to the Red Sea, and have attacked Saudi Arabia with missiles and drones.

A Qatari proposal for a framework bringing Iran and the Arab Gulf states into a common security architecture is also on the agenda for Gulf leaders' meeting with Trump, regional sources said.

Qatari Prime Minister Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani said: "Lasting security cannot be built through repeated cycles of escalations and retaliation, or arrangements that leave any state permanently exposed to insecurity."

Turkey's Erdogan urges UN reform, wider recognition of Palestinian state

Reuters
New York, September 22

TURKISH PRESIDENT Tayyip Erdogan told the United Nations General Assembly Tuesday the UN had become unable to fulfill its duty of preserving peace and called for reform of the Security Council.

"Let's recognise that a system in which the will of more than 190 countries is subject to the whims of five countries is neither fair nor capable of fully establishing trust," he said.

"The United Nations, established 81 years ago to maintain peace and security, has become unable to fulfil this mission, or rather it has been made unable to do so," he added.

Erdogan also condemned the situation in Gaza, saying "no one who holds humanity, compassion and mercy in their heart, with a sense of justice and conscience can turn a blind eye" to what was happening there.

"(Palestinian President) Mahmoud Abbas, has been unable to take his place in this hall for two consecutive years. This injustice against our Palestinian brothers and sisters wounds the consciences, Erdogan said.

He urged countries that do not recognise a Palestinian state to review their position and for all nations to increase pressure on Israel to end the war in Gaza, which he called "our time's most inhumane, most embarrassing concentration camp".

In his final UN speech, Guterres calls for a 'world built on interdependence'

Associated Press
United Nations, September 22

UN SECRETARY-General Antonio Guterres pleaded for "a world built on interdependence" as he made his final address Tuesday to the General Assembly gathering of world leaders.

The UN leader has long implored leaders not to give up on cooperation and shared decision-making in the face of accelerating global challenges and increasing great powers competition. Tuesday's message took on additional urgency because he leaves office at the end of this year.

"The fault lines in our world are widening," he said, citing raging wars, rising temperatures and artificial intelligence, among other matters. Instead of letting the future continue to veer toward fragmentation, transactionalism and mistrust, he called for "a world built on interdependence" and sustained by a dense web of economic, political, social and technological connections.

Guterres also rebuked might-makes-right thinking, telling superpowers to recognise "that their power isn't so super." Recent years have made it clear that "military power alone cannot secure peace," he said.

The annual high-level gathering at the UN General Assembly will be consumed with wars in Iran, Gaza, Ukraine, Sudan, Congo and Myanmar and a persisting question.

Saudi restarts East-West pipeline

Singapore: Saudi Arabia has restarted operations at its East-West Pipeline and could resume exports from the Red Sea port of Yanbu later Tuesday, three sources briefed on matter said.

Drone attacks forced Saudi Arabia to shut its East-West Pipeline on September 13, halting crude loadings at the kingdom's Yanbu port. The resumption of supplies on Tuesday helped to drive selling on global oil markets, traders said.

Brent crude futures fell by more than $2 a barrel to its lowest since September 8.

Since disruption to oil flows through the Strait of Hormuz following the US-Israeli war on Iran, OPEC's leading oil exporter has been using the pipeline to reroute around 4 million barrels per day — around 4% of global supply — to Yanbu. The pipeline was pumping at a low rate after its restart, two of sources said.

State oil firm Saudi Aramco did not respond to a request for comment. **REUTERS**

Trump signs US-Denmark-Greenland pact

Deal to expand US military presence in Greenland

Associated Press
United Nations, September 22

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump has signed an agreement with Denmark and Greenland aimed at strengthening Arctic and North Atlantic security, easing tensions over his repeated calls for Greenland to become part of the United States.

The signing Tuesday on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly in New York comes days after Trump announced the deal to bolster US military presence on the vast, icy island but keep it under Danish control. The agreement would still apply if Greenland eventually chooses independence.

"This is tremendous for Europe and for the United States and for everybody," Trump said just before the agreement was signed. "And for Greenland, it's going to be incredible."

Trump has expressed his desire to acquire Greenland since as long ago as 2019 and, during his second term, has issued threats to seize the semiautonomous territory from Denmark, a NATO ally. On Tuesday, he did not respond to questions about whether a US acquisition of Greenland was off the table.

Officials from the US, Greenland and Denmark negotiated for months behind the scenes, searching for solutions to address some of Trump's security concerns about the island.

Trump's designs on Greenland strained relations within NATO, with Danish Prime Minister Mette Frederiksen warning a US takeover would amount to the end of the Atlantic alliance.

The standoff drove a wedge between the US and Denmark and its EU partners, who stepped up security exercises.

US President Donald Trump and New York Mayor Zohran Mamdani at a press conference at Gracie Mansion in New York on Monday after they discussed housing, affordability and their political differences. AP

• BRIEFLY

SRI LANKA

Court finds 15 men guilty of their involvement in Easter bombings

Police patrol at the High Court ahead of a verdict related to the 2019 Easter bombings. AP

A SRI Lankan court found 15 men guilty on Tuesday of involvement in the 2019 Easter Sunday bombings, which killed more than 260 people and wounded about 500. The April 21 attacks targeted three churches and three hotels across the island nation during Easter services and celebrations. The Islamic State group-inspired bombings, among the deadliest in Sri Lanka's history, killed 42 foreigners and devastated communities across the country. AP

TURKEY

Shooting outside school injures 11

A STUDENT opened fire in front of their high school in Turkey's western province of Manisa early on Tuesday, wounding at least 11 other pupils, Justice Minister Akin Gurlek said. The assailant was caught and their mother, father, and grandfather — who owned the weapon used in the attack — have been detained, he added. AP

THE PHILIPPINES

Manila, EU reach a free trade deal

THE EUROPEAN Union and the Philippines announced a new free trade deal on Tuesday. The EU's top trade negotiator, Maros Sefcovic, said that he and Philippine Trade Secretary Maria Cristina Aldeguer-Roque structured the deal to grow the nearly around $35 billion of annual trade between the EU and the Philippines. AP

Russian strikes kill four in Ukraine ahead of Trump-Zelenskyy talks

Kyiv: Russia killed four people in strikes on Ukraine's industrial heartland overnight, Ukrainian officials said Tuesday, hours before President Volodymyr Zelenskyy was due to meet US President Donald Trump at the UN.

"Russia deliberately targets businesses, farms, warehouses, railways, energy facilities and residential buildings," Ukrainian Prime Minister Sergii Koretskyi said on Telegram.

The Ukrainian military said on Tuesday it had hit a Russian oil refinery in the city of Ufa, more than 1,300 km from the border with Ukraine. It also said it had struck the Kuibyshev oil refinery in the Samara region on the Volga river.

Trump said last week that Ukraine and Russia agreed not to strike energy targets, but any semblance of a truce disappeared when Russia hit petrol stations in Kyiv the following day and Ukraine bombed a Russian oil refinery. Continuing its attacks on Ukraine's economic infrastructure, Moscow simultaneously hit industrial enterprises in the cities of Dnipro, Kryvyi Rih and Pavlohrad in the southeastern region of Dnipropetrovsk, governor Oleksandr Hanzha said on Telegram.

The region is home to machine building, steel-making and other major production.

A missile strike on a facility in Dnipro owned by Interpipe, Ukraine's largest pipe producer, killed four people and wounded seven, company said. **REUTERS**

Beijing flags 'red line' Taiwan ahead of Xi-Trump summit in Washington

Beijing: China on Tuesday spelt out Taiwan as a "red line", a day ahead of President Xi Jinping's visit to Washington for a summit with his US counterpart Donald Trump. Beijing claims Taiwan as part of its mainland. Xi's meeting with Trump Thursday during his three-day visit to Washington will be the two leaders' second meeting since May.

Announcing Xi's visit, the Chinese Foreign Ministry said on Monday that the leaders' meeting within a span of half a year marks a "milestone of historic significance".

During the meeting, Xi is widely expected to convey China's firm opposition to America's proposed $11 billion arms package for Taiwan, which Trump has yet to approve and urge the US leader to scale down Washington's support for Taipei.

China claims the self-ruled Taiwan island is part of its mainland and vows to integrate it. It also prohibits countries it has diplomatic relations with from having formal ties with Taipei.

It reiterated that Taiwan is a "red line" for Beijing, calling it a guardrail and safety net for China-US relations, the Hong Kong-based *South China Morning Post reported*, citing article.

"Managing 'Taiwan independence' is a key part of building strategic stability between China and US," the front-page *People's Daily* piece noted, framing pro-independence forces as a "common enemy" of Beijing and Washington. **PTI**

• THE MOST INCENDIARY NEWS IN *SWAN SONG* COMES WHEN EARL SPENCER DESCRIBES TELEPHONE CONVERSATIONS HE SAYS HE HAD WITH PRINCE CHARLES AFTER DIANA'S DEATH

Swan Song: A missile of a memoir as Diana's brother takes fresh aim at British royals

Sarah Lyall
September 22

IN 1997, EARL Spencer, head of one of Britain's most distinguished aristocratic dynasties, stood before the world and delivered a public rebuke to the British royal family. The occasion was the funeral of his sister Diana, the Princess of Wales, whose death in a car accident in Paris had unleashed a torrent of grief from a nation long accustomed to concealing its feelings.

At one point, the earl alluded to Buckingham Palace's decision to strike "Her Royal Highness" from Diana's name as a condition of her divorce from Prince Charles, the future king, a year earlier. His sister, he said, "proved in the last year that she needed no royal title to continue to generate her particular brand of magic."

No one who witnessed the earl's extraordinary oration, which drew spontaneous applause from spectators watching on screens outside, will ever forget its shock, even at a funeral full of shocking details. Queen Elizabeth, seated impassively in the church, was one of the objects of his remarks and the earl's godmother; Robert Fellowes, the Queen's private secretary, was his brother-in-law.

Nearly 30 years later, Earl Spencer, 62, is publishing *Swan Song: Diana, My Sister*, a memoir of his and Diana's connected lives that revisits the days surrounding her death. If he seemed angry at the royal family 29 years ago and determined to stand up for his own family in the face of what he saw as callousness by theirs, it is clear now that the public didn't know the half of it.

The events are nearly three decades old. Earl Spencer, who uses his given name, Charles Spencer, professionally, has worked as a journalist, historian and podcast host and written nine nonfiction books, including *A Very Private School*, an account of the abuse he and other boys suffered at Maidwell.

The most incendiary news in *Swan Song* comes when Earl Spencer describes telephone conversations he says he had with Prince Charles after Diana's death. At first, Charles sounded "giddily elated — like a lottery winner, I remember thinking at the time," the earl says. Perhaps, he writes, the prince was thinking about "now being free to marry the woman he loved, rather than appreciating the loss of one he did not" — a reference to Camilla Parker Bowles, now Queen Camilla.

Worse was to come when the two argued over the funeral arrangements. Though the royal family had effectively excommunicated Diana after the divorce, the earl writes, it "felt entitled to take the lead" in planning the event; the Spencers "were simply expected to fall in line."

He says that when Prince Charles learned he objected to the plan to have Princes Harry and William, then 12 and 15, walk behind their mother's coffin as it approached Westminster Abbey, Charles telephoned him in a rage.

His temper worsened when the earl, the princes' uncle, said Diana wouldn't have wanted her sons to undergo such an ordeal.

"That's the problem with your family. They've got no bloody sense of duty!" Earl Spencer says Charles — whom he describes as a "bellowing buffoon" — told him. He thought of "all the generations of Spencers, in their gilded frames at Althorp, who had served King, Queen and Country dutifully."

At the end of his outburst, Charles turned his attention back to Diana. "'Rest assured,' he hissed," Earl Spencer writes. "'We'll forget her soon enough!'" The earl hung up the phone.

Charles did not directly deny the account, but his office released a statement that was a denial of sorts.

"His Majesty is mindful that the pain of fraternal grief can cloud reason, affect judgment and colour memory in ways others do not recognize, even many years after such a loss."

In response, Earl Spencer reiterated his recollection — "those are exactly the words he said," he told the *BBC* — and declared that "it is not every day you wake up to find you've been gaslit by the King." **NYT**

Earl Spencer *(left)* with the then Prince Charles at the official opening of a memorial for Diana in Hyde Park, London in 2004. AP

WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 23, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 22 PAGES

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

₹7.00 (₹8 RAIPUR, ₹15 SRINAGAR) • www.indianexpress.com

DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

Happening today

• **ALL IRANIAN AIRLINES** "will be shut down around the world," according to US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, who has threatened foreign companies with secondary sanctions if they continue servicing Iran's carriers.

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY

INSIDE

JAISHANKAR: GLOBAL ORDER UNDER STRESS, NEED REFORMED MULTILATERALISM P 6

1986 RULING STANDS, CAN'T PENALISE FOR NOT SINGING: SC ON VANDE MATARAM P 7

BIHAR MOLESTATION: ACCUSED SHOT IN LEG DURING 'ENCOUNTER' WITH POLICE P 7

EXPRESS INVESTIGATION PART I

14 times in 10 months, two Election Commissioners objected on record to steps taken by Commission — from keeping them in the dark to adding new voters and deleting names

Unprecedented rupture inside Election Commission: ECs call steps on new voters 'unauthorised, illegal'; warn against voter database access being 'centralised' in Delhi, bypassing officials on ground

Ritika Chopra
New Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Panaji, September 22

THE ELECTION Commission of India's (ECI) Special Intensive Revision (SIR), which began in Bihar in June 2025, an otherwise routine clean-up of the rolls, has struck more than 13 crore names off the draft voter rolls in 30 States and Union Territories. This has put the Commission at the centre of intense public debate over its role in deciding who gets to vote — and who doesn't.

An investigation by *The Indian Express* reveals that questions were raised on these very issues within the three-member Election Commission (EC) itself, time and again through much of this same period. By two of the three Election Commissioners, Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, no less.

The national rollout of the SIR has been under the supervision of all three Commissioners. But Sandhu and Joshi have formally objected, on record, at least 14 times over the last 10 months — four times on a single day — to decisions taken and orders issued, they say, without their knowledge.

The stakes couldn't be higher.

For, the objections relate to the core of the EC's mandate: new voter registration, deletion and restoration of voters in the rolls; filing of appeals against orders restoring voters in the SIR process; and the custody, and security, of the entire electoral roll itself. All objections related to these were copied to Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, too. Some were sent to Deputy Election Commissioners under their watch.

In one such written objection, Sandhu complains that the EC acted against the written advice of two Commissioners and claims its action was "unauthorised and illegal." Most recently, in a radical departure from the norm (*see adjacent report*), Joshi and Sandhu wrote separately to

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

CEC Gyanesh Kumar with Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi at a press conference. All three Commissioners were appointed by the NDA government. ANIL SHARMA/ FILE

Integrity of voter database: They even knocked on Cabinet Secretary's door

Ritika Chopra & Damini Nath
New Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Panaji, September 22

THE PROMISE was sweeping. On January 22, the Election Commission of India (ECI) launched ECINet, the tech backbone for almost a billion voters, bringing more than 40 of its apps and portals under one roof. It was built in strict accordance with the law, Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar said. It would "enhance transparency, credibility and public trust", said Seema Khanna, the Director General of IT in the Commission.

Within months, this very platform the CEC and his DG(IT) had called lawful and trustworthy was unravelling — state officers, prescribed by law to add or delete names and update records, were finding themselves shut out of the system, their access restricted by Khanna's team in New Delhi.

This was a potential blow to the integrity of the elections itself. It prompted the two Election Commissioners

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

TOMORROW: PART II

FILING APPEALS IN WEST BENGAL; STRIKING DOWN NAMES IN GOA

Illegal, unauthorised...(it's) harassment of young: ECs object to change in Form 6

Ritika Chopra
New Delhi, September 22

THE CHANGE is "illegal," "unauthorised," it needs to be sent to the Government...it must be removed immediately so that young, first-time voters are not harassed. The warning by the two Election Commissioners couldn't have been clearer — and yet it was ignored.

The change brought questions related to SIR into Form 6, the form new voters have to fill. It asked applicants to choose one of three statements: whether their name appeared in the electoral roll during the last SIR held in the early 2000s, whether the name of a parent or grandparent appeared in that

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS special
EC changes Form 6 for new voters, inserts section asking them about parents in SIR

Express report published July 12

What this rift reveals: Cloud over Commission's conduct

Ritika Chopra
New Delhi, September 22

THERE HAS been dissent within the Election Commission earlier but never before have two Election Commissioners put on record objections that touch the heart of the electoral process itself: new voters, deleting names, the IT system that secures the entire voters' list itself.

1. CONCENTRATION OF POWERS: You may be legally entitled to vote but now you may hit the "system hurdle". Your Electoral Registration Officer may not be able to ensure your right. That's

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Shri Thawarchand Gehlot
His Excellency
Governor of Karnataka

ರಾಜೀವ್ ಗಾಂಧಿ ಆರೋಗ್ಯ ವಿಜ್ಞಾನಗಳ ವಿಶ್ವವಿದ್ಯಾಲಯ, ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ

RAJIV GANDHI UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES, KARNATAKA

No. 12, 30th Cross Road, 4th 'T' Block, Jayanagar, Bengaluru 560 041, Karnataka.

LEGACY OF EXCELLENCE, VISION FOR TOMORROW

India's largest health sciences university, committed to excellence in education, research, innovation and healthcare for a better tomorrow

Shri D.K. Shivakumar
Hon'ble Chief Minister
Government of Karnataka

Dr. G. Parameshwara
Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister
Government of Karnataka

1,550+ AFFILIATED INSTITUTIONS | 4+ LAKH STUDENTS | 40,000+ FACULTY AND STAFF | 60,000+ DEGREES AWARDED ANNUALLY | 8+ LAKH HEALTHCARE PROFESSIONALS EMPOWERED

PLEASE NOTE
RGUHS has No affiliated colleges outside Karnataka.
For the list of our affiliated colleges Please visit
www.rguhs.ac.in

COURSES OFFERED

NURSING
Number of Colleges 681
• B.Sc. Nursing
• Post Basic B.Sc. Nursing
• M.Sc. Nursing
• Phd • NPCC

AYUSH
(UG, PG & Phd in)
Number of Colleges 150
• Ayurveda
• Homoeopathy
• Unani • Yoga & Naturopathy
• Siddha • Sowarigpa

PHARMACY
Number of Colleges 150
• B.Pharm
• Pharm.D
• M.Pharm
• Pharm.D (Post Baccalaureate)
• Phd

DENTAL SCIENCES
Number of Colleges 37
• BDS
• MDS
• Fellowship
• Phd

ALLIED HEALTH SCIENCES
Number of Colleges 276
• B.Sc. Allied Health Sciences
• M.Sc. Allied Health Sciences
• Phd

MEDICINE
Number of Colleges 61
• MBBS
• MD/MS
• Super Specialty (DM/M.Ch.)
• Fellowship Programmes
• Phd

PHYSIOTHERAPY
Number of Colleges 169
• BPT
• MPT
• Phd

ADMISSIONS OPEN

Hon'ble Minister for Medical Education and Skill Development Dr. Sharanaprakash R. Patil, Hon'ble Minister for Health and Family Welfare Shri U. T. Khader and Hon'ble Vice Chancellor Dr. Bhagavan B. C. participated in a programme at RGUHS.

New Projects Underway

RGUHS CAMPUS AT RAMANAGARA

A state-of-the-art University Campus is being established in Ramanagara with the vision of creating a world-class center for medical education, academic excellence and institutional administration. It will include constituent colleges, a modern hospital and an administrative block.

Skill/Simulation Labs Across Karnataka

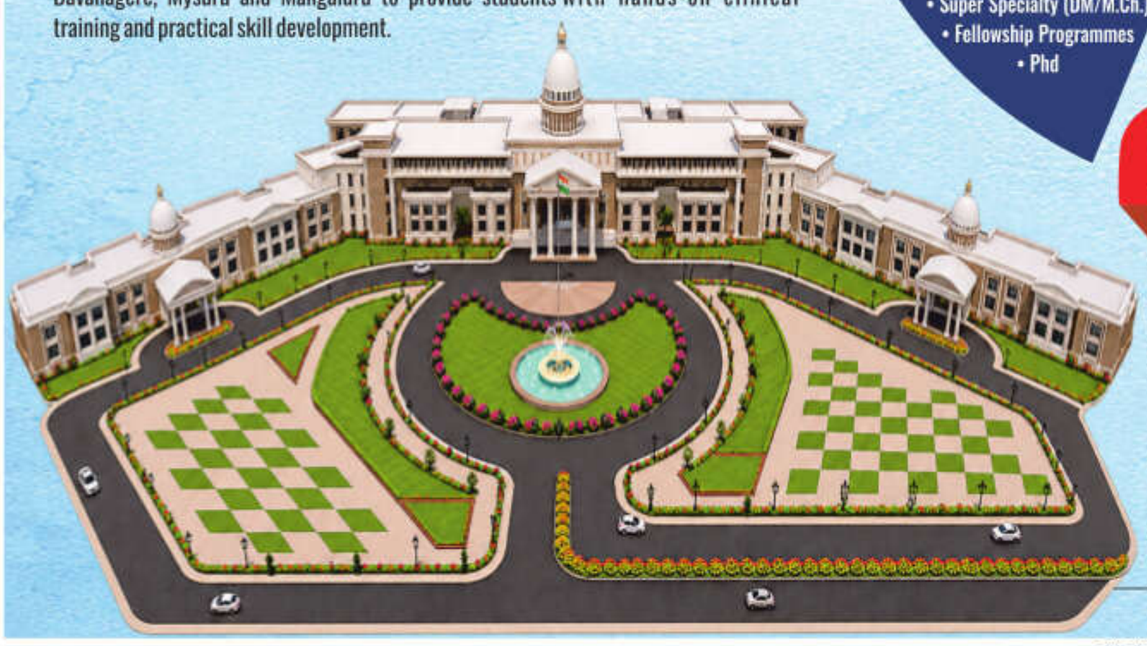
Skill/Simulation Labs are being developed at Gadag, Bheemanakuppe, Kalaburagi, Davanagere, Mysuru and Mangaluru to provide students with hands-on clinical training and practical skill development.

New Projects Underway

RESEARCH & INNOVATION CENTRE BHEEMANAKUPPE, BANGALORE

A state-of-the-art research hub for advanced health sciences research, innovation and translational studies, integrating Digital Pathology, Digital Radiology, AI-assisted diagnostics and centralized health data systems.

• India's Largest Bio Bank
• Foreign Language Laboratory
• Largest Helinet Consortium – Digital E-Library Network
• India's Largest Teachers' Training and Faculty Development Centre
• India's First Pharmacy Skill Lab
• Advanced Genetic and Molecular Biology Laboratory
• Research Grants for Students and Faculty
• RAGUPAT – Placement & Training: Strengthening skill development, finishing programmes and global career opportunities for students and graduates



TRANSFORMING SOCIETY BEYOND CLASSROOMS – KEY INITIATIVES

Nasha Mukt Campus Abhiyan | Organ Donation Pledge Abhiyan | Palliative Care Curriculum Training for Faculty | Divine Mother – Child Program | Raktha Kosha | BLS & Jeeva Raksha Training | Disaster Management Network Across Karnataka | Research, Innovation and Academic Collaboration with the Indian Institute of Science (IISc) | Smart Mentor Programme – Empowering Students through Digital Mentorship | Institution-Wide Digital Transformation Program

As enshrined in our Constitution - to safeguard public property and to abjure violence is the fundamental duty of every citizen of India.

EXPRESS INVESTIGATION FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

14 times in 10 months, two Election Commissioners objected on record to steps taken by Commission

the Cabinet Secretary complaining about changes in work allocation that, in effect, removed a layer of oversight of the IT backbone for the electoral rolls. They made it clear: these changes had been done without their knowledge and they struck them down.

It was after this, on September 9, that the CEC and the two ECs met, their first full meeting in four months.

The Indian Express has seen each of these exchanges, and interviewed a range of officials in New Delhi, Kolkata, Goa and Mumbai, to reconstruct the extent of the disquiet within, unprecedented in scale and significance within the constitutional authority that is entrusted with the free and fair conduct of the nation's elections.

More so, because all three were handpicked by the NDA government and appointed under the 2023 Act by a selection panel of the Prime Minister, Union Home Minister and the Leader of Opposition. The Opposition member, Congress's Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury, recorded a dissent over the appointment process when Sandhu and Gyanesh Kumar were named Election Commissioners in March 2024. LoP Rahul Gandhi, too, recorded his dissent when Kumar was elevated to CEC and Joshi appointed in February 2025.

On September 21, *The Indian Express* sent a questionnaire to the Commission on the issues flagged by the two Election Commissioners asking what was done to address their concerns. There was no response. Both the ECs were also sent emails on September 21, asking them whether their concerns were addressed. Both the emails also sought responses on whether these issues were flagged during the September 9 meeting. Both emails were followed up by phone calls on Monday and Tuesday. There was no response.

Taken together, these objections represent the sharpest and most sustained ruptures recorded inside a Constitutional authority — and touch four key issues:

1. Who's a "new voter", why was Form-6 changed?

In July this year, as first reported by *The Indian Express*, a form that every adult citizen has to fill to become a voter started asking a question it never did earlier. Linking the application to the SIR, it asked if the new voter or their parents/ grandparents "exist" in the "electoral roll of last SIR." Applicants could not proceed without answering it.

This despite the fact that in May, Joshi had warned on file that Form 6 could not be changed in this manner without the government amending the rules, and Sandhu had agreed. The change was made anyway. After *The Indian Express* first reported this change in July, Sandhu put on record on August 13 that it was "unauthorised and illegal" and "must be removed immediately". Until Monday morning, that question was still there.

2. Who should have access to the electoral roll?

The Commission's strongest defence against every political allegation on electoral roll rigging has been that the roll preparation is decentralised. Each constituency's voters' list is prepared and controlled by its Electoral Registration Officer, a statutory authority on the ground. Usually, the ERO is the Sub-Divisional Magistrate. This list sits on a software, ERONet, and its successor ECINet. Over the past year, the two Commissioners have repeatedly questioned whether EROs' access to this list is now being restricted.

This was what Joshi red-flagged in May this year — the SIR was gathering pace across states — as "gradual centralisation of the electoral roll database" and proposed an audit to certify that "no one, except the concerned statutory authorities, has credentials to make any change in the (voter) database."

In August, Sandhu reiterated this. He recorded that state-level election officials were reporting they "don't have proper and complete access" to the ERONet portal, the digital system through which they maintain the electoral roll. He flagged that the Commission's Director General of IT Seema Khanna "doesn't have any legal authority to restrict proper and complete access and freedom to operate, as given by law, to the statutory authorities."

The defence the Commission has relied on for decades, the two ECs were saying, is being dismantled from inside its own IT division.

3. West Bengal: who authorised the appeals?

The SIR was the most deeply contested in West Bengal. There was no evidence of its role in the election outcome. Of the 294 seats that went to polls, in 49, the SIR deletions exceeded the victory margin. But in these, the spoils were almost evenly shared — 26 were won by BJP and 21 by TMC.

But the manner in which names were struck off prompted the Supreme Court, in February 2026, to take the last leg of the SIR out of the Commission's hands and get judicial officers to decide on the plight of 60 lakh voters flagged for "logical discrepancies."

Of these, 27 lakh electors were subsequently deleted by the Commission. The court then ordered tribunals of retired High Court judges to hear appeals against those decisions.

Last week, the Commission told the court that there were 38 lakh appeals pending before the tribunals: 22.21 lakh filed by deleted voters seeking to be restored. The other 16.10 lakh were filed against voters the judicial officers had included, seeking their deletion. The Commission did not say who filed those.

This was the issue flagged by Sandhu — about the Commission appealing against voters whom judicial officers had included.

In August, he wrote to Commission officials asking, "Who was authorised to file these appeals on behalf of ECI, and by whom?" and "Who actually filed these appeals on behalf of ECI?" He recorded that neither he nor Joshi nor the current Chief Electoral Officer of West Bengal had been informed about the basis or process of filing the appeals.

4. Goa: why did the software reject eligible voters?

The same centralisation, which Joshi and Sandhu had flagged repeatedly, ended up disenfranchising potential voters in Goa. On January 29, the Supreme Court ordered that voters flagged for "logical discrepancies" during the SIR be allowed to submit documents and be heard before the final roll was published. A "logical discrepancy" is a mismatch the software throws up when it tries to link a voter to a parent or relative on an older roll: a name that doesn't match, an age gap that doesn't add up.

Goa's EROs heard these cases. On the documents produced, they found 97 voters eligible for the final roll. The software had no way to record that decision.

Between February 11 and 17, the office of Goa's Chief Electoral Officer wrote eight times to Gyanesh Bharti, the Senior Deputy Election Commissioner in charge of the state, copying Director General of IT Seema Khanna every time, asking for the rollback option that would let EROs reverse the earlier deletions as the Supreme Court had directed. The requests went unanswered as the deadline for publication of the final electoral roll approached.

The provision was not enabled in time. The 97 were left off the final voters' roll in Goa. Ninety seven voters is a small number, however this goes far beyond 97 — it is the ECI's job to ensure that every valid vote gets counted.

Objections within: what the law requires

The Commission is a constitutional body under Article 324, made up of the Chief Election Commissioner and two Election Commissioners who are equal in rank. The CEC is first among equals. He does not have the power to decide alone.

Under the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, all business of the Commission, says Section 18, "shall, as far as possible, be transacted unanimously".

If the CEC and the Election Commissioners "differ in opinion on any matter", the matter "shall be decided according to the opinion of the majority." The same section allows the Commission to settle its own procedure and the division of its work, but only "by unanimous decision".

Indeed, both Commissioners invoked these provisions in their notes to remind the Commission's officers how it is meant to work. On April 16, Sandhu told the Commission's senior officers that "many communications go out in the name of the ECI but they do not have the approval of the Commission", and that from then on every communication must have it, "as per the provisions of 2023 Act".

Eight days later, Joshi told the same officers that "several communications are disseminated in the name of the ECI without the requisite approval of 'the Commission'," and that all future communications must have that approval, "in accordance with the provisions of Article 324 of the Constitution" and the Act.

• TEN MONTHS, 14 NOTES: THE OBJECTIONS ON RECORD

Five of the 14 notes by ECs Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi were copied to Chief Election Commissioner

1 **OCT 28, 2025 — SANDHU:** Letters, orders in ECI's name without Commission's approval.

2 **APR 16, 2026 — SANDHU:** Getting to know about new IT modules, portals from media.

3 **APR 16 — SANDHU:** Official communications issued without Commission's approval.

4 **APR 16 — JOSHI:** For over a year, got no agenda before, minutes after, Commission's meetings.

5 **APR 16 — JOSHI:** Officers on foreign trips without Commission's approval.

6 **APR 24 — JOSHI:** Reiterates no official communications without Commission's approval.

7 **MAY 16 — JOSHI:** Don't change Form 6 (new voter) without Govt approval; Sandhu agrees on May 19.

8 **MAY 29 — JOSHI:** Warns electoral roll database is being centralised, needs audit; Sandhu endorses on July 13.

9 **JUL 29 — JOSHI TO CABINET SECRETARY:** Official redistributing work without Commission's knowledge.

10 **JUL 29 — SANDHU TO CABINET SECRETARY:** Reiterates work roster issue, seeks action against official.

11 **JUL 30:** Joshi and Sandhu strike down new allocation order.

12 **AUG 12 — SANDHU:** Who authorised appeals on EC's behalf before West Bengal's tribunals?

13 **AUG 13 — SANDHU:** Form-6 change is 'unauthorised and illegal'.

14 **AUG 14 — SANDHU:** Field officers can't access ECI Net system. DG(IT) has no power to restrict.

— RITIKA CHOPRA

MEET THE TWO ELECTION COMMISSIONERS

SUKHBIR SINGH SANDHU

HE JOINED as Election Commissioner on March 15, 2024. A 1988-batch IAS officer of the Uttarakhand cadre, he served as Chief Secretary of Uttarakhand from July 2021 to January 2024. Prior to that, from 2019 to 2021, he was Chairman of the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI). In February 2024, he briefly served as Secretary to the Lokpal.

He also served as Collector of Haridwar, Gautam Buddha Nagar (NOIDA) and Udham Singh Nagar districts. He was Principal Secretary to four Chief Ministers across three political parties between 2007 and 2014.

Sandhu completed his MBBS from Government Medical College, Amritsar, and has a Master's in History from Guru Nanak Dev University, Amritsar. He is also a Law graduate.

VIVEK JOSHI

HE JOINED as an Election Commissioner on February 19, 2025. A 1989-batch IAS officer of the Haryana cadre, he served as Chief Secretary of Haryana. He has also served in the Ministries of Textiles, Women and Child Development, and Finance. In Haryana, he was Deputy Commissioner of Jind, Hisar and Panchkula, and Divisional Commissioner of Ambala. He has been a board member of the Reserve Bank of India and the State Bank of India.

Joshi has a PhD in International Economics from the Graduate Institute, Geneva, and a B.E. in Mechanical Engineering (1987) from Roorkee University, now known as IIT Roorkee.

— DEEPAK TENGURIYA

Integrity of voter database: They even knocked on Cabinet Secretary's door

Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi to raise red flags about the "gradual centralisation of the electoral roll database" and warn that ECINet was restricting the powers of officers on the ground who were responsible for preparing and finalising the roll.

On three occasions, they copied their notes to Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

When a new officer was put in charge of the EC's administration division in Delhi and issued a work allocation order that threatened to further concentrate these powers, the two ECs separately wrote to the country's top bureaucrat, Cabinet Secretary T V Somanathan.

In effect, the two ECs were flagging a violation of the law.

The Representation of the People Act, 1950, and the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, assign responsibility for the electoral roll to the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO), one for each Assembly seat. An ERO is usually the sub-divisional magistrate or an officer of equivalent rank in the district administration. The ERO prepares the voters' list, hears claims and objections and decides which names will stay — and which get deleted.

This is a deliberately decentralised system. For decades, the ECI has leaned on that design to answer political allegations of mass manipulation of electoral rolls. No single person is supposed to control the voters' list.

On paper, the ERO still decides every name on the list. In practice, for at least the past 10 months, this has been tested in state after state. There are many cases where the ERO has not been able to do what the software allows: add a name, delete one, reverse a decision or process an appeal. What the software allows is controlled centrally by Khanna's division in New Delhi.

Over ten months, from November to August, the two Commissioners said so repeatedly and in writing:

NOVEMBER 4, 2025: The concerns did not begin with ECINet. Its predecessor, ERONet, the roll-management system that ECINet has since subsumed, was already being used to manage the electoral roll, while new modules were being rolled out for the Special Intensive Revision. By November 2025, months before ECINet was launched, there were already warnings inside the Commission that the IT system (ERONet then) must not restrict the statutory powers of EROs.

On November 4, 2025, acting on Sandhu's directions, Deputy Election Commissioner Sanjay Kumar wrote to Khanna and senior Commission officers that "statutory functions of ERO, DEO and CEO (were) to be strictly exercised by them and no one else" and that "IT systems must be in strict compliance with the law, without any exception."

JANUARY 2, 2026: With the SIR underway in 12 states and UTs, and the IT division putting EROs onto a new module for issuing notices and holding hearings, Sanjay Kumar wrote to Khanna, asking her to "ensure that IT system is made in a manner that ERO's discretion to act in any manner is not restricted". Twenty days later, the Commission launched ECINet.

APRIL 16: Sandhu recorded that the IT division "has developed many new modules and portals in the last few months" without any being brought to his knowledge or presented to the Commission. "I have come to know about new developments from media only," he wrote. He asked that Khanna be directed to keep all members of the Commission briefed and obtain "all necessary approvals" before undertaking any activity.

MAY 29: Joshi wrote to the CEC, Sandhu and Sanjay Kumar of "the gradual centralisation of the electoral roll database" and proposed an audit, with an outside expert from the IITs, to certify that "no one, except the concerned statutory authorities, has credentials to make any change in the (voter) database".

Joshi proposed two checks. One committee would periodically review the systems and certify that only the statutory authorities had the credentials to change the voter database. A second committee would check whether ECINet complied with the law and ensure that any policy or procedural changes to ERONet and ECINet were brought before the Commission. The aim, Joshi wrote, was to create an "internal auditing mechanism" that could also help the Commission answer the allegations against it that centralisation had invited.

JULY 13: Sandhu endorsed the proposal, writing that it would "improve the system" and should be put before the Commission. A month later, on August 14, Sandhu recorded the outcome. "Any action taken on these two notes of two Election Commissioners is not known to the undersigned."

JULY 28: The tensions within ECI over the functioning of the IT division came to a head in late July, when an established layer of oversight over the IT division was removed.

Until then, senior IAS officer Sanjay Kumar, who was serving as Deputy Election Commissioner in New Delhi, was responsible for overseeing the IT division's work and routing its files to the three-member Commission.

On July 28, Maneesh Garg, Senior Deputy Election Commissioner in the ECI, was given additional charge of administration while the regular officer was on leave. Within hours, Garg changed the work allocation without consulting the Commission, removing Sanjay Kumar from the oversight of DG IT.

For Sandhu and Joshi, that chain was the oversight they had been asking for. It was through it that they had sought briefings on the IT division's work and proposed an audit of the system. Garg's order removed it.

JULY 29: In a move without precedent, the two Commissioners each wrote separately to the Cabinet Secretary reporting the above order and calling it a "clear violation" of the law that governs the Commission and asking for "appropriate action" against Garg.

JULY 30: A day after writing to the Cabinet Secretary, Sandhu and Joshi jointly set Garg's order aside. They said the changes he made were "without any reason and justification". They directed the previous work allocation to continue until the Commission reached a consensus on any change. The note went to Garg and was also copied to the CEC.

AUGUST 14: Sandhu then put on record his most detailed concern about the IT system and the electoral roll. CEOs, DEOs and EROs are the statutory authorities responsible for the electoral roll, he wrote. But many had told him they did not have "proper and complete access" to ERONet and were therefore unable to perform their statutory duties properly. Their powers, he said, had been "curtailed by centralised control of ERONet at DG(IT) level".

"It is strange," Sandhu wrote, that responsibility for the electoral roll lay with these statutory authorities while "access control has been centralised by DG(IT)". The DG(IT), he wrote, "doesn't have any legal authority to restrict proper and complete access and freedom to operate, as given by law".

Sandhu directed full access "be given immediately". He also asked the DG (IT) to certify, based on confirmations from all CEOs, that statutory authorities across states and Union Territories had full access to ERONet and could perform their duties without restrictions.

The Election Commission and the two ECs, Sandhu and Joshi, did not respond to calls and questionnaires emailed by *The Indian Express* seeking comment.

ECs object to change in Form 6

roll, or whether neither their name nor that of their parents appeared in it.

The section itself was not marked mandatory, but applicants could not proceed to submit the form without answering it.

Internal records investigated by *The Indian Express* show this declaration was added despite two of the Commission's three members recording in May that it could not be done without amending the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, notified by the Centre after consultation with the Election Commission.

2 Commissioners, 1 warning

On May 16, responding to the proposal to change Form 6 through the SIR framework, Election Commissioner Vivek Joshi recorded his objections. The SIR, he noted, was being conducted under Section 21(3) of the Representation of the People Act, 1950 — the provision that lets the Commission order a special revision of the roll — "as one time measure and exception".

The forms prescribed for the SIR were specific to that exercise and were non-statutory, or not part of law, he wrote. Form 6 and Form 8 (for making changes and corrections): they are "prescribed statutorily" and "cannot be altered without making amendments in the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960". Joshi specifically rejected the idea that a sentence in an SIR order or guideline could change a form fixed by law.

His conclusion was that the "best and legally sustainable course of action" would be to send the proposal to the Government for changes to the rules. He also proposed that a draft of the changes to Form 6 and Form 8 be put before the Commission immediately. On May 19, his colleague on the panel Sukhbir Singh Sandhu concurred with Joshi on file.

On July 12, *The Indian Express* first reported on the new declaration in Form 6 on the Commission's ECINet portal. On August 13, referring to *The Indian Express* report, Sandhu wrote to the Deputy Election Commissioner and the Director General in charge of IT, with Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and Joshi copied on the note.

Sandhu recalled Joshi's May 16 note, with which he had agreed, that Form 6 was a statutory form embedded in the rules and could not be changed without approval from the competent authority — meaning, the Government.

"In spite of these very clear views expressed by two Election Commissioners," Sandhu wrote, the "unauthorised/ illegal changes in Form-6 on the portal" had not been removed and the original form had not been restored. The changes "must be removed immediately so that young and would-be first time voters, who are otherwise eligible, can register themselves as voters as per law, without any harassment", he wrote.

What the addition means

The right to vote belongs to the individual: a person qualifies by age, citizenship and residence, not by whether their parents made it through the last revision. And, in a deeply contested SIR where over 13 crore people have already been dropped from the list, inserting such a question puts a shadow on their children as well.

Indeed, the new question on Form 6 mattered most to new voters whose parents or grandparents did not figure in the rolls prepared after the last SIR. An 18-year-old in such a family could not truthfully choose either of the first two options, and the form did not explain what would happen if they chose the third.

It also assumes significance because there is already a clear route for changing Form 6. In 2021, Parliament amended the Representation of the People Act, 1950 to allow the Commission to collect Aadhaar numbers from voters. That change to Form 6 was not made by the Commission itself: on June 17, 2022, the Law Ministry's Legislative Department notified the corresponding changes to the Registration of Electors Rules and Form 6. It was against this legal framework that the proposed SIR-linked change to Form 6 came before the Commission this year.

Cloud over Commission's conduct

what happened in Goa where 97 people met the ERO's requirements. They produced their documents, the ERO found them eligible but the software, controlled from EC headquarters in Delhi, didn't allow the ERO's decisions to be recorded. A voter can be eligible, prove it, be found eligible by the officer the law appoints, and still not be on the roll when the day comes, because the roll is a centrally controlled system that cut the ERO out.

2. SIR SHADOW OVER NEXT GENERATION: The change to Form-6 to which the ECs have objected asks new voters to mention if their parents, grandparents are on the roll of the last SIR. A parent's deletion, in a deeply contested SIR, and what course it takes — appeal or adjudication — will now hang over their child. A critical form that decides who a new voter is was changed without the Government amending the rules as the law requires.

3. EROSION OF SAFEGUARDS: Decentralisation within the EC was itself its strongest safeguard. For decades, the Commission has answered charges of rigging the electoral roll with the same basic argument: no one person or team controls the list. Thousands of statutory officers do, constituency by constituency. That safeguard, the two ECs have complained, is weakened when control over the digital system is centralised. A team in Delhi can now stall, override or cancel what ground-level officials do.

A voter after casting her vote for the 2019 Lok Sabha election in Meghalaya. EXPRESS FILE

4. CHECKS AND BALANCES CRUMBLE: The ECI is a three-member constitutional body. Its law provides that business should, as far as possible, be transacted unanimously and, where members differ, by majority. Yet Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi repeatedly recorded that they had not been consulted or informed about decisions taken in the Commission's name.

5. VIOLATING THE EC'S MANDATE: There has been dissent within the Commission earlier but this one is very different. In January 2009, CEC N Gopalaswami, who was appointed as an EC by the Vajpayee government and later became the CEC, wrote to the President recommending that EC Navin Chawla be removed alleging partisan conduct. The Manmohan Singh government rejected the recommendation on March 1, 2009, and Chawla succeeded Gopalaswami as CEC that April.

In May 2019, days before the last phase of the Lok Sabha election, Election Commissioner Ashok Lavasa wrote to CEC Sunil Arora that he would stop attending Commission meetings on Model Code of Conduct complaints until his minority decisions are recorded in the final orders. He had disagreed with the majority's clean chits to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and then BJP president Amit Shah. Arora said the three members were "not expected to be templates or clones of each other". On May 21, 2019, the full Commission met and decided, 2-1, that dissents would be recorded in the file but not in the orders. Lavasa left EC the following year, before his turn as CEC, for the Asian Development Bank. Both Arora and Lavasa were appointed by the NDA governments.

In both the Chawla and the Lavasa cases, the dissent was around a specific issue flagged by an individual. This time, however, two Commissioners who make up the majority are not dissenting on decisions they have been overruled on. They are putting on record that decisions were taken, orders issued and cases filed and they are in the dark. Clearly, the Commission, that the 2023 Act requires to act "as far as possible, unanimously", has not.

'Contractual hiring not the answer': Court flags staff crunch at govt hospitals

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 22

STATING THAT contractual employment in hospitals is not the answer to staff crunch, the Delhi High Court has told the Delhi government to recruit for hospital top posts immediately

It also flagged the lack of a "uniform HR policy" to handle recruitments in these hospitals, cautioning the government that "there should not be a single post" at the top, such as of medical superintendent, left vacant.

The observation, made in an order on September 18 and made public on Monday, was by a bench of Justices Prathiba Singh and Manmeet Pritam Singh Arora while hearing a suo motu PIL. In 2017, the HC had taken suo motu cognisance of facilities lacking at hospitals, including ventilators, and had instituted the PIL.

The court has periodically kept a close eye on Delhi government's health facilities through the PIL, issuing directions from time to time, including implementing a system of publicly sharing in real-time bed availability across its hospitals.

The bench has now called for all medical superintendents/medical directors/directors of the 38 government hospitals in Delhi, as well as the secretary of the health department to join the proceedings either virtually or physically on the next date of hearing on October 10.

Taking up the issue of lack of manpower, cited as a reason by several hospitals on why several high-end medical equipment remain unused, the court observed that "contractual employment cannot be the answer to all problems".

Noting that the government "would have to deal with the issue of recruitment in a centralised manner, rather than allowing recruitment at the local level on a contractual basis," it said that filling up of vacancies has to be done in a manner so as to bring some consistency, clarity and permanency.

'SIR notices seem mechanical': SC seeks poll body's response

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 22

More than 33 lakh voters have been issued notices over reasons like 'logical discrepancy'. FILE

THE SUPREME Court Tuesday, taking note of concerns over the manner in which the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls is being carried out in Delhi, told the Election Commission of India (ECI) that notices seem to have been issued "mechanically" to "doubtful" voters. It also asked the poll body to see if additional filters were needed to refine the process.

"Refinement of the tool is necessary ... Almost mechanical notices are going. In all probability, they are machine-generated notices. So, please examine whether some additional filters are necessary before the notices," Justice Joymalya Bagchi, who was part of a three-judge bench, said.

The bench, presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and also comprising Justice V Mohana, was hearing a petition by activists Anjali Bhardwaj and Amrita Johri that stated that the ECI and the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer had failed to adequately disclose the names deleted from the electoral roll, apart from those issued notices for logical discrepancy and the reasons for the same.

The bench also issued a notice to the ECI on the plea and sought a status report.

Advocate Prashant Bhushan, appearing for the petitioners, said it is shocking that notices have been issued to more than 33 lakh voters due to reasons including "logical discrepancy".

More than 47 lakh names have already been deleted from the draft electoral rolls during the ongoing exercise in the Capital covering more than 97 lakh voters. Former deputy prime minister L K Advani, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, former vice-president Jagdeep Dhankhar and Election Commissioner S S Sandhu, Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri, former Delhi deputy chief minister Manish Sisodia, former JNU vice-chancellor M Jagadesh Kumar, former Delhi lieutenant governor Najeeb Jung, former NITI Aayog vice-chairman Arvind Panagariya, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey, former Army chief Upendra Dwivedi, CBI Director Praveen Sood and Rajya Sabha MP Kapil Sibal are among prominent voters who have received or are likely to receive notices.

"You need to clarify 'logical discrepancy' a little," the SC bench told senior advocate D S Naidu, who appeared for the poll body.

The CJI said, "I shifted to Delhi in May 2019 ... Before that, I was voting in Chandigarh. Your logical discrepancy notice can ask me whether in 2019 I was voting in Delhi or in Chandigarh, or somewhere else ... You can say 'Delhi or somewhere else, clarify.' So the person should be told what to clarify".

Bhushan pointed out that sometimes documents listed by the ECI may also not be capable of refuting the discrepancies.

Naidu, meanwhile, said every notice mentioned the reason for issuing them while referring to some sample notices. The CJI, while noting that those did mention the reasons, asked Naidu what information would be sufficient for an elector to answer the questions. Naidu, in his response, said the 12 documents referred to in the notices were not exhaustive.

Bhushan, on the other hand, asked why someone who has already submitted an enumeration form and produced proof of age and residence should produce more material.

CJI Kant said it could be because Delhi has a large migrant population. "In Delhi, problem would be unique," he said.

As Justice Mohana said, "we have also come across a situation where Booth Level Officers (BLOs) are not available", senior advocate Sibal pointed out that the city has many multi-storey buildings without elevators and that it would be far-fetched to say that the BLOs would visit each and every house.

As Justice Bagchi asked Naidu how many BLOs have been deployed for the SIR exercise in the Capital, the latter said: 14,000 BLOs and 1,200 Electoral Registration Officers.

Justice Bagchi also noted that if BLOs are stationed at ward offices, electors can approach them directly. Naidu said this had been done, adding that the poll body is also willing to extend the October 29 deadline, if necessary.

The CJI, also stating that there can be some orientation to boost electors' confidence, said: "... there are 15-20 types of queries/objections. You can prepare a standard response to that and circulate to all..."

Man killed, woman injured as Thar rams scooter in Greater Noida West

Drishti Jain
Greater Noida, September 22

FORTY-YEAR-OLD SUPREME Court advocate Neeraj had on Monday gone to pick up his wife Nishi Shrivastava from a school in Greater Noida West where she is employed as a teacher, on his scooter. Little did he know while stepping out of his house in Chipiyana, Gautam Buddha Nagar, that it was going to be his last ride.

Neeraj was killed and Nishi sustained critical injuries after a speeding SUV, a Mahindra Thar model, allegedly hit their two-wheeler, police said. "We are analysing CCTV footage. An inquiry is underway and efforts to trace the driver of the SUV are on," said a police officer. The spot of the incident falls under the jurisdiction of Bisrakh police station, they said.

Neeraj and Nishi got married barely six months ago, said her brother-in-law Krishna Kant Shrivastava, and had just started to build the life they wanted for themselves.

Picking up Nishi was something part of Neeraj's daily routine. "After work, Neeraj would reach home and step out again around 5 pm to pick Nishi up from her playschool," Krishna also said.

A hunt for the driver of the SUV (above) is on. VIDEO GRAB

"Following the accident, Nishi somehow managed to call up my wife (Nishi's sister). We reached a government hospital where she was taken first. She was later shifted to a private hospital. Her bones have been crushed by the vehicle. She has multiple fractures. Her knees and fingers were completely bent," he said.

The brother-in-law also said that the family has started raising money for Nishi's treatment, considering it would be expensive. "She probably would not be able to work any more," Krishna added.

Meanwhile, Nishi still has no idea what the accident cost her. She does not know that her husband is no more. She underwent a surgery Tuesday and the family said stents and rods had to be implanted in her body. "She was asking about Neeraj. We are yet to decide who will break the news to her," Krishna said.

According to the family, Nishi had lost her mother just eight days after her marriage. Her father passed away several years ago. "She used to stay with us. My wife (Nishi's sister) is still in shock," he said.

A video of the incident that went viral on the social media shows Neeraj lying inside a nearby drain and locals attending to his wife.

"The car was being driven very rashly ... probably at a speed of over 100 kmph," Krishna alleged, adding that Neeraj's brother has filed a police complaint.

• Skywatch

Forecast: September 23, 2026

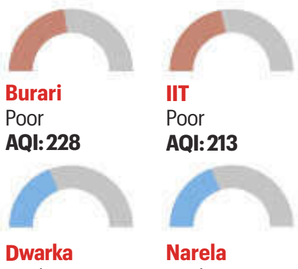
Mainly clear sky. No rain.

MAX: 34-36
1.6°C above normal

MIN: 23-25
0.1°C above normal

- *Sunrise: 6:10 AM (September 24)*
- *Sunset: 6:17 PM (September 23)*
- *Moonrise: 4:22 PM (September 23)*
- *Moonset: 3:40 AM (September 24)*

• AQI Tracker



Burari Poor **AQI: 228**

IIT Poor **AQI: 213**

Dwarka Moderate **AQI: 190**

Narela Moderate **AQI: 199**

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

418 units of counterfeit rabies vaccine worth Rs 2L seized in Delhi, supply traced to Kanpur

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, September 22

COUNTERFEIT RABIES vaccine worth Rs 2 lakh, seized by the Delhi Drugs Control (DDC) Department from a firm in Central Delhi's Bhagirath Palace, has been traced to a supplier in Kanpur, a government release stated on Monday.

Raids at three premises of the firm, on the direction of Delhi Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh, led to the seizure of 481 units of Purified Vero Cell Rabies Vaccine (Abhayrab).

The original manufacturer of the vaccine, Human Biologicals Institute, Telangana — the human health and vaccine division of Indian Immunologicals Limited (IIL) — has confirmed that the batch was counterfeit and had not been released by the company.

Of the seized stock, 120 vials were collected as legal samples for testing and sent to the Central Research Institute, Kasauli. The remaining 361 units, along with seven purchase invoices, were seized under relevant sections of the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940.

During questioning, the Bhagirath Palace firm told investigators that it had sourced the vaccine from an agency in Kanpur. The information was shared with the Uttar Pradesh State Drug Department, which raided two locations, including premises of the Kanpur agency, and confirmed it was indeed the source of the supply to Delhi.

The DDC department said it is now tracing the distribution network.

Speaking to The Indian Express, Health Minister Singh said the crackdown was not limited to rabies vaccines. "Since our government came to power, we have taken proactive action against spurious medicines, whether they are for cancer, rabies, or TB," he said. "These drugs affect public health, and that is why our policy against them is strict, without exception."

Singh further said, "We have a zero-tolerance policy for people selling spurious vaccines. Rabies is a fatal and serious disease, and we cannot compromise on the quality of the vaccine. Strict action will be taken against everyone involved in this, even suppliers outside Delhi."

On August 27, the Drugs Controller General of India had written to all state drug control departments, asking them to step up vigilance on the movement, distribution and availability of a misbranded vaccine batch.

IIL has said that every batch of Abhayrab undergoes independent government testing before release, and that vaccines supplied through authorised channels, including hospitals and licensed pharmacies, remain unaffected.

The case draws attention back to a burden India has struggled to shake off for decades. A 2025 study by the Indian Council of Medical Research, published in The Lancet Infectious Diseases and based on a nationwide survey of nearly 79,000 households, estimated 5,726 deaths occur due to human rabies in India each year.

Out on b'day, 17-yr-old girl gangraped at DDA park by 3 men who posed as cops with pistol

Was at park with friend; all 3 arrested

Alok Singh & Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 22

OUT TO celebrate her 17th birthday, a girl was allegedly gangraped by three men posing as police officers at a DDA park in Southeast Delhi on Monday evening, police said.

The three men, who were arrested on Tuesday, allegedly used a combination of police lingo, including 'Janab', and threats to convince the teenager and her 17-year-old male friend who accompanied her that they were dealing with police officers, before sexually assaulting her, police said.

The accused — Asif, Hemant and Mukesh, all in the 25-30 age group — were arrested in the morning. Police said Asif was injured in an encounter in Amar Colony, while the other two were arrested based on information provided during his questioning. While Asif worked at a mandi, Hemant is a lawyer and his brother Mukesh a BSc Mathematics student.

According to the police, the girl, a resident of Faridabad and a school student, and her friend, had gone to a temple to offer prayers on her birthday.

Around 7.30 pm, they were walking through the nearby DDA park when the three men allegedly approached them.

Police said the accused, who are friends and frequent the park, asked the teenagers to show their identity documents and questioned them about what they were doing there at that hour. They allegedly introduced themselves as policemen and threatened the teenagers with legal consequences.

"They asked the girl, who was out to celebrate her birthday, and the boy, what was their age. The accused told them that what they were doing in the park was wrong," a source in the police said.

The men allegedly addressed each other as "Janab", a term commonly used by Delhi Police personnel while formally addressing colleagues.

"They addressed one another as 'Janab' and claimed that their PCR Gypsy was parked outside the gate of the park. They also said that they knew lawyers," the source said.

"Further, Asif allegedly showed a pistol to the two teenagers," the source added.

The accused allegedly asked the teenagers for their parents' mobile numbers. When they refused, the men allegedly slapped the boy and forcibly separated him from the girl.

According to police, the three men then sexually assaulted the girl one after another while one of the accused held on to her friend.

Police said the boy subsequently made a PCR call around 8.45 pm, initially telling police that he and the girl had been assaulted by three policemen inside the park. Following this, a police team reached the spot and took the girl for a medical examination.

A case was registered under the POCSO Act and BNS sections dealing with gang rape of a person under 18, criminal conspiracy, voluntarily causing grievous hurt and criminal intimidation, police said.

DCP (Southeast) Vinit Kumar said police teams were formed to trace the accused.

Joint Commissioner of Police (Southern) Vijay Kumar said, "They told the teens that they knew what they were doing at the park, and that police action could be taken against them."

Police personnel patrol the DDA park with torches on Tuesday night. ABHINAV SAHA

Police personnel with the weapon recovered from the accused after an exchange of fire on Tuesday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

142 acres of darkness, 29 gates and gaps in security

Alok Singh, Mishal Mussaddique, Sakshi Chand & Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, September 22

AT 7.30 pm on Tuesday, the only sound cutting through the darkness of the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) park in South Delhi was a security guard's whistle.

"Please leave, the park will close at 8," he called out as he walked along a barely visible path. In one hand he carried a torch, in the other, a mobile phone. There was not a functioning lamp post in sight.

Barely 24 hours ago, a 17-year-old girl was allegedly gangraped at the park, in front of her male friend. Police said the three accused had allegedly taken advantage of the darkness and isolation of the stretch.

On Tuesday evening, little appeared to have changed.

The guard cabin near a gate, the closest entry point to the spot where the alleged incident took place, had no electricity. There were no CCTV cameras inside the park as well, police said. Most of the cameras at its entry gates are non-functional.

The park is spread across around 142 acres and has 29 gates, according to the DDA. Different sections are interconnected, with informal pathways. Damaged portions of its outer boundary also make it difficult to control entry and exit, the guards said.

Lamp posts, CCTVs don't work

One guard said around 300 lamp posts are installed across the park, but most did not work. "You cannot see a working single lamp post along this stretch," the guard added.

A little had changed since Monday except for the increased police presence, according to the guard.

"Since morning, the same kind of people have been moving around the park. The situation here is the same as it was yesterday," he said.

He then walked into the park, recording a video of the poorly lit area on his phone. His supervisor, he said, had instructed the guards to do so. "Perhaps it is because of yesterday's incident," he added.

Another guard said nine guards each were deployed during eight-hour shifts, with personnel stationed at the six main gates. A guard had been posted at the gate near which the alleged assault took place, but he was stationed at some distance from the crime spot, he said.

"Sometimes local police also do patrolling but not every day," he added. "Although we and sometimes police personnel are deployed at most of the park's main gates, its expansive boundary, damaged walls and several informal pathways continue to make it difficult to regulate entry and exit."

Concern of local residents

Nikhil Saxena, vice-president of the RWA of a residential colony located near the park, said residents had raised safety concerns for months. "The area is very huge. There is no patrolling. The colony shares a boundary with the park, and residents have reported bottles and stones being thrown from its side," he added.

Karan Aggarwal, a resident of another nearby society, raised similar concerns. "The park sees a footfall of 2,000 people daily. Earlier, a PCR van used to be there for patrolling, but that is not enough. What happened yesterday is not an isolated incident. People drink and consume drugs in the dark spots of the park. There are no strict checks."

A visitor to the park said, "Local people are afraid to enter the park in the evening because it is poorly lit and has become a hub for drug users and thieves," he said.

An elderly man, who was also at the park, added that police patrol in the evenings and at night, using torches to ask people to leave.

What DDA says and police rues

A DDA spokesperson, meanwhile, said its lighting installations were functional and inspected regularly. "DDA is also undertaking a comprehensive assessment of security manpower and deployment requirements, keeping in view the extensive area of the park and its 29 access points. Coordination with Delhi Police is being further strengthened to ensure enhanced patrolling and a prompt response to any suspicious activity or emergency situation," the spokesperson added.

According to Delhi Police officers, they had raised concerns regarding the park and the adjoining area several times, most recently in July. "We have pointed out that the area becomes pitch dark after sunset and lacks functioning lights... There have been multiple communications sent to the various agencies," an officer said.

The size of the park, he added, made patrolling difficult. "Even if patrolling is done, the mere size is so much that if you walk through one area, by the time you reach back the time taken is long."

Late Tuesday, police stepped up their presence. Around 8 pm, a team, including senior district officers, entered the park carrying batons and torches. They said they had started from Gate 1 and would patrol the interconnected sections.

"Security vigil will continue until late at night," an officer said.

Clothes they wore, a photograph & CCTV footage: How police traced the accused

Sakshi Chand & Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 22

A HEAVILY built man with stubble in a check shirt and jeans; another in a brown T-shirt and lower; and a third dressed in black T-shirt and lower. Also, the nickname they used for one another.

These details, recalled by the 16-year-old girl, became the first clues for police officers investigating the alleged gangrape at a DDA park in South Delhi. Her description led the officers to a photograph in police records, which helped them identify Asif.

His arrest and questioning, along with CCTV camera footage from the area, then helped police trace the two other accused, Hemant and Mukesh, officers said.

Police said they matched Asif's description against dossiers maintained by local police of criminals, anti-social elements and suspicious persons in the area.

"We have dossiers of criminals but also of anti-social elements and ruffians. Police staff who patrol in parks and in common areas click pictures of people who wander aimlessly. Asif was one such person whose picture had been clicked," a source in the police said.

Police personnel at the spot where an exchange of fire took place with an accused. PRAVEEN KHANNA

When she was shown the photograph, the girl identified him as Asif.

This led police to their first suspect. They traced Asif to Amar Colony and arrested him following a brief exchange of fire. Police said he was wearing the same clothes at the time – the ones the teenager had described him wearing during the incident.

Police said Asif opened fire at the team, firing three rounds despite being asked to surrender. One bullet allegedly hit the bulletproof jacket of Head Constable Rajesh. Police said the officer fired two rounds in self-defence, one of which hit Asif in his right leg. A firearm was also recovered from him, they added.

The investigation then moved to the two other accused based on Asif's questioning and CCTV footage from the area around the park.

Police said information provided by Asif led investigators to brothers Hemant and Mukesh, who lived in Shri Niwaspuri. Investigators said the CCTV footage showed the brothers walking near the area. Their clothes also allegedly matched the description given by the teenager.

A police team arrested them from their home soon after.

The three accused knew each other and would often walk around in the park, police said. Asif, who used to worked at a mandi near Srinivaspuri, had met Hemant, practising lawyer, and Mukesh, a BSc Mathematics student, a few months ago over a game of cricket.

Asif, who currently worked at the Okhla Sabzi mandi, is married and has a teenage daughter, said police.

Hemant allegedly used legal terminology while the three men posed as policemen and addressed one another as "Janab", police said. 'Janab' is a term commonly used by Delhi Police personnel while formally addressing their colleagues.

Police have recovered material evidence from the crime scene, including used condoms, which have been sent to the Forensic Science Laboratory for examination, officers said.

Hemant and Mukesh's parents live in Faridabad. Their father, advocate J R Dhankar, alleged that police took his sons from their home around 7 am without informing him of the reason.

"They were beaten up. We do not know the girl, and my sons have no connection with her either. This is a conspiracy to frame them in the case," Dhankar alleged, while standing outside Amar Colony police station where the case was lodged. Police have not commented on the allegations.

College near park raises safety concerns, says local pink police booth is often unmanned

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, September 22

THE ALLEGED gangrape of a 17-year-old inside a DDA park in South Delhi on Tuesday morning has heightened safety concerns among students, many of whom live in paying guest accommodations in the area.

A prominent women's college in the area cancelled all classes after 12 pm on Tuesday. For Wednesday, physical classes have been suspended, and teachers who are not participating in the Delhi University Teachers' Association's (DUTA) protest, along with guest faculty, have been asked to conduct their classes online.

DUTA is set to hold a march over vacancies in teaching posts and regularisation of long-serving ad-hoc and temporary faculty at 12 Delhi government-funded colleges.

Aaratrika Ghosh, a key member of the women college's Students' Council said students were anxious.

"Given how common incidents like these have become -- incidents of men staring down women, exposing their genitals in public, or in general being very creepy -- students are kind of in a panic mode, given that many of them live in PGs in the area," she added.

> ***The prominent women's college in the area suspended physical classes for Wednesday***

Students also expressed concerns about the pink police booth in the vicinity. Ghosh said students did not have confidence in the facility as it was often left unmanned.

The college administration said it had taken steps to strengthen security on campus and around its perimeter.

The Principal told *The Indian Express*, "The safety, security and well-being of our students is of paramount importance to us. Security personnel are deployed at all gates, and CCTV surveillance is being monitored and strengthened."

"We are in close coordination with the local police and have requested increased patrolling in the lanes adjoining the college, especially around the back gate and the parks in the vicinity," she added.

2020 DELHI RIOTS

1-week interim bail for Sharjeel Imam to attend cousin wedding

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 22

A DELHI court on Tuesday granted Sharjeel Imam a week's interim bail in the "larger conspiracy case" linked to the 2020 Northeast Delhi riots to attend his cousin's wedding.

Imam will be on bail from October 4 to October 10.

The student activist has been lodged in Tihar Jail for six years in relation to the case lodged by the Special Cell under the stringent anti-terror law.

"The report as filed by the IO shows that the marriage of Danish Imam and Fahad Imam, cousins of the applicant, have been verified, which is going to be solemnised on 04.10.2026 and 07.10.2026 respectively. Considering the fact that this is only the second application of the applicant for interim bail, and that too for the purpose of attending the marriage of his real cousins, the court deems it appropriate to grant him the desired relief," said Additional Sessions Judge Sameer Bajpai of Karkardooma Court in an order dated September 22.

"Application is accordingly allowed and the applicant is granted interim bail for seven days i.e. from 04.10.2026 to 10.10.2026 on furnishing of a personal bond for Rs 50,000/- with one surety in the like amount," he added.

The judge imposed certain conditions on Imam such as not contacting any witness of the case, not using social media, and not interacting with media persons among others.

"Further, during the interim bail period, the applicant shall not meet any other person except his family members, relatives and friends... he shall remain at places where the ceremonies of marriages will take place and the guests in the marriage will stay," ASJ Bajpai said.

Woman 'chased', 'harrassed' by two youths in Saket; probe on

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, September 22

A 21-YEAR-OLD woman was allegedly chased and harassed by two unidentified motorcycle-borne men who also pushed her off her scooter near Panchsheel Metro station on the intervening night of September 11 and 12, police said on Tuesday.

The woman allegedly sustained serious injuries in the incident, police said, adding that an FIR has been registered and a probe is underway.

In her complaint submitted to the Hauz Khas police on September 15, the woman, identified as Gauri Kashyap, said she had stepped out of her office in Saket around midnight and was on her way home when the incident took place.

She alleged that two men, who appeared to be in their twenties, started teasing and passing remarks at her before starting to chase her.

According to her complaint, the men also allegedly hit her scooter with their motorcycle, after which she lost control, tripped and skidded on the road for 100-150 metres.

Kashyap alleged that the men subsequently fled. She said a passer-by arranged medical help. According to her complaint, an ambulance was called via Blinkit app.

She said some of her colleagues also rushed to the spot after being informed about the incident.

According to the complaint, she was taken to Max Hospital, Saket. She said she was later shifted to Medanta Hospital, Noida.

DCP (South) Anant Mittal said a PCR call regarding the incident was received at Hauz Khas police station around 1 am on September 12. When the police reached the spot, the woman had already been taken to the hospital.

Police said the woman is currently in her hometown and will join the probe once back in Delhi.

72nd NATIONAL FILM AWARDS CEREMONY NEAR THE STATUE OF UNITY IN GUJARAT

Do not endorse harmful products: President's message to film actors

Points out that stars are those that give & spread light

Leena Misra
Ektanagar (Narmada), September 22

PRESIDENT DROUPADI Murmu called for greater participation of women on the jury as she presented the National Film Awards for 2024 across over 40 categories on Tuesday.

The President also appealed to film stars to not endorse products that are harmful to health, saying, "Stars are those that give and spread light."

Celebrities from the film industry across the country attended the ceremony in Ektanagar, the tourist destination in Gujarat around the Statue of Unity in Narmada district. The grand event was held in a special dome erected against the backdrop of the 182-metre tall statue of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel after whom the dam on the river Narmada is also named.

President Murmu presented the awards to the winners in categories including feature and non-feature films, language films, biopics and documentaries.

Veteran actor Anant Nag, who was accompanied by his wife Gayatri, received the country's highest film honour, the Dadasaheb Phalke Award.

Actor Yami Gautam and her filmmaker husband Aditya Dhar received the award for Best Feature Film for '*Article 370*'.

Among the awarded films were one on the life of Veer Savarkar in which Randeep Hooda plays the main protagonist, and one on the making of the Statue of Unity.

President Murmu noted that "many women were among the awardees", and said, "I would wish that every regional jury ensures the participation of women, I saw that many women got recognised for their films today; therefore, there should be more women on the jury. "In any field, only when the perspective of women is included does it create a vision for entire humanity."

She also said that successful film artists and the roles they played were emulated by "crores of children and youth", and appealed to artists not to "endorse substances that are harmful to health".

"*Star wahi hai jo roshni deta hai, star wahi hai jo roshni phailaay*," the President said.

The President also mentioned the first Santali film to have won an award in the 72nd edition of the Awards. '*Angen*' (Invisible), has been directed by Ravi Raj Murmu, a filmmaker from Jharkhand.

President Murmu, who is herself Santali, said, "With this film, not only a brilliant film gets a boost but also our cultural diversity and social inclusivity." The short film was recognised for "transforming folklore into cinematic poetry".

The President also appealed to those in the film industry to "give respect and social security" to the smallest labourers and artists contributing to the "creative economy".

This is the first time that the National Film Awards ceremony has been held outside Delhi.

Union Minister for Railways and Information & Broadcasting Ashwini Vaishnaw said taking the film awards to destinations outside of the national capital was modelled after the G20, which was held across states and Union Territories. "That was an example of the way in which our country's rich and diverse cultural heritage can be showcased," the Minister said.

Vaishnaw invited states and Union territories to select important tourist destinations where the next ceremony could be hosted, suggesting that holding the ceremony outside the national capital is set to become a trend.

"We have gathered at the world's tallest statue, which gives a huge opportunity to the film world to come and experience this beautiful place, the heritage and the historic events that happened in our country when the British were thrown out," he said.

"I am giving a call to all states and Union Territories to select one of the most important tourist destinations in your state and Union Territory and tell us what improvements you will make in them, and then your destination will be selected where the NFA will be held. This way, we will be able to visit some of the most important tourist destinations in our country," the Minister said, adding that the presence of film stars at these places would promote them.

Among the other stars present at the ceremony were Mammootty (Best Actor for Malayalam film '*Bramayugam*'), Kartik Aaryan for Hindi film '*Chandu Champion*', and Dhanush for the Tamil film '*Raayan*'. '*Bhangaar*' won the award for the Best Non-Feature Film, and '*Ramnami*' for Best Documentary.

Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel invited filmmakers to come to Gujarat, and mentioned the only Gujarati film to get an award: '*Maaran*' (Kill) directed by Ahmedabad-based Abhishek Jain.

Governor Acharya Devvrat noted that films were a way to take the world out of "stress and depression".

A STARRY NIGHT

(Clockwise from above) President Droupadi Murmu presents the Dadasaheb Phalke Award to veteran actor Anant Nag during the ceremony in Ektanagar on Tuesday; Yami Gautam receives award for best actress in *Article 370;* Mammootty and Kartik Aaryan bag the 'Best Actor in a Leading Role' award for *Bramayugam* and *Chandu Champion*, respectively. PTI, ANI

Elections for 11 RS seats in UP, Uttarakhand to be held on Oct 16

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, September 22

THE BIENNIAL elections for 11 Rajya Sabha seats — 10 from Uttar Pradesh and one from Uttarakhand — will be held on October 16, the Election Commission announced on Tuesday.

A bypoll for an Upper House seat from West Bengal will also be held on the day, it said.

Of the 11 seats, 10 (nine from UP and one from Uttarakhand) are due to fall vacant as the terms of the current MPs will expire on November 25. Meanwhile, one UP seat is vacant after BJP MP Dinesh Sharma resigned on September 11 to take charge as L-G of Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

Of the 10 Upper House seats from UP, eight are held by the BJP. The SP and the BSP hold one seat each. The lone seat in Uttarakhand is that of BJP MP Naresh Bansal. The other UP seats will be vacated by Arun Singh, Geeta alias Chandraprabha, Neeraj Shekhar, Brijlal, Ram Gopal Yadav, Ramji, B L Verma, Seema and Hardeep Singh Puri.

The West Bengal seat was left vacant after TMC leader Rukmini Malik tendered her resignation just days after her party's landslide defeat in the recently-concluded Assembly polls.

To be sure, the BJP is not only expected to retain its existing nine Rajya Sabha seats (eight in UP and one in Uttarakhand) in the biennial polls, the party's 2026 sweep of West Bengal means it will add yet another berth to its solo tally of 116 in the 245-Member House. The SP, too, has the numbers to retain its current seat, in addition to claiming another.

With 256 and 101 MLAs, respectively, the BJP and the SP hold sway in the 403-strong UP Assembly. The remainder of the 398 occupied seats here comprises 40 legislators from NDA constituents such as Apna Dal (S), which has 13, and the RLD (9), in addition to legislators from smaller parties.

However, the BJP and NDA have an edge over the Opposition since a party will require the support of at least 36 MLAs in the Lower HOuse for each Rajya Sabha seat from Uttar Pradesh.

As of now, the BJP-led NDA has a combined strength of 150 MPs in the 245-Member Upper House. Non-NDA parties account for over 100 MPs in the Rajya Sabha. There are also fence-sitters among the fold, like the DMK, BJD, YSR and BRS, which account for eight, five, four and five seats, respectively.

Keralam recommends probe against Pinarayi in case over daughter's firm

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, September 22

IN A significant political move, the Congress-led Keralam government has recommended a probe against CPI(M) Politburo member and former chief minister Pinarayi Vijayan, his daughter T Veena, and son-in-law Muhammed Riyas under the Prevention of Corruption Act in connection with a money laundering case allegedly involving Veena's IT firm.

Earlier this month, the Enforcement Directorate, which is probing allegations that Veena's IT firm Exalogic Solutions received illegal payments from Kochi-based Cochin Minerals and Rutile Limited when the CPI(M) was in power, submitted a report to the state police asking it to register an FIR against Vijayan and others.

Subsequently, the Home Department under the Congress government sought the legal opinion of Advocate General K Jaju Babu, who in turn gave the green signal that there is enough ground to proceed with a case under the Prevention of Corruption Act.

The Home Department's decision came after Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala held discussions with Chief Minister V D Satheesan. Sources at the Home Minister's office said,

Former CM Pinarayi Vijayan

"The crime branch wing of the state police will conduct a preliminary probe into the matter based on the ED report. A decision on registering an FIR under the Prevention of Corruption Act will be taken only after the preliminary probe."

The ED has alleged that Kochi-based CMRL made payments to Veena's Exalogic Solutions despite the latter not providing any services. The Income Tax Department unearthed the alleged illegal payments, made during Vijayan's first term.

The ED, which claims Veena's firm received Rs 2.78 crore in the guise of IT consultancy payments, had searched Vijayan's premises in May. The agency also searched eight premises linked to local CPI(M) leaders in Kozhikode district, where Riyas hails from.

Following the searches, the ED claimed it found evidence of money transfers through hawala routes.

As per the ED report to the police, Vijayan allegedly collected Rs 3.28 crore from CMRL as a bribe through Veena. To substantiate this claim, the ED cited a purported admission by CMRL's former chief financial officer. The ED claims that Riyas helped transfer the bribe money to Dubai through Veena and others.

The ED has also sought registration of an FIR against senior employees of Exalogic Solutions.

Vijayan has denied the allegations, asserting that his hands are clean.

Riyas, who is also a CPI(M) leader, said, "We are not afraid of any probe. The script is good. The innocent will remain innocent, irrespective of probes at any level. The issue will be fought legally and politically."

Centre doubles validity of green clearances for ports to 20 years

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, September 22

THE CENTRE has notified a major relaxation in the country's environmental clearance process, doubling validity of clearance granted to ports and harbours to a minimum of 20 years, with room for two five-year extensions subject to conditions.

The notification, published on Monday, amended the Environment Impact Assessment (EIA) notification 2006, which governs the country's environmental clearance process.

Environmental clearance for port and harbour projects can now be extended by five years beyond the 20-year period, subject to appraisal committees reviewing the adequacy of existing environmental safeguards. A further five-year extension may be granted in "deserving cases" if the project remains non-operational.

The sectoral expert appraisal committee or state-level expert appraisal committee can recommend the second extension after examination and subject to environmental safeguards, the amendment stated.

Under the EIA Notification, 2006, new projects in specified sectors require prior environmental clearance (EC). Project expansion, modernisation, capacity additions and product-mix changes beyond specified thresholds also require EC, based on environmental impact assessments, public hearings where applicable, and final appraisal by expert committees.

The amendment follows requests from industry and the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways to rationalise the framework, under which environmental clearance for ports and harbours was valid for 10 years, with a one-year extension. Projects must thereafter seek fresh clearance.

"The ministry has received a request to rationalise the validity period of the environmental clearances granted to Ports and Harbours, which is currently valid for an initial period of ten years, which may be extended for a further period of one year," the notification stated.

Sharad Pawar calls for protection of Tata Group's legacy, says Trust's 66% stake design 'deliberate'

Alok Deshpande
Mumbai, September 22

NATIONALIST CONGRESS Party (NCP-SP) chief Sharad Pawar has jumped into the Tata Sons IPO row, saying the need of the hour is to protect its legacy.

He said the rights given to the Trust-nominated directors, including a say in the appointment of the chairman and other key decisions, should be honoured.

Pawar said the Articles of Association (AoA) of Tata Sons govern the company even from the view of corporate governance.

"The Articles of the Group give the majority owner's nominees a decisive voice in choosing the Chairman, and that agreement should be respected, as that is the very design of the Tata Group. We must protect the Group that devoted itself to the development of India," he said.

NCP-SP chief Sharad Pawar

"Shri Jamsetji Tata's vision, carried forward by Sir Dorabji and Sir Ratan Tata, was that wealth created by the enterprise returns to society. Their holdings were placed in Trusts precisely so that no individual would own the group, and the majority stakeholder of the business would be Trusts dedicated to charitable objectives. Therefore, the ownership structure of Tata Sons embraces philanthropy," Pawar's statement read.

Pawar said that operating companies sit under Tata Sons, and Sir Ratan Tata Trust and Sir Dorabji Tata Trust, with allied trusts, own about 66% of Tata Sons. "This design is deliberate. The dividends fund public good. They flow into health, education and research," he added.

On 17 September 2026, the Tata Sons board voted 4-1 to reappoint N Chandrasekaran as Executive Chairman for another stint of five years from February 2027, and approved steps toward public listing of Tata Sons. Noel Tata, Chairman of Tata Trusts, voted against both; the Trusts' second nominee, Mr Venu Srinivasan, voted in favour.

"The Tata Group is a national institution and its charitable ownership must be protected," the veteran leader said.

G.B.PANT INSTITUTE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY
(An Autonomous Institution of Government of Uttarakhand) PAURI GARHWAL-246194

Corrigendum

This is with regard to an advertisement published by our institute on **20/09/2026.** Kindly note that the reference number should be read as **01/Admn./2026** instead of **222/Admn./2026.** The rest of the advertisement remains the same.

Director

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
INSTITUTE FOR DESIGN OF ELECTRICAL MEASURING INSTRUMENTS, MUMBAI
वैद्युतिक मापन उपयंत्र अभिकल्प संस्थान, मुंबई
Government Certificate course on
Artificial Intelligence for BI and Business Analytics
Course Duration 5 Days
Course Timing- 7.00 PM to 8.30 PM
ऑनलाइन ONLINE
Course Date 5 to 9 Oct.2026
Email ID: training@idemi.org Website: www.idemi.org
Contents : Data Fundamentals & ◆ Databases Data Warehousing & ETL ◆ Data Visualization & Dashboards ◆ Descriptive & Diagnostic Analytics Predictive Analytics & Machine Learning Basics ◆ Business KPIs & Metrics ◆ Data Governance & Quality ◆ BI Tools & Platforms ◆ Data Modeling & Star Schemas ◆ AI in Business Intelligence
With hands on practical
Fees-3000+18 % GST(Fees are not refundable)
for whom- Business professionals, Logistics managers, E-commerce entrepreneurs, Students and supply chain analysts.
After Successful Completion Certificate Will be Issued
Scan QR Code for Registration & Fees Payment
Contact-9403566219,8007765693,8291413843

EXPRESS Careers

Nanaji Deshmukh Veterinary Science University, Jabalpur (M.P.)

2nd Counselling and Admission Notice for 2026-27

Applications are invited for admission in Bachelor of Veterinary Science & Animal Husbandry (B. V. Sc. & A.H.) and Bachelor of Fishery Science (B. F. Sc.) degree courses for the session 2026-27 under following quota seats:

1. **Non Resident Indian (NRI) seats**
2. **Foreign national category seats**
3. **For wards of Kashmiri Migrants and Kashmiri Pandits / Kashmiri Hindu Families (Non-migrants) living in Kashmir valley**
4. **For students from Union Territories or Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh**

For details visit University website. **www.ndvsu.org** The date for submission of application and physical presence is **29th September, 2026**

No. 3532/2026 Date 22/09/2026 **Registrar**

Nanaji Deshmukh Veterinary Science University, Jabalpur (Madhya Pradesh)

No 3531/ NDVSU/2026 **Date 22/09/2026**

Notice for Spot Counseling (Offline) for admission in B.V.Sc. & A.H. / B.F.Sc. 2026-27

Spot Counseling (Offline) for admission in remaining vacant seats (free and payment) of B.V. Sc. & A.H. and B.F.Sc. degree programmes 2026-27 will be held as under :-

Degree programme	Date	Qualifying examinations	Venue	Time
B.V.Sc. & A.H. (5 ½ years)	30.09 2026	NEET (UG) 2026	Auditorium, Veterinary College, South Civil Lines, Jabalpur (M.P.)	09.30 a.m.
B.F.Sc. (4 years)	30.09.2026	NEET (UG) 2026/ CUET 2026		

• For details, rules and vacant seats visit University website: **www.ndvsu.org/ https://ndvsu.mponline.gov.in**

Registrar

ICAR-INDIAN VETERINARY RESEARCH INSTITUTE
IZATNAGAR–243 122 (UP) INDIA
Website : www.ivri.nic.in

Walk in Interview

A walk-in interview is to be held on **12th October 2026, from 10:00 a.m.** onwards at the **Veterinary Public Health Division of ICAR-IVRI, Izatnagar** for **one (01) position of Young Professional-II and one (01) position of Young Professional-I under the ICAR-funded 'AINP-One Health' project**. For qualification and other details, candidates may visit the Institute website at: **www.ivri.nic.in**

बीआरआईसी बायोटेक्नोलोजी विभाग का संगठन BRIC a DBT Organization
आर जी सी बी RGCB

BIOTECHNOLOGY RESEARCH AND INNOVATION COUNCIL (BRIC) - RAJIV GANDHI CENTRE FOR BIOTECHNOLOGY (RGCB)

A Biotechnology Institute of the Government of India, Department of Biotechnology (DBT), Ministry for Science & Technology, Thycaud PO Thiruvananthapuram 695014, Kerala, India
www.rgcb.res.in

ROLLING ADVERTISEMENT FOR FACULTY SCIENTIST POSITIONS

No. RGCB/Advt./SCI/01/2026 September 01, 2026

The Rajiv Gandhi Centre for Biotechnology (BRIC-RGCB) is an autonomous National Institute under the Biotechnology, Research & Innovation Council (BRIC), Department of Biotechnology, Government of India. The mandate of the institute is discovery, innovation and translation in biotechnology and disease biology.

BRIC-RGCB invites applications for the following Faculty positions that are currently vacant:

1. **Scientist C (Number of positions –UR-1, OBC-2, SC-1)**
2. **Scientist EII (Number of positions – UR-1, SC-1)**
3. **Scientist F (Number of positions – UR-1, OBC-1)**

Complete details including minimum qualifications, experience and age limit including profile of work is posted on the institute website: **www.rgcb.res.in**. Eligible and interested scientists can submit their applications online, **(https://rgcb.res.in/Faculty Position)** along with uploading of all necessary documents. The applications will be accepted throughout the year and will be scrutinized and evaluated in batches. The last date for receipt of applications for the present quarter is **November 30, 2026.**

Sd/-
Director

The Indian EXPRESS Classifieds FROM ANYTHING TO EVERYTHING

EXPRESS EDUCATION

ANTHRO
Batches Start: Oct 12, 21 (9.30 am Fresh Batch)
Recordings Available for Online Students
TARGET 300+ ?
ASK VAID SIR How?
Free Seminar on Sep 25 12 pm
Scan QR to Register
IAS 2025
Harsh Nehara AIR 74 303/500
5 OF OUR CLASSROOM STUDENTS SCORED 290+
VAID'S ICS, DELHI
to know more visit www.vaidsics.com or call 953 800 1600

Contact for Advt. Booking: M/s Friends Publicity Service
(M): 9212665841, 9212008155

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL

For A Change

IN AN unusual courtroom appearance, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta on Tuesday defended the Congress-led Karnataka government's stand in a plea challenging the state's Premium Floor Area Ratio (FAR) scheme before the Supreme Court. The SG or any Central government lawyer can appear for a party as long as the case is not against the Union. Mehta argued for the Greater Bengaluru Authority, which is chaired by Chief Minister D K Shivakumar, before a bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant that urban spaces have to expand vertically. However, the bench agreed to intervene in the issue.

Wait for 'Achchey Din'

SEVERAL LEADERS and workers of different political parties have joined the Samajwadi Party in recent days, giving a morale booster to the party ahead of the 2027 UP Assembly elections. Now, party president Akhilesh Yadav has put a temporary freeze on any new induction. Sources said Yadav has communicated to SP leaders that prominent leaders will join the party during Navratri, starting October 11, when there will be "achchey din" and "shubh din" (auspicious days). The idea behind the decision is that if big leaders join the SP on auspicious days, they would be more fruitful for the party in the elections, said the sources.

Confident of BJP win in UP in 2027, says Nitin Nabin

Muzaffarnagar: BJP president Nitin Nabin on Tuesday expressed confidence that his party would retain power in UP for a third consecutive term in the 2027 Assembly polls, citing the response of party workers and people during his ongoing visit to western UP.

"The sense I get from the ground is very positive. We are confident of BJP win in 2027," Nabin told media in Muzaffarnagar after being given a welcome by party workers and leaders. He travelled by road from Meerut to Saharanpur via Muzaffarnagar. **PTI**

ON SIDELINES OF UNGA

Global order is under stress, we need reformed multilateralism: Jaishankar

Says '4F crisis of fuel, food, finance and fertiliser' needs guardrails

Divya A
New Delhi, September 22

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and European Council President Antonio Costa during the P4M Summit in New York. PTI

UNDERLINING THAT the global order is "under stress" due to extreme competition and geopolitical tensions, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar has called for "reformed multilateralism". He has said that the "4F crisis of fuel, food, fertiliser and finance" needs "frameworks and guardrails".

His comments come days after US President Donald Trump signed the Russia sanctions Bill, giving himself the authority to impose tariffs of up to 100% on countries, including India and China, that continue to buy Russian oil and gas.

Jaishankar was speaking at the first-ever 'Partners for Multilateralism, International Law, Peace & Prosperity (P4M)' Summit held on the margins of the 81st session of the UN General Assembly (UNGA) on Monday. India co-sponsored the inaugural multilateralism summit at the UN, along with Australia, Barbados, Brazil, Canada, the European Union and Kenya.

"India is glad to join as a co-sponsor. We meet at a time when the global order is under stress," he said, adding that for some decades now, the world has witnessed a steady rebalancing, which was a long-expected structural evolution.

"However, extreme competition, geopolitical tensions and actual conflicts have given this an entirely different character. If left unchecked, it would call into question the very spirit of international cooperation, and that is why it is so essential that multilateralism asserts itself strongly at this juncture," he said.

Jaishankar told the summit that where ongoing conflicts are concerned, specific dimensions could be addressed even while nations strive for a broader peace. "The '4F' crisis of fuel, food, fertiliser and finance cannot be left to itself. When new capabilities and concerns arise, there is a very powerful case for frameworks and guardrails. Where there is a threat of chokepoint dominance and disruption, de-risking and diversifying must be encouraged... And where there is a compelling cause or a powerful case, the like-minded must have the confidence to come together."

Underlining that multilateralism would be best served when international law, rules and norms are scrupulously observed, he said, "For multilateralism to forge ahead, its advocacy and its practice must both be strengthened. Reformed multilateralism is thus essential. More participative deliberations and more transparent decision-making are both overdue."

He also underlined that at stake are "very real issues", including the future of peace and international security, climate justice, countering terrorism and strengthening supply chains, adding that all depend on a "will to cooperate".

Jaishankar was joined by the summit's cosponsors, including President of the European Council Antonio Costa, President of Kenya William Ruto, Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese and Barbados Prime Minister Mia Mottley.

Meanwhile, Jaishankar also participated in the first foreign ministers' meeting of India with the four-member Visegrad group of Central European countries, calling it a "new historic occasion". The Visegrad Group (V4) is a cultural and political alliance of the Czech Republic, Hungary, Poland and Slovakia that aims at advancing co-operation in military, economic, cultural and energy affairs.

At their first meeting, India and the four-member group agreed to step up political, economic and defence cooperation. The group backed India's inclusion as a permanent member of the UNSC, with Slovakia's Foreign Minister Juraj Blanar saying India "must be at the table" as a permanent member. Jaishankar also held several bilaterals — including with his counterparts from Ukraine, France, Moldova and Hungary.

Jaishankar's engagements on Monday commenced with a meeting with French Foreign Minister Jean-Noel Barrot. "Regional and global issues, specifically the Ukraine and Gulf crisis were discussed. Also exchanged views on multilateral issues, including the reform of the UN Security Council," he wrote on X.

Ukraine's Minister of Foreign Affairs Andrii Sybiha, after meeting Jaishankar, said they discussed peace efforts, bilateral cooperation and international developments. "We spoke about the situation in the Black Sea and its market implications. Restoring freedom of navigation is critical for global food security. Ukraine is ready to play a constructive role and we value India's engagement," he said.

On September 26, Jaishankar will address world leaders at the General Debate from the UNGA podium.

E. EXPLAINED

Focus on UNSC

The multilateralism summit comes at a time when the 15-nation UN Security Council remains deeply polarised, with sharp divisions among its five permanent, veto-wielding members — China, France, Russia, UK and the US. New Delhi has been pitching for a seat at the UNSC to reflect the realities of today's world.

Bangladesh Foreign Secy Asad Alam Siam set to be next High Commissioner to India

Divya A
New Delhi, September 22

Bangladesh Foreign Secretary Asad Alam Siam

BANGLADESH FOREIGN Secretary Asad Alam Siam, who has earlier served as Dhaka's envoy to Washington, is set to be the next high commissioner to New Delhi, sources said on Tuesday. The official procedure between New Delhi and Dhaka in this regard is underway.

This comes as the current Bangladesh High Commissioner to New Delhi, Riaz Hamidullah, moves to Geneva as Bangladesh's permanent representative to the UN Office in September-end. He was appointed as the envoy to India in February 2025 — during the interim administration headed by Professor Mohammed Yunus — navigating one of the toughest phases in bilateral ties in the wake of former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina's ouster.

It is learnt that Dhaka had moved the proposal for Siam's appointment as the new envoy in July this year, and the agreement was cleared on Tuesday morning — after the process lasted a little over two months. As per diplomatic norms, the host government has to approve the agreement for the appointment of a foreign ambassador.

Earlier, India had given the assent to Hamidullah's appointment to New Delhi after two months and 20 days, according to sources.

Siam, who joined the diplomatic service in 1995, has served in Bangladeshi missions in Bangkok, Jakarta, Manchester and Milan, besides being Bangladesh's Permanent Representative to the UN Offices in Vienna and to OPEC Fund. He is known as the ears of the present dispensation in Dhaka, helmed by BNP's (Bangladesh Nationalist Party) Tarique Rahman.

Siam's appointment has taken place against the backdrop of negotiations between New Delhi and Dhaka for a possible India visit by Rahman sometime in November — his first bilateral visit here since being elected the Bangladesh Prime Minister in February this year.

Earlier, India had extended an invitation to Rahman as the Chair of the (BIMSTEC Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation) grouping, to attend an outreach session at the recent BRICS Summit. However, the visit could not take place over tough exchanges that broke out after Hasina had held a virtual press interaction on August 5.

In April this year, India had appointed former Union Minister Dinesh Trivedi, a veteran politician from West Bengal, as India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh. Both the sides are making efforts to reset bilateral ties — especially in the wake of demands for the extradition of Hasina, who has been in Delhi since August 2024 after being ousted following widespread protests in Bangladesh.

Vijay breaks bread with school kids as TN expands free breakfast scheme

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, September 22

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay with school students, in Chennai on Tuesday. PTI

TAMIL NADU Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Tuesday expanded the state's free breakfast programme to include students from Classes 6 to 8 in government and government-aided schools in the scheme. With this, about 15.30 lakh children have joined the welfare programme that began four years ago with primary school students.

Vijay launched the expanded Perunthalaivar Kamarajar Breakfast Scheme at Chennai Middle School in Gandhigramam, Thiruvanmiyur, where he sat with students for breakfast. Following this, ministers inaugurated the scheme in their respective regions across the state. The menu comprises nutritious staples such as *upma*, *khichdi* and *pongal*, along with *daal* and *sambar*, with millet-based options served twice a week.

The state government described the scheme as one that brings together nutrition, attendance and learning, while providing support for children's education and social advancement. "Integrating students' physical health, nutrition, school attendance, and learning, the expanded Kamarajar Breakfast Scheme-designed to further strengthen the foundation of school education-will serve as a great support for the educational journey of students and for social progress," it said.

As per the government, the scheme's expansion covers 7,537 additional government and government-aided schools and has been allocated an additional Rs 217.63 crore this financial year. With the latest expansion, about 34.64 lakh students in classes 1 to 8 across 44,984 government and government-aided schools will receive breakfast, at a total allocation of Rs 724 crore.

The programme has grown substantially since 2022, when the then DMK government under CM M K Stalin introduced the CM's Breakfast Scheme for children in classes 1 to 5.

The breakfast scheme is the latest chapter in a much longer history of state-supported school meals in Tamil Nadu. Its roots go back to 1922, when P Theagaraya Chetty, then president of the Corporation of Chennai and a Justice Party leader, introduced meals for underprivileged children in selected Chennai schools.

Karnataka wants Kasturirangan report reviewed

Express News Service
Bengaluru, September 22

THE KARNATAKA Assembly on Tuesday passed a resolution rejecting the Kasturirangan Report, which outlines conservation pathways for the Western Ghats, in its present form. It has also sought a review of the Report's seventh draft, which lists 20,668 sq km across 1,449 villages in 10 districts as ecologically sensitive areas.

The decision came on Day 2 of a special session convened to discuss the Report and the prevailing drought situation in the state. Speaking at the Assembly, CM D K Shivakumar said that several legislators have alleged that the report was based merely on satellite data and was "unscientific". To assess the true extent of the forests, ground truthing and physical survey are essential, he said.

Taking cue from Kerala, Karnataka decided to form a high-level panel to monitor the survey. It is to be headed by a retired SC judge. An all-party delegation to the Centre will also meet PM Modi and Union Forest Minister Bhupender Yadav to discuss the issue.

ED's National Herald case cannot stem from a private complaint, say Sonia, Rahul

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 22

CONGRESS LEADERS Sonia Gandhi and Rahul Gandhi, opposing the ED's plea in the alleged National Herald case before the Delhi High Court, said that it was the "single instance in the country where a department has proceeded on the basis of a private complaint".

In December 2025, the ED had moved the HC challenging a trial court's judgment a day after it was pronounced. The trial court had refused to take cognisance of the ED's chargesheet primarily on the grounds that PMLA contemplates complaints by investigating officers from a probe agency, and not a private complaint from individuals.

In the National Herald case, which accused the Gandhis of money laundering among other charges, the complaint had stemmed from former BJP MP Subramanian Swamy. The Gandhis, in their written responses filed before the HC on September 18, said that "there is no question of a complaint by a private person for an offence... enabling the ED to assume jurisdiction".

They flagged the necessity of a predicate offence for carrying on with ED proceedings, as is stipulated under the PMLA Act. The Gandhis also argued that because a money laundering trial must follow a separate legal track from a scheduled offence trial, the ED can't use a private complaint as "a foundational instrument for investigation".

They also stated that the ED's stance over the years was that "it couldn't launch money laundering proceedings against one company, in absence of (predicate offence) FIR," and that "in the absence of FIR, cognisance under PMLA couldn't be taken".

● AS THE LoP WAS REACHING OUT TO YOUTH IN INDORE, DELHI'S GEN Z DEALT A BLOW TO THE PARTY IN DUSU POLLS, HIGHLIGHTING AGAIN HOW IT HAS NOT EVEN BEGUN THE HARD WORK OF BUILDING THE ORGANISATION

Rahul's *Chhatron ki Goonj* strikes a chord, why Gen Z gives Cong a reality check

THE NEERJA CHOWDHURY COLUMN

WEEKLY INSIGHT INTO WHAT'S CHANGING IN NATIONAL POLITICS – AND WHY

Neerja Chowdhury
New Delhi, September 22

LEADER OF Opposition (LoP) in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi walked up and down the stage in Indore, mike in hand, thousands of young men and women in the audience applauding as he told them what it meant to be a student — one who asks questions — as opposed to the "system" controlled by what he called a handful responsible for people's woes.

This was the fifth edition of the Congress leader's 'Chattron ki Goonj' event aimed at engaging with students. PR agencies which mount such events for political parties could manufacture a response for them only up to a point. Gen Z in Indore — as also in Pune, Dehradun, Prayagraj and Kota earlier — seemed to be looking at Rahul with new eyes. And he, too, is riding on youth sentiments unleashed by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP)'s protests at Delhi's Jantar Mantar two months ago.

Cong's DUSU debacle

Even as Rahul was reaching out to the youth of Madhya Pradesh, Delhi's Gen Z delivered a different message to his Congress party. The RSS's student wing, ABVP, bagged three of the four posts in the Delhi University Students Union (DUSU) polls. The DUSU is not an ordinary student body. Over the years, it has catapulted many leaders to national politics, who include late Arun Jaitley and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta of the BJP and Ajay Maken, Alka Lamba and Ragini Nayak of the Congress.

In June-July, Delhi was rocked by the Gen Z protests over alleged irregularities in the exam and education system as well as unemployment, which culminated in the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as Union Education Minister. However, in the DUSU polls, Gen Z students chose to re-elect the ABVP to the key posts of the president, secretary and joint secretary.

The question is, how did the Congress lose the plot in the DUSU polls when Rahul had succeeded in cornering the Narendra Modi government through the monsoon session of Parliament, during which he even sat on a dharna outside the Prime Minister's house to press for Pradhan's resignation.

Congress student wing NSUI drew a blank in the DUSU polls, where last year it had won the vice-president's position. The party can argue that this time it nominated a tribal candidate, Vijay Shankar Meena, for the DUSU president in what has been a Jat versus Gujjar battle for two decades, and that Meena registered a 78% increase in votes as compared to the party's figure in 2025. While this was in sync with Rahul's new politics of championing the cause of the SCs, STs and OBCs, the point remains that Gen Z is not a monolith but is also a section marked with caste faultlines.

Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi addresses the 'Chhatron ki Goonj' programme in Indore last week. PTI FILE

The Congress's rout in the DUSU polls was aggravated by its loss in the V-P's election, which indicated the party's internal rifts. The party is said to have "denied" the V-P ticket to Deepanshu Shokeen, who then contested as an Independent, scoring a resounding win over his ABVP rival Ishu Maurya.

Shokeen, a Jat youth, whose father is a DTC bus conductor and his mother an Anganwadi worker, undertook a spirited campaign barefoot to demand hostels for students in view of the collapse of a private PG building at Delhi's Satya Niketan in which seven persons, including five DU students, were killed. It created resonance among students, reflecting their desire for fresh faces in politics even without any organisation.

The Congress also allegedly betrayed "nepotism" in the DUSU polls, giving its ticket to Veer Chatrath — son of Manish Chatrath, the in-charge of the AICC headquarters — for the V-P post, who finished a distant third. Manish Chatrath was said to have a significant say in the DUSU ticket allotment along with Kanhaiya Kumar, AICC in-charge of the NSUI.

Gen Z factor

In the wake of student protests, Modi has also stepped up his Gen Z outreach, even through reels on Instagram. In an unprecedented move, the government also agreed to withdraw all FIRs against students (at the instance of the Supreme Court) who participated in paper leak protests in Delhi and other states. RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat has also tried to connect with youth protesters, saying they were not "anti-national".

These are pointers to the BJP-RSS efforts to address the concerns of Gen Z, who account for about 26% of India's population. It goes without saying that they would be among the decisive factors in the coming polls at the state and Central levels.

While Rahul's image is changing and his 'Chhatron ki Goonj' is resonating in different states, this in itself may not translate into votes for the Congress. Its DUSU debacle is another reminder of this harsh reality for the party. That the Congress needs to rebuild its organisation — and has done little on this score — is to state the obvious. Without knuckling down to this project, Rahul may only end up effecting the "NGOkaran (NGO-isation)" of the party.

While the Congress has focused on boosting Rahul's image, be it through 'Bharat Jodo Yatra' or 'Goonj', it has not really moved to rejuvenate and streamline the organisation. Rahul's Pune Goonj event with young women, for instance, has provided an opportunity to the Congress to bring them on board around a powerful theme of women freedom and empowerment, which has the potential of reverberating nationally.

The Congress's failure on the organisational front is all the more glaring as it is pitted against an adversary like the BJP, which has consistently displayed a killer instinct in winning elections. The ruling party is quick to course correct, which the Congress has yet to master. The Congress is known to conduct post mortem of its poll defeats and then let their reports gather dust for decades.

Today, polls are a complex business, driven by multiple factors — resources, detailed planning down to the booth level, mobilisation of grassroots workers, digital technology aided by AI, and political marketing. In sum, metaphorically speaking, Rahul may be firmly under the arc lights, his cheerleaders at hand.

But missing in action are countless, faceless men and women behind the scenes, who have to work in unison the lights and cameras, music systems, ticket booths — and coordinating moves and anticipating missteps — to ensure the concert's success. The Congress has yet to signal it could put such a show together.

Neerja Chowdhury, Contributing Editor, The Indian Express, has covered the last 11 Lok Sabha elections. She is the author of 'How Prime Ministers Decide'

1986 ruling holds, can't penalise for not singing: SC at Vande Mataram hearing

Vocalist Krishna's lawyer Muralidhar protests SG's remark on 'Naxalite's ideas'

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 22

HEARING A PETITION by Carnatic vocalist T M Krishna who has challenged the law mandating the singing of all six stanzas of the *Vande Mataram*, the Supreme Court, while reminding the Centre Tuesday about its 1986 ruling on an individual's right not to sing the national anthem, said it was up to "a conscientious objector not to recite one or all stanzas of the national song" and the person cannot be subjected to "criminal consequences".

It said it will examine whether refusal to sing the *Vande Mataram* could have penal consequences.

The hearing before a three-judge bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant also saw a heated exchange between Solicitor General Tushar Mehta and Senior Advocate and former judge S Muralidhar, appearing for Krishna.

Objecting to the challenge, Mehta said "lawmaking cannot be as per Naxalite's ideas". Muralidhar protested and asked Mehta to withdraw the remark, but he did not. The bench, also comprising Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana, said it had "not taken note" of the comment, restricting itself to "the Constitutional issue" before it.

Krishna's plea said the guideline on singing of all six stanzas of *Vande Mataram* at official functions violates the constitutional principle of secularism because the last four stanzas contain explicit Hindu references.

Justice Bagchi said, "The national song expressing homage to a particular God or form of God would not perhaps impact secularism, but your point whether a conscientious objector can be subjected to penal consequences... may require examination."

He said the law as it stands

T M Krishna

was laid down in its ruling on Bijoe Emmanuel and Others vs State of Kerala and Others. In the 1986 case, the Supreme Court ruled that expelling students, who belonged to Jehovah's Witnesses, for refusing to sing the national anthem, while standing respectfully in silence, violated their fundamental rights.

"We would expect that the law of the land, as declared by this Court in Bijoe Emmanuel, will govern the Act. What is the national song is not in dispute. The declaration of law in Bijoe Emmanuel is not yet questioned," Justice Bagchi said.

Muralidhar said, "What they have done is, as far as amending the Act is concerned, they have introduced the expression national song, but the Act does not define what a national song is. It is a serious lacuna in the Act and it can be misused because they have introduced this office memorandum which is not even gazetted. I don't know under what provision; they don't even cite any provision."

The Centre has amended Section 3 of the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971, extending the same legal protection to *Vande Mataram* as Jana Gana Mana.

Mehta questioned the petitioner's submissions and said, "Secularism will never be this narrow."

Muralidhar said, "A penal statute cannot be in the realm of vagueness. You do not define what a national song is in the statute and you make it a punishable offence."

Justice Bagchi said that "by custom and usage, the national song has always been understood as *Vande Mataram*".

"But only two stanzas," Muralidhar said. "For the first time after 80 years, they are trying to tell us it's not two stanzas. This is why when you use the term national, there has to be some building of a public opinion. It has to be by consensus. You can't thrust it and you cannot have penal consequences. That is what is most worrying."

Justice Bagchi said the extent of penal consequences "requires examination".

Mehta said, "Let's not drag national song in this sensationalism... Every officer says Jai Hind, but Jai Hind is not mentioned in the Constitution." Urging the bench not to issue notice, he said it will only "create a sensation which appears to be the object".

Justice Bagchi said, "Mr. Solicitor, we are not inclined to issue any notice to create any sensation. But we would expect that the law of the land, as declared by this Court in Bijoe Emmanuel, will govern the Act... What is the national song is not in dispute... The declaration of law in Bijoe Emmanuel has still not yet been questioned... It is for the democratically elected state to decide and give aspiration to the nation as to what is the national song, two stanzas or four stanzas. But nobody who feels an infraction of Article 25, 26 rights or a conscientious objector would be subjected to (penal consequences)."

"It's not the remit of the Court to second guess what is the national sentiments and aspirations associated with *Vande Mataram*. It is for the state... It is for a conscientious objector not to recite one or all stanzas of the national song, and (state is) not going to subject him to criminal consequences," he said.

Mehta said, "Lawmaking is as per the Constitution... Lawmaking cannot be as per Naxalite's ideas."

Muralidhar protested: "He will withdraw the expression he used just now. This is going live. I do not want this expression from a Solicitor General of India going live. I strongly object."

A heated exchange followed and Justice Bagchi said it was "unnecessary tension and emotion". Muralidhar said, "Why is the law officer using this kind of expression? This doesn't behove a law officer."

The CJI said the bench was confining itself to examining the legal issue. Mehta was asked to submit a counter-affidavit in two weeks.

Security arrangements outside IIT Bombay campus, Tuesday. PTI

IIT Bombay suicide: Students divided over demand to suspend professor

Pallavi Smart
Mumbai, September 22

DAYS AFTER an IIT Bombay student's death by suicide after he was allegedly caught using a mobile phone during an exam, differences among the students' sections over the protests and their demands have come into sharper focus. As protests demanding justice for 20-year-old Sahil Wakode continue, the student representatives issued another statement on Monday night, saying they stand by Professor Suryanarayana Doolla's right to a fair and impartial investigation, and sought his suspension as a "precautionary measure".

Professor Suryanarayana Doolla, the invigilator during the examination who had also allegedly caught Sahil using ChatGPT for answers, was suspended from his deanship. IIT Bombay has, however, retained him as a professor.

The statement also emphasised that the students' demand concerning Professor Doolla was to temporarily relieve him of his administrative duties as Dean of Administrative Affairs during the probe, and not to presume his guilt.

However, one of the 18 demands the student representatives submitted to IIT Bombay Director Shireesh B Kedare on Sunday night called for Professor Suryanarayana Doolla's suspension with immediate effect. His removal as dean had angered the students who had argued yesterday that they had sought his suspension as a professor.

"We do not stand for or condone cheating or any form of academic misconduct. At the same time, the loss of our fellow student, Sahil, is a deeply tragic event that has compelled us to reflect on the systems and processes within our institute," the statement read.

About Prof. Doolla, the statement said, "Our position has never been one of presuming guilt or prejudging the ongoing investigation. We stand with Professor Doolla as a member of our faculty community and believe that the investigation must be allowed to proceed fairly and impartially."

Faculty forums of IIT Kanpur, Indore back Prof

AFTER IIT DELHI and Madras, faculty forums of IIT Kanpur and Indore have extended their support to Professor Suryanarayana Doolla who has been removed from the post of Dean (Administrative Affairs) at IIT Bombay after the suicide of a student. Both institutes have issued statements condemning action against Prof Doolla. **ENS**

Security personnel carry Nandan Yadav, the key accused, after he was shot in the leg during an encounter in Jamui on Tuesday. PTI

Jamui molestation accused shot in the leg in police encounter

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, September 22

NANDAN YADAV, a key accused in the alleged molestation and harassment of two minors in Jamui, was shot in the leg during an encounter with police early Tuesday, officials said. Police identified him as the man seen in one of the videos with his face covered, grabbing the girl, lifting her and running away while touching her inappropriately.

Another accused, Hareram Yadav, was also injured hours earlier, officials said. Both men, aged 25, are undergoing treatment at a hospital. Deputy Inspector General of Munger Range Rakesh Kumar confirmed the developments to *The Indian Express* on Tuesday morning.

Jamui Superintendent of Police Vishwajeet Dayal said police received information around 5 am on Tuesday that the two main accused were hiding at the riverbed outside Pratappur village. "When the raiding team cordoned off the area, the accused tried to flee after seeing the police. He fell several times while being chased and sustained injuries, following which he was caught," Dayal said. The man identified himself as Hareram Yadav of Pratappur.

Hareram allegedly told investigators that Nandan had fled towards the river and was hiding in a patch of kans grass and bushes. Police then cordoned off the area and launched a search, during which Nandan allegedly opened fire when the team approached. "The police retaliated in self-defence, during which the accused suffered a gunshot injury to his right leg," an officer said.

Police said Nandan works as a tractor driver in the area and that a country-made pistol was recovered from him. "As per the preliminary probe, the two accused appear to have links to illegal sand and liquor smuggling..." an officer said.

The development came a day after police apprehended three juveniles in connection with the incident. The victims, a boy and a girl who are both school students, had gone for a scooter ride after tuition to the hilly outskirts of Jamui, where they were allegedly surrounded by these individuals. The two were assaulted, and the girl was allegedly molested.

EXPRESS special

'Whatever we earn, Ganga takes it away': Voices from flood relief camp

Displaced villagers have taken refuge at two relief camps in Bhagalpur

Himanshu Harsh
Bhagalpur, September 22

OUTSIDE A tent made up of black plastic sheets at Bhagalpur's Tilha Kothi, Raj Kishore is lying on a cot — one thing his family managed to salvage from the floodwaters that entered their home nearly a month ago.

Apart from being a bed, the cot functions also as a chair, and a place to keep whatever remains of their belongings.

"Documents, cash, jewellery — everything was submerged, including the grain we had stored in drums," says the 25-year-old.

Kishore was in Hyderabad when his phone rang. His family told him water had entered their home in Dildarpur Bind Tola. By the time he reached Bhagalpur, there was little left to return to.

Kishore says he keeps going back to check on his house, which is still underwater. "The water is so dirty that you cannot see anything beneath it," he says. But sometimes, if he is lucky, he adds, "things float to the surface". He says, "We collect whatever we find."

For him and hundred others in Bhagalpur displaced in the recent floods, this kothi inside the Tilka Manjhi Bhagalpur University campus is their temporary home. Outside a tent of black plastic sheets and bamboo poles, a group of women are talking. A medical team is stationed near the entrance; there is also an anganwadi centre where around 30 children attend classes in two shifts.

It is a village compressed into a few hundred metres.

A camp set up at Tilka Manjhi Bhagalpur University. HIMANSHU HARSH

A small crowd is gathered around two men locked in an argument. Suman Kumar, 23, says this is very common. "Everyone here has lost so much. Emotions run high. Small disagreements escalate."

Suman was in Ludhiana when water entered his house. He could reach home only four days later. "There is only one train connecting Ludhiana and Bhagalpur and it runs once a week," he says.

Like Suman, many in the camp are migrant labourers living outside Bihar. Some say they could not even collect their wages. Among them is Karan Kumar, employed at a construction site in Hyderabad.

Food is being served to the displaced at another building on the campus, Rabindra Bhawan. Incidentally, it is named after Rabindranath Tagore, who is known to have stayed here and written parts of Gitanjali, which earned him the Nobel Prize in Literature. A control centre monitors the feeding of around 250 families. "We serve meals twice a day," says Hanish Kumar, a teacher volunteer, as dal-chawal and soyabean-aloo is ladled out.

At the T N B Collegiate Ground Relief Camp, barely two kilometres away, around 650 people from the submerged areas of Dildarpur, Shankarpur and Bairariya are sharing space with animals, including cattle.

For many families, the animals are the most valuable assets they have left. But, as Ram Mohan says, "Even the animals who survived need to be fed and watered..."

Mrityunjay Kumar, a teacher helping run the relief camp, says there are around 400 cattle on the grounds. Many people whose homes are still standing also come in for meals, he adds. "They go back as they fear someone may break into their homes and steal whatever is left."

Rajesh Kumar says the flood couldn't have come at a worse time. The maize crop had been harvested around April, with some left over for contingency. Now all of it is under water.

At the Tilha Kothi camp, local artists have been teaching the children Manjusha — a traditional art form associated with the region – for the last few days. There are also storytelling sessions, cultural programmes and film screenings.

"We are trying to make the situation a little better for children through art therapy," says Bhagalpur district art and culture officer Ankit Ranjan. The programme, organised by the state art and culture department in collaboration with the district administration, is held daily , he adds.

Usha Devi, who is staying at the T N B Collegiate camp, says after the flood water recedes, they will need to clean their houses, remove the mud and sludge, salvage whatever can be saved, and make the homes habitable again. "It may take until Chhath (in November)," she says. "How will people earn a living in the meantime? After the relief camps close, we do not know what will happen."

Back at the university camp, as the sun goes down, tubelights strung along wires and ropes begin illuminating the narrow paths between the shelters. People emerge from their dark tents, and some light cooking fires. Adjusting the black sheet over his tent shared by 10 members of his family, Surya Narayan Mandal, 52, says: "Whatever we earn every year, the Ganga takes it away."

He is worried about two loans, amounting to around Rs 80,000, he took from self-help groups earlier this year. The money had gone into crops and household necessities, much of which is now gone.

"The government should rehabilitate us, on higher ground."

According to the state Disaster Management Department's situation report issued on September 21, floods have affected around 49.72 lakh people across 15 districts. The state has also deployed 27 SDRF and eight NDRF teams. As many as 112 community kitchens have served nearly 1.95 crore meals so far. The department said light to moderate rain and isolated heavy rain has been forecast in parts of the state between September 23 and 26.

Forest officer chasing mining mafia truck run over in Rajasthan

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, September 22

A DECORATED Forest Ranger was crushed by a dumper truck which was illegally transporting soil in Rajasthan, officials said on Tuesday.

Forest Ranger Pratap Singh Chundawat (40) was chasing the dumper on his Royal Enfield motorcycle, when he was crushed by the dumper around midnight on Monday. He was rushed to the Nimbahera government hospital where he died on Tuesday during treatment.

The incident took place in Pratapgarh district's Choti Sadri police station limits in the forest area near Ghatiwale Balaji temple.

Pratapgarh Deputy SP Rameshwar Lal told *The Indian Express*, "Late on Monday the forest team received information that soil was being illegally mined from a forest area. The team immediately reached the spot and found a JCB and a dumper at work. Seeing the forest team, the dumper truck tried to escape...Chundawat went after it on his motorcycle. As others (co-accused) caught up, they provoked the dumper driver to crush the officer by saying *charha de iske upar* (crush him). The driver, identified as Kana Bawri, allegedly ran over the officer and escaped."

An FIR has been lodged, the DSP said, adding, "The JCB and the dumper have been seized and some persons, including the owner and driver of the JCB machine, have also been detained..."

The DSP said that as per the FIR, 5-6 persons were involved in digging work when the three forest personnel reached the spot initially. "Forest guards Suresh and Ajay were accompanying Pratap. Later, they called other personnel to the spot," he said.

Forest Ranger Pratap Singh Chundawat

The DSP said that the earth which was being excavated is a thick, 'gaara' type mud used to make bricks or plaster and fill gaps in houses.

Pratapgarh Superintendent of Police Vishal Jangid also reached the spot on Tuesday.

Officials said Chundawat's body was handed over to his family after autopsy.

Describing Chundawat as a multi-faceted personality, Pratapgarh Deputy Conservator of Forest, Suresh Agrawal, said "Pratap Singh Chundawat was our best officer."

Speaking to *The Indian Express* from the cremation site, he said, "We had nominated him for the state level award on the occasion of Independence Day this year. He had also received several awards at the district and division level. He was actively involved in wildlife rescue, especially panthers, pythons, etc. His work in nurseries and plantations had also yielded good results and he was active in games, too, including swimming and shooting."

KPSC exam 'fraud': Middleman paid Rs 1.3 cr to IAS officer, says ED

Express News Service
Bengaluru, September 22

A MIDDLEMAN arrested in connection with the alleged irregularities in the recruitment of 400 veterinary doctors by the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) has told investigators that he paid Rs 1.3 crore to the former controller of exams, suspended IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar, and also sponsored his jewellery purchases for "facilitating exam paper leaks".

The Enforcement Directorate cited middleman Basavaraj Kannale's statements made during questioning to obtain the custody of Gangwar, who was arrested on August 29 by the CID unit of the Karnataka Police, in its own probe under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002.

The ED had placed both Gangwar and Kannale under arrest in prison last week and had obtained body warrants from a CID court to produce them in the court of a special judge for PMLA cases in Bengaluru on Monday. However, with

Suspended IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar

the Karnataka CID police taking further police custody for two days of Kannale on September 19, the middleman was not produced on the body warrant on Monday.

Gangwar, who was produced before the special court, was remanded in six-day custody of the ED for further probe. The ED told the court that its questioning of Kannale in prison had revealed that he paid Rs 1.30 crore in cash to the controller of exams apart from sponsoring his jewellery purchases.

While the ED said Gangwar bought a diamond necklace worth Rs 23 lakh from a prominent jewellery showroom in Bengaluru through funds funnelled by Kannale, the Karnataka CID said during his bail hearing that the IAS officer bought a gold necklace worth over Rs 28 lakh through Kannale.

The Karnataka CID indicated in court last week that it had recovered the jewellery from one of Gangwar's friends.

According to sources familiar with the PMLA probe, the ED is examining whether proceeds of crime were generated through other KPSC exams conducted during Gangwar's two-year tenure, from 2024 to March 2026, as the controller of exams, since the middleman "handled funds for the officer for a long time and not just recently".

The agency found that Kannale transferred funds to Gangwar even in 2025, sources said.

The probe by CID and ED has so far revealed that the middleman received Rs 30 lakh to Rs 40 lakh from each candidate to provide access to the question paper.

Kannale is alleged to have collected around Rs 1.5 crore in advance bribes.

HIMACHAL PRADESH

Four dead as car plunges into gorge

FOUR PEOPLE died and another injured after their car plunged into a gorge in Kullu on Tuesday, police said. The dead were identified as Gunjan, Rahul, Vikas and Bal Krishan, all of Jaboo village in Kullu. According to police, the occupants were returning from a wedding. PTI

To build Viksit Bharat, India must be drug-free, says Shah

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 22

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday said India must deliver a decisive blow to narcotics networks and set a deadline of December 31, 2029, to uproot the drug trade from the country, calling the fight against drugs the most difficult battle before the government.

Addressing the 3rd National Conference of Anti-Narcotics Task Force (ANTF) heads in Delhi, Shah said the Centre and states would have to move from meeting to mission, reporting to result, seizure to dismantling of networks, and case to conviction to achieve the goal of a drug-free India.

The two-day conference, organised by the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB), is being attended by ANTF heads from 36 states and Union Territories, representatives of government departments, and other stakeholders.

Shah said that under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, the government had taken a series of steps over the past five years to achieve the goal of a drug-free India.

"The time has now come to deliver a decisive blow against narcotics, which have become the most serious threat to the country and the world," he said, highlighting the need for collective effort.

Linking the anti-drug campaign to the goal of a developed India by 2047, Shah said the country's youth could not be allowed to be weakened by addiction. "To build a Viksit Bharat by 2047, to save future generations, and to connect the youth with India's development, the only option before us is to make India drug-free," he said.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah at the inauguration of the 3rd national conference of ANTF chiefs in Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

The minister said the roadmap focuses on enforcement, intelligence and operations, control of precursor and synthetic drugs, demand and harm reduction, and capacity building and coordination. More than 100 targets have been categorised under these pillars. Under the target of registering one lakh Nashamukt Mitras, Shah said 46,780 had already been registered by various ministries and were operational.

Shah said anti-narcotics efforts should move away from a seizure-centric approach and focus on dismantling entire networks. Backward and forward linkages, financial investigations and digital trails must be pursued, he said, adding that the funds of drug dealers must be targeted.

He said cartels should be attacked at three levels: entry points, inter-state distribution systems and local sales networks within districts. Districts, he added, would be categorised into clusters based on whether they were points of manufacture or entry, transportation corridors, or areas of consumption.

Bombay HC pulls up Mallya for posting ED affidavit on X

Omkar Gokhale
Mumbai, September 22

THE BOMBAY High Court on Tuesday pulled up fugitive businessman Vijay Mallya, for uploading an affidavit filed by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) in reply to his plea onto 'X' (formerly known as Twitter), stating that fighting ongoing legal matters on social media 'undermines the efficacy' of the court.

"Please make your client understand this is not the way to do it. Try and understand, what happens is, it undermines the efficacy of the court, because what is shown to me is something which is prima facie serious," said a single-judge bench of Justice Milind N Jadhav.

"The problem is he (Mallya) is spoiling his own case otherwise if he is doing like this. He has very competent lawyers in the court to argue the matter," the judge added. The ED's counsel raised an objection that after the agency emailed the affidavit to Mallya's lawyers, he uploaded the document on 'X' with derogatory comments, even before the court got a chance to peruse the affidavit.

IRCON INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
NAVRATNA COMPANY
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Website : www.ircon.org, CIN - L45203DL1976GOI008171

EOI Notice

EOI NO.: IRCON/S&T/Telecom/EOI/2026 Dtd.: 21.09.2026

Ircon International Limited, A Navratna PSU Under Ministry of Railways, invites open Expression of Interest (EOI) from experienced agencies for association as Pre-bid Partner/Associate Agency/ Sub-contractor for the following work:-

"Reputed Indian companies with experience in Telecommunication works are invited to associate with IRCON for empanelment as Pre-bid Partners/Associate Agencies/Sub-contractors/Execution Partners/JV Partner for upcoming projects in the Railway, Metro and Telecom sectors."

Last Date and Time of e-Bid Submission of EOI	19.10.2026 up to 11:00 hrs. (IST)

For further details and updates, please visit tender section on e-tender website https://etenders.gov.in/eprocure/app Amendment/Corrigendum, if any, would be hosted only on the website. Chief General Manager/S&T, C-4, District Centre, Saket, New Delhi-110017

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Engineer/C, Northern Railway, DRM Office, Delhi Division, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055, for and on behalf of the President of India invites open electronic-tenders for under noted works:-

S.No. 1: Name of work : Improvement of the safety features of non interlocked Level Crossings by providing an additional layer.
Approximate cost of work : Rs. 48,17,957.64
Earnest money to be deposited : Rs. 96,400/-
Completion period : 06 Months
Date of opening : 15.10.2026

The e-tender is to be submit through railway website **'http: ireps.gov.in'**. The tenders can be submit on website up to **15:00 hrs.** on **15.10.2026** and shall be opened there after.

No.: 128-W/Sr.DEN-C/NIT-10-2026-27-WC Date: 22.09.2026 3295/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA
NIRMAN SOUDHA, UNIT-V, BHUBANESWAR
INVITATIONS FOR BIDS (IFB)
334001/846/2627
E-mail ID:cebuildings_orissa@yahoo.co.in
cebuildings@rediffmail.com, Tel. -(0674)- 2391523

File No.-B-IV-H-(ALMC)-22/2023(Pt-V)34808 the 21st Sept., 2026

Invitation for Bids
2nd Corrigendum

Tender Reference No. CE-Bldg-l-31/2026-27
Name of the Works:
(1) "Construction of Govt. College of Nursing (G + 1) and Hostel Building (G + 3) at Baripada, Dist.-Mayurbhanj".
(2) "Construction of Govt. College of Nursing at Baleswar",
(3) "Construction of Govt. College of Nursing at Jajpur".

The following changes have been made in Bid Identification No. CE-Bldg-1-31/2026-27
1. Bid documents such as DTCN / BOQ etc. can be seen / downloaded from the Govt. Website i.e. **www.tendersorissa.gov.in**, during the period from **dt.12.10.2026 to 17.00 hours** of **dt.27.10.2026** instead of **dt.21.09.2026 to dt.06.10.2026** for **ONLINE BIDDING** respectively.
2. Online bids shall be received **till 17.00 Hours of dt.27.10.2026** instead of **dt.06.10.2026.**
3. The technical bids will be opened at **11.30 A.M. of dt.28.10.2026** instead of **dt.07.10.2026.**

All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

Sd/-
Engineer-in-Chief (Civil),
(I/c) Chief Engineer, Buildings-l,
Odisha, Bhubaneswar

OIPR-34001/34117/1/26-27/0074

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
एक नवरत्न कम्पनी (भारत सरकार का उपक्रम)
A Navratna Company (A Govt. of India Undertaking)
NSIC Business Park, New MDBP Building, 2nd Floor, Okhla Ind. Estate, New Delhi- 110020
कॉनकॉर CONCOR

NOTICE INVITING E- TENDER

CONCOR invites E-Tender in Single Packet System of tendering for the following work:-

Tender No.	CON/AREA-III/ENGG/ICD-MVN/E-96515/2026-27
Name of Work	Construction boundary wall at ICD-MVN, Thoothukkudi (Tamil Nadu)
Estimated Cost	₹ 94.55 Lakhs (including GST)
Completion Period	04 (Four) Months
Earnest Money Deposit	₹ 1,89,100/- (Rupee One Lakhs Eighty-Nine Thousand One Hundred only)
Cost of Tender Document	NIL
Tender Processing Fee (Non-refundable)	₹ 3540/- (inclusive all taxes & duties through e-payment.)
Date of sale of Tender (online)	23.09.2026 (from 16:00 hrs.) to 13.10.2026 (upto 17:00 hrs.)
Date & Time of submission of Tender (online)	14.10.2026 up to 17:00 hrs.
Date & Time of Opening of Tender (online)	15.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

For financial eligibility criteria, experience with respect to similar nature of work, etc, please refer to detailed tender notice available on website www.concorindia.com, but the complete tender document can be downloaded from website www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL only. Further, Corrigendum / Addendum to this Tender, if any, will be published on website www.concorindia.com, www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL and Central Procurement Portal (CPP) only. Newspaper press advertisement shall not be issued for the same.
Group General Manager (P&S), Phone No.: 011 – 41222500

INDIAN RAILWAYS
GOVERNMENT OF INDIA (BHARAT SARKAR)
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS (RAIL MANTRALAYA)
(RAILWAY BOARD)

No. RS(POL)/58/0506/2027 **New Delhi, dated, 22.09.2026**
Sub: Publication of E-Tender Notice against Ministry of Railways (Railway Board)'s E-Tender No. 2027 BG TC due for opening on 22.10.2026 for procurement of Branded Grease.

Executive Director, Railway Stores (RS), Ministry of Railways (Railway Board), Government of India, for and on behalf of the President of India invites e-tender as per details given here under:-

1.	**E-Tender No.**	2027 BGTC
2.	**Name of Work**	Branded greases conforming to relevant specifications for the following brands/types of grades of products or equivalent brands/grades as approved by RDSO for regular and unrestricted use: **1. Grease for Application on Axle Box Cylindrical Roller Bearing of ALCO Diesel Locos:** SERVOGEM RR-3 (IOC)/BALMEROL MULTI-GREASE 'LL-3' (BL) MAK RR GREASE - 3 (BPC) Lithon - RR 3 (HPC) Conforming to RDSO specification No.WD-17-misc.-92 **Quantity : 15,35,757 Kgs.** **2. Grease for Application on Traction Motor Gear Case (Plain Suspension Bearing type))of ALCO Diesel Locos:** SERVOCOAT 170-T (IOC)/ BLUE COAT -'3' (BL) / MAK CAMEX COMPOUND- G (BPC) **Quantity : 4,05,852 Kgs.**
3.	**Earnest Money**	Rs. 50 Lakh
4.	**Last date and time for submission of -tender**	22.10.2026 at 14.30 hrs.
5.	**Website for complete details of e-tendering and further corrigenda, if any in the tender**	**http://www.ireps.gov.in**
6.	**Allocation Head**	Grant No. 01

No.: RS(POL)/58/0506/2027 **Director, Railway stores (M)**
New Delhi, Dated: 22.09.2026 **For & on behalf of the President of India**
Serving Customers with a Smile 3297/2026

म.प्र. स्टेट सिविल सप्लाईज कार्पो. लिमि.
पंजी. कार्या. : ब्लॉक नं. 1 तृतीय तल, पर्यावास भवन, भोपाल-482011
वेब. : www.mpscsc.mp.gov.in, ई-मेल : mpscsc@gmail.com
Procurement Control Room No. : 0775-2677847
वर्तमान पता : संचालनालय सामाजिक न्याय एवं दिव्यांगजन सशक्तिकरण भवन, द्वितीय एवं तृतीय तल, लिंक रोड नं. 3 राष्ट्रीय स्वास्थ्य मिशन (NHM भवन के पास) पत्रकार कॉलोनी के सामने, भोपाल पिनकोड-462016
क्रमांक/निस्तारण/1172712/2026-27/316 भोपाल, दिनांक : 22.09.2026

क्षतिग्रस्त स्कंध के विक्रय हेतु जारी निविदा क्र. 139 दिनांक 05.06.2026 निरस्त कर पुन: निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

कार्पोरेशन द्वारा म.प्र. के विभिन्न जिलों में भंडारित विभिन्न श्रेणी के क्षतिग्रस्त स्कंध जो "जैसा है जहां है" के आधार पर विक्रय हेतु निविदा क्रमांक 139 दिनांक 05.06.2026 जारी की गई थी, जिसे निरस्त किया जाकर पुन: निविदा जारी कर भारतीय खाद्य निगम में पंजीकृत पात्र निविदाकारों से ऑनलाइन निविदायें ई-निविदा वेबसाइट **https://mptenders.gov.in** पर दिनांक 07.10.2026 सायं 5.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा दस्तावेज, नियम एवं शर्तों आदि का विस्तृत विवरण **https://mptenders.gov.in** एवं **https://www.mpscsc.mp.gov.in** पर उपलब्ध है। निविदा दस्तावेज एवं निविदा प्रक्रिया ऑनलाइन भरने हेतु संबंधित तकनीकी सहयोग व स्पष्टीकरण प्राप्त करने हेतु टोल फ्री नंबर 0120-4001002 पर संपर्क कर सकते हैं।
म.प्र. माध्यम/128187/2026 प्रबंध संचालक

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, पथ निर्माण विभाग
पथ प्रमण्डल सं0–1, मुजफ्फरपुर
Mobile No : 9470001292, E-mail : eercd1muz@gmail.com, ee-rd-muz1-bih@nic.in

शुद्धि पत्र

इस कार्यालय का पत्रांक 2394 (अनु0) दिनांक 02.09.2026, पी0 आर0 सं0–011025 (आर0सी0डी0) 2026–27 जो दिनांक 04.09.2026 को दैनिक समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित हुआ है, को अपरिहार्य कारणवश ई–पुनर्निविदा के निर्धारित अवधि का विस्तार निम्नानुसार किया जाता है :–

क्र0		पूर्व की निर्धारित अवधि	संशोधित निर्धारित अवधि
1	Period for Download of tender documents	from 22.09.2026 to 29.09.2026 upto 15:00 hrs (From Website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)	from 01.10.2026 to 09.10.2026 upto 15:00 hrs (From Website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
2	Date, time & place of pre-bid meeting	24.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs. at 11:00 hrs (CE North, RCD, Patna)	05.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs (CE North, RCD, Patna)
3	Last date & time for uploading Tender documents by bidder	29.09.2026 upto 15:00 hrs. on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	09.10.2026 upto 15:00 hrs. on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4	Date, time & Place of opening of technical bid	29.09.2026 at 15:30 hrs. on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	09.10.2026 at 15:30 hrs. on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
5	Date, time & place of opening of Financial Bid	After evaluation of Technical Bid on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	After evaluation of Technical Bid on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in

अन्य शर्तें पूर्वत रहेंगें।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
पथ प्रमण्डल सं0–1, मुजफ्फरपुर

PR- 012035 (RCD) 2026-27

विस्तृत सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE PANIPAT CO-OP. SUGAR MILLS LTD., PANIPAT	SUPPLY, ERECTION AND COMMISSIONING OF 90 KLPD CAPACITY ZERO LIQUID DISCHARGE COMPLIANT GREEN FIELD MOLASSES CUM GRAIN BASED DISTILLERY FOR PRODUCTION OF FUEL GRADE ETHANOL WITH 25 TPH CAPACITY INCINERATION BOILER AND 2.5 MW TURBINE (INCLUDING COMPLETE CIVIL WORKS) ON EPC BASIS AND OPERATION & MAINTENANCE OF THE SAME FOR TWO YEARS AT THE PANIPAT COOPERATIVE SUGAR MILLS LTD., VILLAGE DAHAR, PANIPAT, HARYANA – 132 145	19.09.2026 28.10.2026	208.17 CRORES	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813588266 panipatsugarmills@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 49537/HRY

Office of The Chief Executive Officers, SMVDSB, Katra

For and on behalf of the Chairman, Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine Board, eligible bids are invited form the firms for the work Facility Management Services for providing Housekeeping /Sanitation and Laundry manpower at SMVDNSH, Kakryal for a period of one year and further extendable for one year on the basis of satisfactory performance of the firm.

The last date for submission of tenders is 07.10.2026 at 04:00 P.M and the ibid detail may kindly be downloaded from **https://jktenders.gov.in** & **www.maavaishnodevi.org**

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(एक नवरत्न कम्पनी (भारत सरकार का उपक्रम) (A Navratna Undertaking of Govt. of India)
NSIC NEW MDBP Building, 2nd Floor, Okhla Industrial Estate (Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station), New Delhi-110020

INVITATION FOR E-TENDER

CONCOR invite E-Bids for **Open e-Tender (Single Bid System) for " Annual Maintenance Contract for Operation and Maintenance of firefighting system at MMLP-MIHAN Nagpur for 24 months."** The brief of tender is as under:

Tender No.	**CON/A-II/AMC/FF/O&M/MIHAN/E103450/2026-27**
Total Estimated Cost	₹ 59,91,264/- (incl. GST)
Cost of Tender documents (Non-refundable)	₹ 1,120 (Inclusive all) through e-payment
Tender Processing Fee (Non-refundable)	₹ 3,540 (Inclusive all) through e-payment
Earnest Money Deposit	₹ 1,19,826 (through e-payment)
Date of sale of tender (online)	From 23.09.2026 at 17:00 Hrs. to 13.10.2026 up to 12:30 Hrs.
Last Date & Time of submission	13.10.2026 up to 14:00 Hrs. (E-Tendering Mode Only)
Date and time of Opening of Tender	13.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

The complete Tender Document for eligibility criteria and other details can be viewed & downloaded only from the website **(www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL)**. The tender notice is also available on the website **www.concorindia.co.in** and website of Public Procurement Portal **http://eprocure.gov.in**. Bidders are requested to visit the websites regularly.
General Manager/Tech./A-II

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, HANSI	SPECIAL REPAIR OF 4 NOS ROADS (I) UKLANA KUNDANPURA ROAD TO SCHOOL AT UKLANA BY PROVIDING IPB (0.84 KM) (ROAD ID 10972) (II) PARBHUWALA TO NH-65 BY PROVIDING RELAYING OF IPB AND WDG AND STG (2.205 KM) (ROAD ID 10937) (III) MIRPUR TO AGROHA BY PROVIDING WDG AND STG AND IPB (1.00 KM) (ROAD ID 11525) (IV) SABARWAS TO KHARAKHERI BY PROVIDING STG IN HISAR DISTRICT. (2.64 KM) (ROAD ID 10949) (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (UKLANA CONSTITUENCY) (WITHOUT GST) (G-VIII) + 18 WORKS	18.09.2026 28.09.2026	7392.38 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01663259688 pwd-eepd-hansi@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, JIND	CONSTRUCTION OF 8 NOS. TRANSIT FLATS AND 2 NOS. RESIDENTIAL BUILDING AT JULANA IN JIND DISTRICT (HON`BLE C.M. ANNOUNCEMENT CODE NO. 20720 DATED 19.01.2018)	CLOSING DATE 05.10.2026	572.22 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8398098075 pwdeepdjind@gmail.com
3	PWD B&R, YAMUNA NAGAR	TRENGTHENING OF JAGADHRI BILASPUR ROAD (SH NO.1) (ID 442) KM. 0.00 TO 0.60) IN YAMUNA NAGAR DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAM-2026-27)(JAGADHRI CONSTITUENCY)	21.09.2026 28.09.2026	55.16 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01732237834 pwd-eepd-yamunanagar@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, YAMUNA NAGAR	STRENGTHENING OF JAGADHRI BARI PABNI ROAD (ID 444) KM. 0.00 TO 12.56) IN YAMUNANAGAR DISTRICT. (WORK PROGRAM-2026-27)(SADHAURA CONSTITUENCY)	21.09.2026 05.10.2026	865.62 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01732237834 pwd-eepd-yamunanagar@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	PROVIDING MODULAR KITCHEN IN D. C. RESIDENCE AT FATEHABAD IN FATEHABAD DISTT. (EXCLUDING GST).	21.09.2026 28.09.2026	9.70 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
6	PWD B&R, YAMUNA NAGAR	STRENGTHENING OF YAMUNA NAGAR KHAJURI JATHALA ROAD (ID 511) KM. 0.00 TO 2.00) IN YAMUNA NAGAR DISTRICT (UNDER WORK PROGRAM-2026-27)(YAMUNA NAGAR CONSTITUENCY).	21.09.2026 30.09.2026	73.55 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01732237834 pwd-eepd-yamunanagar@hry.nic.in
7	PWD B&R, AMBALA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PROVIDING WDG. AND STG. FOR VARIOUS 4 NOS. LINK ROADS (I.E. ROAD ID 852, 855, 386 AND 7784) UNDER THE JURISDICTION OF PROVINCIAL DIVISION NO.2, PWD BANDR BR., AMBALA CANTT IN AMBALA DISTRICT (UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (MULLANA CONSTITUENCY) (GROUP-5) + 1 WORKS	17.09.2026 28.09.2026	723.15 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9417362462 pwd-eepd2-ambala@hry.nic.in
8	PWD B&R, HISAR	WORK OF ACCESSIBLE INDIA CAMPAIGN IN JUDICIAL COURT BUILDING CHARKHI DADRI (PDG 13 PASSENGER LIFT WITH ALLIED MATERIAL ONLY)	17.09.2026 25.09.2026	18.62 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
9	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	SPECIAL REPAIR FOR IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM SOHNA CITY TO DHANI SOHNA VIA NANGLI FROM KM. 0.00 TO 2.100 IN SOHNA CONSTITUENCY IN GURUGRAM DISTT. (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-2027)	CLOSING DATE 28.09.2026	108.11 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eepd1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
10	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	REPLACEMENT OF 4 NOS. JOHNSON MAKE LIFTS INSTALLED IN MINI SECRETARIAT AT JIND. + 2 WORKS	18.09.2026 28.09.2026	124.41 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9034929655 pwdeeedrohtak1@gmail.com
11	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	RENOVATION OF MAIN BLOCK, EXTENSION BLOCK, ANCILLARY BLOCK AND BEAUTIFICATION OF EXTERNAL AREA OF HARYANA BHAWAN, NEW DELHI.	CLOSING DATE 03.10.2026	817.14 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eepd1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
12	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KARNAL	CONST. OF HALL FOR INDOOR GYM IN VILLAGE MOHIDINPUR BLOCK KARNAL + 3 WORKS	18.09.2026 26.09.2026	89.91 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896202019 prexeeng.kri@hry.nic.in
13	PANCHAYATI RAJ,FARIDABAD	CONSTRUCTION OF DRAINS AND TREATMENT PROCEDURE OF WASTE WATER (GWM) AT VILLAGE CHHAINSA BLOCK BALLABGARH DISTRICT FARIDABAD + 2 WORKS	18.09.2026 25.09.2026	118.25 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467905067 prexeeng.fbd1@gmail.com
14	PANCHAYATI RAJ,FARIDABAD	SUPPLY OF 90 WATT LED STREET LIGHTS IN 15 VILLAGES OF DISTRICT FARIDABAD (PHASE-2)	18.09.2026 25.09.2026	13.15 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467905067 prexeeng.fbd1@gmail.com
15	PANCHAYATI RAJ, PANIPAT	CONST. OF BC CHAUPAL (BARRAGI CHAUPAL) ATT VILLAGE NAULTHA BLOCK ISRANA + 15 WORKS	19.09.2026 25.09.2026	474.94 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9068676922 prexeeng.pnp@gmail.com
16	DEPUTY COMMISSIONER-CUM- CHAIRMAN DITS, JHAJJAR	INVITING PROPOSALS OF INTERESTED FIRMS FOR SUPPLY OF STATIONERY (A-4, A-3 & LEGAL PAPER) IN DISTRICT JHAJJAR	21.09.2026 30.09.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01251-253119 diojjr@hry.nic.in
17	WOMEN & CHILD DEVELOPMENT, SONIPAT	SUPPLY FOR GOODS AND FOOD IITRMS IN ANAGNWASDI CENTER IN DISTT. SONIPAT	21.09.2026 07.10.2026	EMD 25000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466423780 posnp.wcd@gmail.com
18	CIVIL HOSPITAL, PANCHKULA	PURCHASE OF MEDICAL GASES (NITROUS OXIDE, CARBON DIOXIDE & MEDICAL GASES)	24.09.2026 05.10.2026	EMD 50000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2562199 gh6pkl@gmail.com
19	CIVIL HOSPITAL, PANCHKULA	SUPPLY OF LIQUID MEDICAL OXYGEN	24.09.2026 05.10.2026	EMD 50000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2562199 gh6pkl@gmail.com
20	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR MEDICAL EQUIPMENT/INSTRUMENT (MICROSCOPE FOR TEMPORAL BONE DISSECTION LAB WALL MOUNTED/STATION FITTED) AT KCGMC, KARNAL.	25.09.2026 05.10.2026	EMD 10000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
21	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR CHEMICAL/REAGENTS AND KITS FOR DEPARTMENT OF BIOCHEMISTRY AT KCGMC, KARNAL.	28.09.2026 08.10.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
22	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, SIRSA	DEWEEDING OF WEED GROWTH,BUSHES,INTERNAL AND OUTER CLEARANCE OF KISHANPURA MINOR RD 0 TO 24200 TAIL. + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 29.09.2026	2.43 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666235721 xenghaggar@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 49582/HRY

BSES BSES Yamuna Power Limited
BSES Yamuna Power Limited, Delhi
... A joint venture with Govt. of NCT of Delhi

NOTICE INVITING TENDER Date: 23.09.2026

E-tenders are invited under the Single-Bid System for the following materials/works:

NIT & SRM RFx No.	Tender Description	Due Date / Time (Submission)
CMC/BY/26-27/RB/SkS/SV/32 [RFx No: 2000001193]	Expression of Interest (EOI) for Selection of Advanced Distribution Management System (ADMS) Technology for Next-Generation Smart Grid Operations and Network Modernization in BYPL, Delhi	22.10.2026 / 15:00 hrs

For detailed information and submission of Tender Documents - including any corrigendum - please visit our website at www.bsesdelhi.com → BSES Yamuna Power Ltd → Tenders → Open Tenders, or access our e-tendering portal at https://srmprdportal.bsesdelhi.com/irj/portal
Head (Contracts & Materials)

BSES YAMUNA POWER LIMITED (BYPL)
Regd. Office: Shakti Kiran Building, Karkardooma, Delhi-110032
CIN: U40109DL2001PLC111525 Tel: 011-41247111

noida
New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida G.B Nagar, (U.P.)
Website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms / contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened / downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website : **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **https://etender.up.nic.in.** Please ensure to see these websites for any changes / amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)
1. **35/S.M.(Jal)-II/E.T./2026-27,** Strengthening of Sewerage (Changing of old chocked and damaged Sewer line in different blocks at Network Sector-30, 31 & 36), Noida. Cost Rs. 91.82 Lacs
2. **36/S.M.(Jal)-II/E.T./2026-27,** Internal/External Water Supply in Sector-145, 146, 147, 148, 149 (Electrification work for Tube well's & UGR in Sector-146), Noida. Cost Rs. 96.37 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date: - 06.10.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: - 07.10.2026 at 11.00 AM.

(B)
1. **26/S.M.(Jal)-II/E.T./2026-27,** M/o Sewerage (Searching, Raising, Cleaning and Functional of Sewer Line in Sector-150), Noida. Cost Rs. 66.25 Lacs
2. **27/S.M.(Jal)-II/E.T./2026-27,** Internal Development of Water Works Compound (Repair, Maintenance, Painting Work and other various works in Ranney Well-10 Compound Sector-164), Noida. Cost Rs. 92.25 Lacs
3. **04/S.M.(Jal-O.A.)/2026-27,** O/M of Sewer Line and MSPS/SPS at Expressway (Two year Repairing and Rewinding of 75/90 HP Submersible Pump at IPS-7, Sector-129), Noida. Cost Rs. 58.71 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date: - 29.09.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: - 30.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.

General Manager (Jal)
NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

सत्यमेव जयते
राजस्थान सरकार

माननीय प्रधानमंत्री

श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी जी

का

हार्दिक आभार

जल प्रबंधन में एक और नया कीर्तिमान

समृद्ध होगा राजस्थान

सुनिश्चित होगी शेखावटी की जल सुरक्षा

माननीय केन्द्रीय गृह मंत्री **श्री अमित शाह** के नेतृत्व एवं केन्द्रीय जल शक्ति मंत्री **श्री सी आर पाटिल** की गरिमामयी उपस्थिति में **15 सितंबर, 2026** को राजस्थान सहित छह बेसिन राज्यों के मध्य किशाऊ बहुद्देशीय परियोजना के निर्माण हेतु समझौता सम्पन्न

- राजस्थान का आवंटन: **134 MCM जल**
- परियोजना की अनुमानित लागत: **15,000 करोड़**
- किशाऊ बाँध यमुना की सहायक टौंस नदी पर **1324 MCM जल भंडारण क्षमता** की योजना
- माननीय मुख्यमंत्री जी के विशेष प्रयासों से हिमाचल प्रदेश को आवंटित जल में से **25% अतिरिक्त जल राजस्थान को मिलेगा**
- जल का उपयोग **शेखावटी में पेयजल, सिंचाई एवं अन्य हितकारी उपयोगों के लिए**
- किशाऊ परियोजना को भारत सरकार की महत्वपूर्ण **राष्ट्रीय परियोजनाओं में सम्मिलित** किया गया है

यमुना जल परियोजना के अंतर्गत हथिनीकुंड बैराज से प्रस्तावित भूमिगत पाइप लाइन से ऊपरी यमुना बेसिन के **रेणुकाजी, लखवार एवं किशाऊ बांधों** से आवंटित जल शेखावटी क्षेत्र में पेयजल, सिंचाई एवं अन्य उपयोगों के लिए वर्ष पर्यंत उपलब्ध होगा।

राजस्थान संवाद

सूचना एवं जनसम्पर्क विभाग, राजस्थान

● WEB EXCLUSIVE
'Death penalty: Courts cannot just ignore the law.'
— By Anup Surendranath
Log on to www.indianexpress.com

● WORDLY WISE
The mind is not a vessel to be filled, but a fire to be kindled.
— Plutarch

The Indian EXPRESS
~ FOUNDED BY ~
RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

In IIT, student death and a reckoning

TWO DEATHS within a month at two of India's most storied institutions of excellence come as a sobering moment in a nation that prizes them as tools of meritocratic ascent. At IIT-Bombay, a second-year BTech student took his life hours after he was allegedly found adopting unfair means in an examination. Following student agitation, the institute has suspended the dean who reported him, even as faculty members have rallied behind their colleague. Last month, at IIT-Delhi, the death by suicide of an MSc student set off weeks of protest and questions about the responsibilities of an institution towards those in its care. Behind both these instances are campuses struggling to find a language in which accountability and compassion can coexist.

It would be a mistake to read in these tragedies evidence that some of the country's brightest young people lack resilience. Those who clear these competitive examinations have already proved a formidable capacity for endurance. The larger question centres on the old imagination of authority in premier campuses, which are more socially and culturally diverse than ever before. With that diversity comes different experiences of class, caste, language, aspiration and vulnerability. The caste discrimination alleged by the deceased student's family is a reminder that diversity without a corresponding shift in institutional culture can create new forms of exclusion, that a system designed principally around teaching, testing, rigour and discipline cannot address the change on campus solely through the addition of a counsellor's office. It requires professors and administrators to hear what young people — many of them away from home for the first time — are trying to say about isolation, stigma and fear. Faculty, too, working within a system of administrative protocol and expected to anticipate crises for which they were never trained, need clarity about what is expected of them when a student is in distress, and the assurance that decisions taken in the best interest and following guidelines are not used to scapegoat them afterwards.

None of this is achieved in the sound and fury of the immediate aftermath of a tragedy. Campuses need guidelines that preserve academic integrity. Along with strong counselling and grievance mechanisms, they need a frank institutional reckoning with caste and hierarchy. Meaningful student representation should become ordinary institutional practice. Between 2006 and 2026, there have reportedly been over 170 student deaths across various IIT campuses.The role of an institution of excellence cannot be limited to the mentoring of high performers. It must also create a space where failure is not insurmountable. That task will never be easy. But the measure of a campus lies in whether academic excellence can be anchored in student wellbeing.

SC message: Illegal arrest cannot be papered over

ON MONDAY, the Supreme Court invoked Article 22 (1) to affirm that an arrested person kept in the dark about the grounds of arrest was entitled to immediate release. It reiterated that communicating the reasons for arrest in writing and in a language the arrestee understands is "non-negotiable", and that it applies "across the spectrum, including offences under the BNS or under special enactments". Ruling that probing agencies cannot shrug off the breach of Article 22 (1), the Court observed that such an omission would amount to the violation of the accused's fundamental rights. Its two-judge bench also laid down strict procedure for re-arresting such a person.

In a series of significant judgments in the last three years, the apex court has consistently rejected the argument that the gravity of an offence could justify a departure from constitutional safeguards under Article 22(1). On Monday, too, the Court rejected the state's argument that grave allegations must buy the police room to manoeuvre. Liberty, the Court held, does not become negotiable because the charge is serious. "Any attempt to encroach upon the fundamental rights guaranteed under Article 22(1) of the Constitution... would vitiate the process of arrest and remand. Such a fundamental right being sacrosanct, cannot be breached under any circumstances." The latest ruling raises the bar for the state: An officer who violates the procedure must face a departmental inquiry; the case must be handed to a different officer, and any attempt to re-arrest the individual needs an endorsement by a superior officer and a magistrate's independent satisfaction within a week. The bench also said the release after an unconstitutional arrest should not be treated as bail — the detention was illegal to begin with. This distinction is significant because bail can be revoked by the state, but an unconstitutional act, once established, cannot be undone by the same authority simply by issuing fresh paperwork.

The ruling sends a message to the executive that procedure is not mere paperwork. Its direction to high courts to award "suitable mandatory compensation" in case of violation of Article 22 is important because a finding of illegality cannot be an end in itself. The verdict recognises the harm caused and suffered and makes the state accountable for the unlawful action.

After the rat race, the joy of work

WHAT HAPPENS to winners of the rat race? Athletes offer the starkest example: Most reach the pinnacle of their career when they are young, and the rest of life can, if they aren't careful, become a mere reminiscence of the glory days. Then there are the tech bros, with their billions, discovering MMA and bodybuilding, focusing on space and Mars, while the source of their wealth erodes people and nature. Most people accept retirement, hoping merely to rest after a lifetime of labour. For each, though, there is something to learn from Yoshihiko Noda's quiet devotion to his work.

Noda, finance minister of Japan and prime minister in 2011-12, spends a few hours every morning handing out pamphlets at Minami-Funabashi Station in Chiba. They cover issues such as disaster insurance and governance reform. Noda got his start in Chiba's local politics and it is a routine that, despite scaling the heights of the political ladder in Tokyo, he has returned to. Visible in his gesture is the difference between a job and a vocation.

The trappings of success can obscure what led to it in the first place. A writer, playing a part in literary salons, forgets the misery and joy of writing. The musician forgets the harmonies and discord that made her great, and the politician forgets the need to make things better. Noda, it seems, has not forgotten what made him choose the career he did. Perhaps the tech bros will take inspiration and stick to building apps.

A world on the brink, diplomacy and politics as usual

PRATAP BHANU MEHTA

SOON, Xi Jinping and Donald Trump will meet. World leaders will descend on the UN General Assembly. Yet another forum of leaders, P4M, with Canada, Europe, Brazil, and Kenya, was just announced. The SCO met at Bishkek. The BRICS summit has just concluded in Delhi. The liturgy of international politics continues. Talking is usually good. This has helped put a floor under the multiple crises. In some cases, like trade, these summits have opened up new options for the world and created new alliances. It has, to use the current buzzword, helped build resilience. Who knows what might have happened without all this activity? In all likelihood, we would be worse off.

At the same time, it is not difficult to shake off the deep vertigo this activity is inducing. One of the greatest novels of the 20th century, Robert Musil's *The Man Without Qualities*, had captured this well. It is, psychologically, a richly layered novel. I first read it right after the fall of the Berlin Wall, when its pessimism about modernity seemed out of place. But its disorienting force lingers in two respects. The first is the sense of a civilisation that is sophisticated, intelligent, inventive, smart, capable, refined, even if a little amoral and confused. Yet, it has no sense of how to mobilise judgement or political action to avoid impending catastrophe. But the second thing is the weird juxtaposition between a sense of impending danger, even catastrophe, and the normal routines of ordinary life and diplomacy. Leaders and people were not exactly ignorant of what was going on. They were not quite "sleepwalking". Everyone was aware of the momentous changes in politics, in technology, in society. They were daily news. But in a way, that was part of the paradox. Catastrophe talk or talk of dangers was just another one of those things. It is as if, in our times, the catastrophic melting of the glaciers and not quite getting the proportion of ice right in a cold coffee were on the same level of attention.

There is, of course, a virtue in not catastrophising; frenzy can produce fatalism or bad decisions. But the yawning gap between the machinery and protocols of international politics and the underlying historical dangers is quite striking. One temptation is to put this down to the absence of global leadership. One of the disturbing features of our current condition is that the fate of the world seems increasingly concentrated in the hands of a few individuals: Trump, Xi, a bunch of technology executives, and maybe a bunch of energy barons. In such a world, the characteristics of the few individuals seem to matter disproportionately. And yet never was the world more bereft of global leadership, if by leadership we mean the ability to rise above narrow self-interest and become a bridge between the interests of individual nations and global interest, between the present and the future. No one will expect Xi or Trump to play that role.

But you have to wonder if this is just about the quality of individual leaders we have. While individual leaders seem powerful, they are actually seriously constrained by each other. Neither China nor the United States can unilaterally frame the global order according to their whims. That is a relief. There are no hegemons. Countries can constrain each other. But they cannot produce collective action. Foreign policy is made under domestic constraints, and so it should often be. Governments are accountable to their citizens, who will care about the price of food, fuel, and employment. Domestic audiences in big powers also care about their national advantage: Leaders cannot surrender territory, accept defeat without facing domestic consequences, or be seen to concede technological advances to an adversary. The tension between national and global interests is baked into our sense of the normal. Not saving humanity might eventually be a disaster for any country, but trying to save it will often incur a high cost for the leader now. In normal times, these tensions are part of the fabric of international relations. We live with them, and they can be quite productive.

> You have to wonder: On a simple measure of significant risks to humanity — widespread war, climate change, pandemics, nuclear risks, and now possibly AI — is all this activity amounting to making us safer?

But when the magnitude of the risks has changed considerably, these tensions skirt at the edge of a breaking point, which is where we are now on every issue. In none of the wars that have systemic consequences for the world — Russia-Ukraine, America-Iran, Iran-Saudi, Israel and its neighbours — is there a bargaining solution within the current frameworks of territory, power and prestige. In AI, the incentives to accelerate, when driven by the quest for technological advantage, come just at the moment when the technology requires slowing down, regulation and deeper forms of information sharing. Climate negotiations have proved nearly impossible as each state protects its own energy security. Global debt seems an easy solution to economic woes. We want to continue to act normally when the stakes are no longer normal.

The summits will occur. The commitment to dialogue will be announced. The communiqué will be hailed as a triumph, as it was in the recent BRICS summit. The machinery working gives us a sense of normalcy. But you have to wonder: On a simple measure of significant risks to humanity — widespread war, climate change, pandemics, nuclear risks, and now possibly AI — is all this activity amounting to making us safer?

Musil's subtle point was not that we are foolish, ignorant or even depraved. It was rather that we might be rational, a bit too rational in taking our cues from normal times. Our leaders are doing what they are supposed to do: Preserve economic growth and energy security, compete for technological superiority, worry about the next election, and even stage the pageantry of summits. But conventional rationality and normalcy will not cut it. As in Musil's novel, a character says, "The function of diplomacy is to keep what we have." To this, the character Arnheim gives a dark reply, "Keeping what we have leads to war." The focus on Xi and Trump may make us forget just how stuck, and how much at risk, we are.

The writer is contributing editor, The Indian Express

Saving the rhino, restoring grasslands

BHUPENDER YADAV

FOR INDIA, the greater one-horned rhinoceros is much more than an iconic species. It is an integral part of the ecological and cultural landscape of the Brahmaputra floodplains and the Terai grasslands. The animal's historical range extended across the northern Indian Subcontinent, along the Indus, Ganga and Brahmaputra river systems. Today, its wild population in the country is concentrated mainly in Assam, UP and West Bengal. Under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, India is now pushing for the expansion of the rhino range.

The rhino conservation strategy is guided by the understanding that conservation should not be limited to safeguarding existing rhino concentrations but should work toward establishing secure populations across suitable parts of their historical range. The National Conservation Strategy for the rhinoceros, launched in 2019, provides a framework for strengthening existing populations, restoring the species to suitable former habitats, maintaining genetic security and habitat connectivity, promoting scientifically planned translocations and building climate resilience into rhino conservation.

The rhino's story in India is a story of recovery. The animal's numbers have increased from around 1,500 in the 1980s to more than 4,000 as of September 2024.

The five-year Phase I (2026-2031), proposed for support through the National CAMPA Authority, brings together Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and West Bengal, with a focus on scientific monitoring, protection, habitat restoration and management, translocation planning, coexistence and capacity building. It seeks not only to consolidate the existing populations but also to support the species' expansion into suitable areas in Bihar and Arunachal Pradesh.

The rhino's habitats are also important for swamp deer, wild buffalo, elephants, tigers, grassland birds and several smaller species. Grasslands are dynamic ecosystems that require science-based management to prevent degradation, inappropriate succession and the spread of invasive species. The Rhino Conservation Action Plan provides for mapping grasslands and wetlands, identifying invasive species, prioritising habitats for intensive restoration and developing protected area-specific management protocols.

This species-focused effort is complemented by a national initiative. A five-year (2026-2031) project on the Comprehensive Assessment of Indian Grasslands, to be implemented by the Wildlife Institute of India, Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education and Forest Survey of India, will assess grassland extent, ecological condition, biodiversity, degradation, ecosystem services and carbon potential. It will support a National Grassland Atlas, restoration priorities and long-term management guidelines.

Flooding is intrinsic to landscapes such as Kaziranga. But the increasing frequency and intensity of extreme climatic events can create new conservation pressures. Maintaining access to higher ground, securing ecological connectivity, protecting dispersal routes and managing habitats will be important. The National Conservation Strategy recognises climate-resilient management as part of the protection framework for the species.

Technology, too, has an expanding role. Modern surveillance, spatial monitoring, veterinary diagnostics, genetic tools and decision-support systems can reinforce traditional fieldcraft. No technology, however, can substitute the forest guards, watchers, mahouts, veterinarians and field officers who patrol these landscapes. Equally important are the communities living around rhino habitats. The future of the species depends on conservation being seen not as an isolated governmental activity but as a shared enterprise.

India's experience has also shown the importance of cooperation beyond state and national boundaries. At the Second Asian Rhino Range States Conservation Meeting held in New Delhi in 2019, India joined Bhutan, Indonesia, Malaysia and Nepal in adopting the New Delhi Declaration to strengthen conservation cooperation for Asian rhinoceros species. The Centre and the rhino-bearing states have since continued to work within this broader framework.

On World Rhino Day, September 22, we take satisfaction in the distance travelled. In protecting rhinos, we are also protecting the rivers, grasslands, wetlands, forests and communities that together make these landscapes among India's richest treasures. The rhino's recovery is a national achievement. Its future is a national responsibility.

> Grasslands are dynamic ecosystems that require science-based management to prevent degradation, inappropriate succession and the spread of invasive species

The writer is Union Cabinet Minister for Environment, Forest & Climate Change

How to ensure hospitals don't cheat patients

ABHAY SHUKLA

A DRIP set that costs a hospital Rs 11 carries a printed price of Rs 325. A syringe bought for under Rs 7 is marked for sale at Rs 57. These figures were recently released by Tukaram Mundhe, Maharashtra's Food and Drug Administration (FDA) commissioner, who has given several such examples of massive profiteering during the sale of medical items by hospitals. How does such inflation of margins impact the patient's bill? An earlier analysis of the bills of critical patients at private hospitals across Maharashtra, done as part of an audit process facilitated by Jan Arogya Abhiyan, gives striking answers.

Not one of the 46 medicine brands we examined was charged within the limit of 10 per cent markup on their purchase price, fixed during the pandemic. For nearly half the medicines, patients have been paying more than 150 per cent above what the hospital paid. A paracetamol drip bought for about Rs 33 was being billed at Rs 408. An antibiotic injection bought for about Rs 180 was being billed at Rs 950. The most common range of margins has been 200-400 per cent. The margins in the case of consumables can be even higher. A drip set bought for about Rs 12 may be typically billed at Rs 160, sometimes even Rs 270. An oxygen mask costing about Rs 55 can be charged up to Rs 570.

In 2016, a Department of Pharmaceuticals committee chaired by Sudhansh Pant noted that high MRPs were "a tool to cheat the helpless consumer" and that "fixing the MRP is, therefore, free for all and largely arbitrary in which the consumer is the net loser". This national body recommended capping trade margins on all medicines and implants, price-controlled or not, between 35 per cent and 50 per cent depending on their price. Yet 10 years later, these recommendations gather dust and patients continue to pay huge, unjustified margins on many medicines and consumables, which contributes to medical impoverishment.

Three steps are urgently needed. First, Maharashtra and other state FDAs can direct every private hospital to mention during billing, for medicines and consumables above a set value, both the price the hospital paid and what it is charging. A Rs 12 purchase printed beside a Rs 160 charge would tell consumers what is going on, supporting the logic for either the hospital to give a discount, or for the patient to purchase from alternative sources.

Second, the central government should expand statutory price regulation to all essential medicines and medical consumables (currently only 18 per cent of medicines are price controlled, that too in a manner that is often over-permissive). Such action would include appropriate amendments to the Drug Price Control Order, with the Department of Pharmaceuticals and National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority playing key roles.

Third, patients must claim a right they rarely use. Maharashtra's FDA ordered in 2016, and again in 2022, that hospitals cannot force admitted patients to buy medicines only from the hospital's pharmacy. The National Consumer Commission has called such compulsion an unfair trade practice, and this right is also mentioned in the National Patients' Rights Charter. All hospitals must display this right and the FDA should enforce it. Until these steps are taken, for most patients admitted in private hospitals, MRP will continue to mean "Manipulated Raised Price".

> The central government should expand statutory price regulation to all essential medicines and medical consumables. Currently only 18 per cent of medicines are price controlled

The writer is a public health expert and national co-convenor of Jan Swasthya Abhiyan

40 YEARS AGO
September 23, 1986

INDIAN EXPRESS
Labour panel split on restructuring industrial ties
Second tie in Test history
Soma bags India's second medal

Labour panel split

THE TRIPARTITE standing labour committee, which met in New Delhi to consider proposals for restructuring the industrial relations and dispute settlement system, found itself sharply divided on most of the points. While the Congress (I)-led INTUC and the employers' associations supported the move, central trade unions belonging to the opposition parties let it be known that they could not be a party to what the AITUC representative, Homi Daji, said was "regimentation of the workforce". Among the vocal critics of the proposals were the AITUC, CITU, BMS and UTUC (S).

Boy killed in police firing

A two-year-old boy was killed by a stray bullet in a police firing to quell a violent mob at Musafirkhana in Bombay. The firing was resorted to when the hawkers along the Musafirkhana road started brick-batting the customs and civic officials following a raid to confiscate the smuggled goods openly sold there.

Soma bags Asian Games medal

SHOOTER SOMA DUTTA won India's second medal of the Asian Games, a bronze in the women's air rifle event, but the cheer it brought was overshadowed as underdogs South Korea sprang a surprise and held India to a 1-1 draw in a Group A hockey match. India were lucky to be a goal up at half time. Mohinder Pal Singh scored from a 23rd-minute penalty corner.

Second tie in Test history

IT'S 5.18 and Greg Mathews prepares to bowl the fifth ball of his 40th over — the last of the innings. With one ball to go, all three results are still possible: A win for India, a draw, or a tie. Maninder Singh, number 11, prepares to take strike. The crowd holds its breath. 5.19 and history is made — it's a tie.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY
Germany's chancellor must change course to halt the rise of the AfD.
— The Guardian

READ. THINK. SHARE.
Scan the QR code to explore curated editorials and opinions from leading voices

AI is now a great-power game. Three difficult questions for India

RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

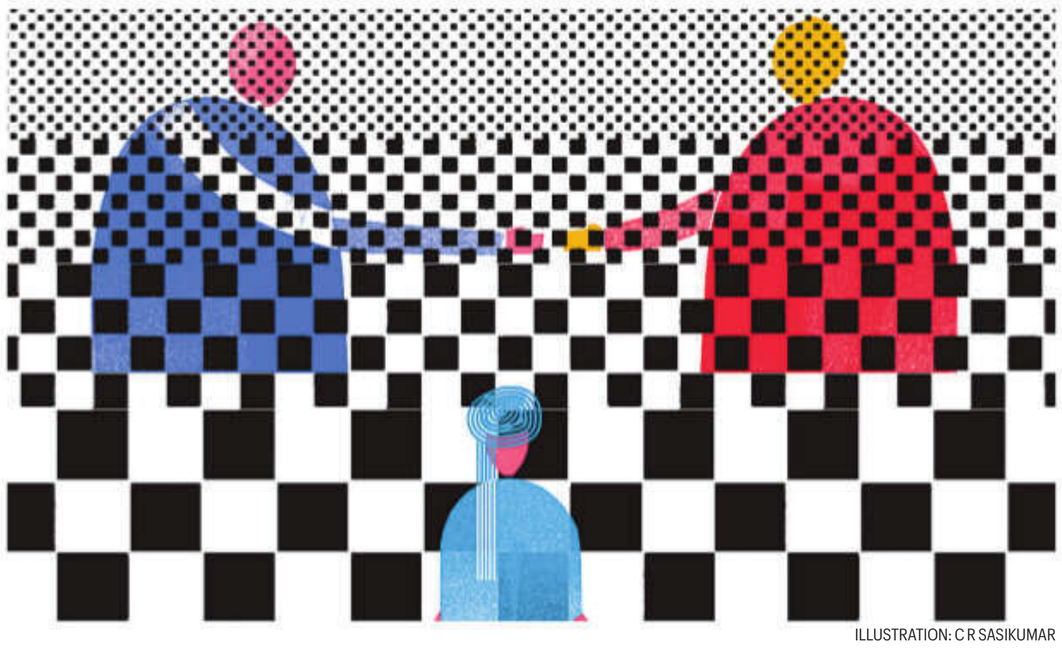


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

LARELY 10 days after using the Delhi BRICS summit to offer a Chinese vision of international cooperation on artificial intelligence, President Xi Jinping will sit down with US President Donald Trump in Washington on Thursday to initiate a formal bilateral dialogue on AI and its risks. Xi's journey from Delhi to Washington underlines an uncomfortable reality: The BRICS rhetoric on AI may be multipolar, but technological power at the frontier remains concentrated in the United States and China.

As Trump personally receives Xi upon his arrival in Washington and rolls out the red carpet, trade balances and export controls are expected to figure prominently in their third summit in less than 10 months. But AI is now set to become an integral part of the engagement between the world's two most important powers. The launch of a US-China AI dialogue could be a modest step towards managing the growing risks that AI poses to international security.

The Washington dialogue marks the flip side of the happy talk on AI at BRICS. In Delhi, Xi emphasised openness, access and diffusion. He invited BRICS members to join the World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organisation, launched by China in Shanghai this summer, and proposed an open-source AI community for the forum. Xi presented China as the champion of developing countries seeking affordable access to AI models and applications.

In Washington, the conversation will be about the other side of the AI revolution — the dangers generated by increasingly powerful frontier models and the need to prevent accidents, miscalculation and misuse. As the world's leading AI powers, the US and China are beginning to shape the security and geopolitical architecture of the new technology.

For India, this mixture of competition and collaboration between Washington and Beijing might be discomfiting, but it is also familiar. During the Cold War, the US and the Soviet Union competed and cooperated in the nuclear and space domains. Even as they engaged in a fierce struggle for technological and geopolitical advantage, they negotiated rules to reduce mutual risks. Those rules inevitably affected the rest of the world.

The emerging US-China engagement builds on a dialogue that began three years ago. The Biden administration opened a tentative channel after Joe Biden and Xi met at Woodside, California, in November 2023. The most concrete outcome came at Lima a year later, when the two leaders affirmed that humans, not artificial intelligence, must control decisions on the use of nuclear weapons. The principle was modest but important.

Under Trump, AI diplomacy has become more transactional — and more competitive. Discussions on safety are now entangled with disputes over advanced chips, export controls, rare earths, tariffs, computing power and the race to develop frontier models.

When Trump met Xi in Beijing in May, the two discussed possible AI "guardrails", but no formal arrangement followed. After talks in New York last weekend between US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Chinese Vice-Premier He Lifeng, Washington said the two sides had considered a standing AI dialogue and a notification system for incidents with national-security consequences.

> Delhi should welcome any US-China agreement that reduces the dangers of AI. But it also faces three difficult questions

Such a mechanism could eventually resemble a crisis-management channel. In a crisis, the first requirement is not agreement on the entire technological order. It is the ability to establish what has happened, whether it was accidental or deliberate, and who is responsible.

Although Washington and Beijing have been discussing AI for three years, their approaches remain divergent. The US wants a framework to manage the risks posed by powerful models and their military applications. China worries that discussions on safety could become another instrument for preserving American technological advantages or legitimising restrictions on Beijing's access to advanced computing. The two also disagree on open-source models, data governance, state regulation and the legitimacy of export controls. A grand AI bargain between Trump and Xi is not at hand. What they are seeking is a narrower understanding on strategic stability in the AI age.

Delhi should welcome any US-China agreement that reduces the dangers of AI. But it also faces three difficult questions. The first is how to navigate the technological contest between Washington and Beijing. India is part of the US-led Pax Silica initiative on technology and supply chains. This follows naturally from its deep integration with the American digital and AI ecosystem. Unsurprisingly, Delhi has stayed out of China's WAICO amid enduring security problems and mutual distrust. Yet, as a BRICS member, India cannot avoid the rhetoric on AI shaped by China, the forum's dominant power.

Second, India's emphasis on making AI work for developing societies found considerable resonance at the Delhi AI summit earlier this year. But China's deeper capabilities in computing, infrastructure, hardware and advanced models allow it to offer the so-called Global South a wider package of technological cooperation.

Third, Delhi will worry that a US-China dialogue initially focused on strategic stability could eventually become an effort to set rules for everyone else. Beyond the fear of an AI condominium is the concern that strategic stability between the two leading powers might produce discriminatory technology controls against others. The history of the nuclear order gives India ample reason for caution. Yet, US-China geopolitical rivalry and the competition for markets could not only limit such collusion but also create some leverage for emerging technological powers such as India.

India's successful engagement with AI will ultimately depend less on sweeping declarations about technological sovereignty than on its capabilities — in computing power, semiconductors, models, research, capital and human talent. Given the current gap between India's capabilities and those of America and China, Delhi's immediate imperative is clear: Deepen cooperation with trusted partners while building indigenous technological strength at home.

The writer is contributing editor on international affairs for The Indian Express. *He is a professor at the Motwani Jadeja Institute of American Studies, Jindal Global University*

From a jan sunwai in Delhi, lessons for poll body

NIKHIL DEY AND KONINIKA RAY

ON THE rainy morning of September 5, harried residents of Mangolpuri, Delhi, lined up at a *jan sunwai* (public hearing) to file claims and objections about being wrongfully excluded from the draft Special Intensive Revision (SIR) voter list.

Four days earlier, voters across Delhi had received a shock when the draft SIR list was published, with over a third of their names (over 47 lakh) "deleted", marked "absent, permanently shifted, dead, or duplicate" (ASDD). An additional 11 lakh voters had been dropped from the voter list altogether, and 32 lakh were to receive notices, thus amounting to the staggering figure of one in two voters in Delhi trying to get their names back onto the voter list. In a resettlement colony like Mangolpuri, this was a cause of extreme insecurity.

Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar recently certified the SIR process, claiming that "zero appeals have been filed against deletions in 12 states where the SIR has been completed". The testimonies at the Mangolpuri *jan sunwai* not only showed how wrong the ECI is in evaluating the SIR, but also why it is a process that is flawed in design. There are at least six clear lessons that emerge out of the public audit:

One, no matter what orders are passed, it is an almost impossible task for the booth level officer (BLO) to complete the mandated three visits to every house. In fact, many houses were not visited even once. Two, the *de novo* filling of enumeration forms by all voters shifts the burden of voter registration from the Election Commission to the voter. This is unprecedented, unwarranted, and is bound to result in mass exclusions. In 2002, the BLOs followed an SOP where they used the previously frozen voter list to go house to house and verify additions and deletions. That is a far more sensible method. Three, the requirement of proving citizenship by mapping yourself or your direct lineage onto the 2002 voter list has proved to be a nightmare, especially for migrant workers and women who have shifted due to marriage.

Four, the so-called logical discrepancies have imposed a tyranny and illogic of amplifying wrong data entries made over the years. Once again, the burden of correcting wrongly entered data falls on the citizen. Five, the overwhelming lesson from Mangolpuri is that this flawed and arbitrary SIR system must go. The appeal and grievance redress process also lies with the same machinery that is implementing this impossible exercise. Six, until such time as better sense prevails, the provisions in the election manual incorporating a public hearing at the panchayat, ward or booth level before any name is deleted or added must be implemented in letter and spirit.

The public audit process carried out in Mangolpuri did not just identify and prove the shortcomings and incorrect exclusions in the SIR process, but also demonstrated this as an efficacious method to update and revise the electoral roll. Unfortunately, this process has been almost entirely ignored by the ECI. The CEOs of three states — Karnataka, Telangana and Jharkhand — have issued perfunctory orders that can never be carried out in the one day they have allocated for this purpose.

The audit showed wrongful deletions in all the ASDD categories. Some of the anomalies were especially ironic. In 95 houses, one of the spouses had been marked as shifted while the other remained on the SIR list. In one case, a man called Kanta Prasad had been marked dead, and he came to the microphone asking what he could do to come back to life. Finally, two days after the *jan sunwai*, the CEO's office decided to respond through a press note and stood by their wrongful deletions in all six cases they addressed. For instance, the note stated, "In the case of Kanta Prasad, the elector was included in the ASDD list (under dead category) on the basis of information furnished by his family member, namely Shivanshu."

Shivanshu is Kanta Prasad's son. He has recorded a statement that he was tricked into signing a blank sheet of paper under the pretext of restoring his father's name. Instead of redress and accountability for incorrect deletions, the ECI requires all wrongly deleted voters to come back to the voter list by filling Form 6, where the voter is forced to sign a false declaration that they are "applying for inclusion in the electoral roll for the first time".

Instead of defending the indefensible, it would be prudent for the ECI to scrap this SIR process altogether. Even if the SIR is not scrapped, all its additions and deletions should go through a public audit process. Bringing this into effect as a safeguard against arbitrary deletions and exclusions in Delhi would be a good place to start.

Dey is a social activist and is working with the MKSS and Jan Sarokar. Ray is with the National Federation of Indian Women and Jan Sarokar

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Campus culture

RECENT DEATHS at IIT Delhi and IIT Bombay show that our campuses treat stress as a student problem rather than an institutional one ('For student well-being, rethink the campus, not just the student', *IE*, September 22). Young people are told to practise mindfulness while struggling with opaque grading, rigid hierarchies, and unsympathetic faculty. Resilience cannot replace reform. Universities must treat students as adults with rights.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

ONE THING is undeniably true: Students from "lower" caste backgrounds find the environment in IITs and other prestigious institutions "alien" and even "hostile" ('For student well-being, rethink the campus, not just the student', *IE*, September 22). If there is no caste on campus, why Dalit students are disproportionately dying on Indian campuses becomes a relevant and legitimate question to ask. Caste has its ineluctable victims on campuses, as in the outside social milieu. This reality must make the government and the wider civil society do what is needed to put vulnerable students from marginalised communities at ease.

G David Milton, Maruthancode

Houthi test

ANY REGIONAL arrangement involving Saudi Arabia and Yemen requires restraint and credible implementation ('Houthis are putting Mecca pact to the test', *IE*, September 22). The priority should be protecting civilians, preventing attacks on religious sites and keeping humanitarian access open. Regional governments should maintain channels for de-escalation and address violations through agreed mechanisms rather than retaliation. International partners can support relief efforts without replacing regional diplomacy. A durable settlement requires security guarantees alongside political dialogue and reconstruction.

S P Suganya Devi, Coimbatore

How much of food spending reaches farmers?

SUDHA NARAYANAN, BARUN DEB PAL AND ADITI GAUTAM

A WIDESPREAD concern for farmers in India is that they get only a fraction of the rupee that a consumer spends on food. But so far there has been virtually no systematic effort to measure the share of a rupee a consumer spends on all food that accrues to the farmer. Using the supply-use tables that map linkages and transactions between the different sectors in the economy, we use a technique called the "Food Dollar series" to trace how much of a rupee spent on food by consumers goes to the farm for the period 2011-12 to 2023-24. We estimate this for both food consumed at home and away from home.

When a consumer spends a rupee on food at home, as much as 57.8 per cent accrued to the farm in 2023-24 and just 8.4 per cent of food expenditures away from home. Three issues are worth highlighting. First, this difference between the farm share for food consumed at and away from home is expected. Food consumed away from home passes through longer chains, with restaurant preparation, service and associated trade absorbing value that would otherwise reach the farm. Second, the farm share for India is markedly higher than comparable estimates for most countries. Estimates for 61 countries over 2005-15 suggest that farms receive about 27 per cent of at-home food expenditure. Farm share of the amount spent on food away from home, too, is higher for India; for the United States of America, for example, it is just 4 per cent. Third, our estimates suggest that while farm share for food at-home expenditure has been increasing in recent years (from 51.8 per cent in 2011-12), that on food away from home has been declining, from about 10 per cent in the 2010s.

> Farm share estimates deserve cautious interpretation. First, as food travels longer distances or passes through more hands or transforms more, the farm share is reduced

Indian food habits are changing rapidly; yet household food purchases continue to be dominated by unprocessed or minimally processed, perishable, high-value items. The share of households consuming any PPF rose from 82.2 per cent to 96.6 per cent between 2011-12 and 2022-23, but over the period, as a share of total monthly consumption expenditure, PPF expenditures barely rose. Further, the processing industry is still dominated by low-margin milling, mostly unorganised and low in value addition. This implies that off-farm shares remain low. Eating out in India is growing, too, but accounts for an estimated 13 per cent of total food consumption, much lower than in the US and China. We can expect the farm share overall to decline as some of these trends become more prominent.

A low farm share in the consumer spending on food is often cited as evidence that Indian food supply chains are inefficient or unfair to the farmers; just as a high farm share is celebrated. However, farm share estimates deserve cautious interpretation. First, as food travels longer distances, passes through more hands or transforms more, the farm share is reduced. Sometimes long and complex value chains may reflect in a lower farm share but may also leave the farmer with higher net returns. For example, farmers earn just 3-5 per cent of the retail price for gherkins but make higher returns than for, say, tomatoes, for which they may get a higher share of the retail price. Second, even with a high share, farmers may not be making profits. Cooperative dairy farmers such as Amul have historically received more than 60 per cent of the retail price, but the increasing costs of inputs such as feed may nevertheless leave them with lower incomes if these costs are not passed on in the form of higher prices.

That said, a low farm share underscores the need to ensure that farmers can capture a higher share of the value added by post-harvest activities — via farmer ownership of downstream food, beverages and logistics enterprises and by expanding farmer participation in post-harvest activities. These mid- and downstream sectors are where future jobs and better-paying jobs are likely to emerge.

Narayanan and Pal are with IFPRI, India, and Gautam is with Michigan State University, East Lansing. Views are personal

Building trust is key in warnings on melting glaciers

STUART DUNNING

THE DISASTER that unfolded in Nepal and Tibet started with a rock-ice avalanche that transformed into a devastating debris flow, the kind that was responsible for the Dharali disaster in 2025. A rock-ice avalanche from Ronti Peak in 2021 also became a debris flow, causing the Chamoli disaster. None of these disasters is "natural". There are many rock avalanches each year and thousands of debris flows; it is only when they adversely impact our lives and surroundings that they become disasters.

The first reports from Nepal suggested an earthquake and, potentially, a glacial lake outburst flood (GLOF). GLOFs are indeed a source of risk to Himalayan communities. Several years ago, we calculated that 15 million people globally faced GLOF danger, over 9 million of them in High Mountain Asia, nearly 3 million in India alone. But in fact, the "earthquake" in Nepal was from the force of the rock-ice avalanche hitting the valley floor, and it became clear there was no glacial lake in the valley.

The Rasuwa disaster, therefore, was not a GLOF, and is more difficult to plan for, in the same way Chamoli was difficult to plan for. There was no large lake to model floods from, to drain if considered dangerous, or to add real-time monitoring to. Rock-ice avalanches could originate from many hundreds of thousands of steep, rapidly deglaciating slopes with thawing permafrost in the Himalaya. I'm sure, as the science progresses, we will find signs that the slopes were already moving before the disaster, but, as with many slopes, how do we decide which ones are the most dangerous and which ones need us to look at big decisions downstream on where we can and can't live? These are the kind of questions scientists, politicians and communities have to ask, as well as the benefits and risks of hydropower development in these environments. In both Chamoli and Rasuwa, a significant number of people missing or dead were workers in hydropower infrastructure that was in the path of these devastating flows.

> Rock-ice avalanches could originate from many hundreds of thousands of steep, rapidly deglaciating slopes with thawing permafrost in the Himalaya

For GLOFs, we know where the water will come from: The glacial lake. For the Rasuwa/Chamoli "hazard cascades", is it practical to have river gauges or monitoring in every single high mountain valley able to provide "enough" warning? I'm not sure it is. What is possible and existing now, and did exist in the Rasuwa event, provides enough warning for those further downstream, but not enough for those upstream. It is not just the detection of the event, it is also the communication of the news, how fast people respond, and what they do.

So, what is the future? Detecting moving slopes across the Himalaya is perhaps possible, working out which ones might catastrophically fail is perhaps not reliably so yet, and the consequences of getting it wrong are high. What is possible is a denser seismic station network. We know we can detect and locate the landslide-generated earthquake, and the extreme flood events themselves generate continuous seismic "noise" as they rumble down valleys, as with GLOFs. So, this is possible, but it has not been done. Why? It would need cross-border co-operation across the Himalaya and tens of millions of dollars. That is a societal and science challenge. We can do the science, but it must be embedded in communities who trust the warnings, and know what to do. We may save lives that way, but we do not save the places. And so, there are big questions to ask about sustainable development into the future and the pressures on new and old uses of land.

The writer is professor of applied geomorphology at Newcastle University, UK

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,MANOJ KUMAR,S/o-CHANDRADEO PANDITA,R/o-FLAT NO-1502,SHRI LAXMI RESIDENCY,PLOT/SEC-2B/INS-06,VASUNDHARA GHAZIABAD-201012 UP, have changed the name of my minor DAUGHTER RAGINI KUMARI TO KAUSHKI KUMARI 0040879794-7

I, Vikram Savio Bernard Vaz S/o Mathew Vaz R/o-A52/S3, Pankaj Apartments-3, Shalimargarden Ext-2, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Vikram Savio Vaz. 0071061828-1

I, Shabina Ahmad W/O Naseem Ahmad R/o D-96/1, Zakir Nagar, Okhla, Delhi-110025, Have Changed My Name To SABEENA. Permanently. 0040879795-5

I, Monika Gupta D/o Satya Narayan Gupta R/o D-15/254 Sector-3 Rohini Delhi -110085 have changed my name to Monika permanently. 0040879726-1

It is for general information that,I Shubham Pandey,S/o-Raj Kumar Pandey,R/o-H.No.-50/3,Street No.-5,Bhajan Pura,North East Delhi-110053, declare that name of my mother has been wrongly written as,MILON PANDEY in my 10th-class Certificate.The actual name of my mother is MILAN PANDEY which may be amended accordingly. 0040879787-4

I, Subham S/o Mohan Lal, holder of Indian Passport no. AE898482 and valid until 21.09.2035, r/o 1169, Near Atta Chhaki Pharal, Kaithal, Pin 136021, Haryana, India have changed my name Subham and surname Subham. 0040879790-1

I have changed my name from NADARAJAN to NADARAJAN PONVEL videMaharashtra Gazette notification number M-26307851 DATED 19/09/2026 0071061809-1

I,KUSUM RANI,W/O-ANIL KUMAR JAIN,R/O-HOUSE NO-50,3RD-FLOOR BLOCK-A P, SHALIMAR BAGH DELHI-110088 , HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO KUSUM JAIN 0040879793-7

I, POONAM, W/o NEERAJ TANDAN, residing at PANCHSHEEL BALAK INTER COLLEGE, GAD SHAHDRA, BISRAKH, JALALPR, DADRI, DISTT-GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR, U.P.-201301 have changed my name from POONAM to POONAM RANI Henceforth, I shall be known as POONAM RANI for all purposes. 0071061853-1

I,NAEEM AHMED,S/O-ABDUL KALAM,R/O.C 185/190,S/F GALI NO.4,NEAR BY SHARDA PUBLIC SCHOOL CHOUHAN BANGER GARHI MENDU,SEELAMPUR NORTH EAST,DELHI-110053,have changed my name to MOHD NAIM. 0040879796-3

I, Bhanu S/o Surender Kumar R/o A-161, DDA Flat, New Ranjeet Nagar Delhi-110008, have changed my name to Akash for all future purposes. 0040879700-1

I Thomas Varghese Edayanattu S/O, Oommen Varghese R/o A 304 Kairali Apartment Plot No 10 Sector 3 Dwarka Delhi Pin 110078 have changed my name to Thomas Varghese. 0040879691-1

I,MUNNALAL SHAH,S/o-KANHAIYA SAH,R/o-WZ-934/2, BASAI DARAPUR, RAMESH NAGAR,Delhi-110015 have changed my name to MUNGA LAL SAH 0040879794-9

I Mundrika Devi W/o Rameshwar Modi R/o Near Hanuman Mandir, Kundi Dhanwar, Masmohna, Koderma, Jharkhand- 825418 , have changed my name to Leelavati Devi 0071061831-1

I,Arti W/O Saeeduddin Ansari R/O B-6, Gali No-2,Indra Vihar, Chaman Park, Gokalpuri, North East,Delhi-110094.Have Changed To My Name To AYESHA 0040879795-7

I, Arti Kapoor,W/O Pramoad Inder Kapur, R/O-H.No.K-1/95,1st-Floor,EPDP Main-Road, Chittaranjan Park,Delhi,have changed my name Arti Kapoor to Aarti Kapoor and henceforth should for all purposes known as AARTI KAPOOR. 0040879699-1

I,Parmendra Singh S/O S N Singh R/O C-504,New Ashok Nagar, Vasundhra Enclave,Delhi-110096,have changed my name to Parmendra Kumar Singh. 0040879794-2

I, Mohammad Farooq S/o Karimulla Khan R/o B-24, Sector-10, Noida,Gautam Buddha Nagar U.P-201301 have changed my name to Mohd Farooq for all future purposes 0071061814-1

I, AMRITA W/O Amrendra kumar R/o C-510, Gaur Sportwood, Sector-79, Noida G.B Nagar U.P-201305 have Changed my name to AMRITA JHA for all future purposes 0071061862-1

I, Rajni Agarwal W/o Krishan Kumar Garg R/o H No-D-527 Second Floor, Tagore Garden Extension, Dist: West Delhi-110027, have changed my name to Rajni Aggarwal. 0071061859-1

I, Sangita Chatterjee W/o Sujay Bhowmik residing at 7B, LJS Enclave, Command Hospital Complex, Alipore, Kolkata-700027 have changed my name to Sangita Bhowmik.Sangita Chatterjee and Sangita Bhowmik both are the same person. 0040879880-2

I Heena W/o Syed Ghulfam Ali R/o 1429,Chatta Nawab Sahab, Farash Khana Delhi-110006 have changed my name from Hina to Heena for all future purposes. Hina & Heena both are same person. 0040879880-2

I,WASI KHAN,S/0-SHAFI ULLAH KHAN,R/0 1680 GALI SHABAN RODGRAN LAL KUAN DELHI 6 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO WASI ULLAH 0040879787-7

I,Kamal Sukhija R/O 306 Osaka Tower,Omaxe Heights,Sector-86,Faridabad-121002 have changed my minor daughter name from Manasvi to Manasvi Sukhija. 0040879794-3

I,Ravi Kumar Madaan,S/o-Jati Ram,R/o-Plot No.63,63A, Dichaon Enclave, Dwarka,New Delhi-110043,have changed my name to Ravi Kumar for all Purposes. 0040879793-2

I, Sonia D/o Om Prakash, R/o Village-Bairangpur Urf Naee Basti, Dadri, Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-203207, declare that my name Sonia Bhati has been changed/corrected to Sonia. Both names refer to one and the same person. Henceforth, I shall be known as Sonia for all purposes. 0071061835-1

I,Chandrajeet S/o-Sitaram,R/o-Jagamlan, Chhaprauli,Dehat, Bhagpat, U.P.-250617,have changed the name of my minor son Darsh aged-12 years and he shall hereafter be known as Daksh 0040879795-9

I Girish Manchanda S/o Des Raj Manchanda, R/o House No-64, Kaimri Road, Police Line Area, Hisar, Haryana, I have changed the name of my minor son Satvik to Satvik Manchanda aged 14 years. 0071061892-1

I,MOHD AYAN,S/o-MOHD RAIS, R/o.TA-69,Gali No.-4,Tughlakabad Extension, Kalkaji,New Delhi-110019, have changed my name from MOHD AYAN to MOHAMMAD AYAN for all future proposes. 0040879787-8

I,AZAD ALI S/O SHEKH TALIF R/O C-243 GALI NO.3 JAHANGIR PURI DELHI-110033.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHEKH AZAD. 0040879794-4

I, SUBUHI ARSHAD W/O MOHD ARSHAD R/O, 2390, Kothi Nawab Loharu Bazar Ballimaran DELHI 110006, have changed my name to SUBUHI NAZ Permanently. 0071061817-1

I,Anchal,D/O-Lalan yadav R/O C/27,Street No-1Ground Floor Sunil Colony Burari North Delhi-110084 Have Changed My Name To Anchal Yadav 0040879795-2

I, Shaikh Neelam Mohammed Farooq alias Shaikh Neelam Mohd Farooq D/o Mohammed Farooq, R/o F-163B, 2nd floor, Eastern Side, Shaheen Bagh, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi - 110025, have changed my name to Neelam Saba. 0050298219-1

I,Vijay Jadhav @ Vijay Ishrwar Jadhav,S/o-Ishrwar Jadhav,R/o-5172-73, Second Floor,Gali No.4,Krishna Nagar,Karol Bagh,Delhi-110005,have Changed my Name to Vijay Ishwar Jadhav Permanently. 0040879787-1

I,Jayashree Naik alias Jayashree K,W/O-Pradip Kumar Naik S/O. Arjun Naik Qtr No,673 1st floor Type 2 sector -8.R .K puram .New Delhi,Delhi-110022 , HAVE CHANGED MY NAME AND SHALL,HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS Jayashree K. 0040879787-10

I, Annie Thomas W/o Rojer John R/o 109, Kailash Apts, 45, I.P. Extension, Delhi110092, India have changed my name to Annie Thomas Rojer 0071061794-1

I,Seema Parveen W/o-Naushad Ali R/o A-186 PTS Colony Malviya Nagar Delhi-110017 Have Changed My Name To Seema Parvin Khan. 0040879793-4

I, No- 9111700W, Hav Bilal Ahmad Bhat, RO/Tehsil- Lalpora, District - Kupwara-193223. In my service record name and D o B of my son has been wrongly mentioned as Abu Huazifa, 29-12-2015 instead of Mohammad Aariz ,01-03-2017. It needs corrections. Objections be filed to concerned authority within seven days 0020520588-1

I, Monika c/o Shri Rajan r/o WZ-91, Second Floor, Street No.-13, Ramgarh Colony, Moti Nagar, New Delhi-110015 have changed my name as MONA. 0040879696-1

I,POOJA DEVI,W/O-POOJA KUMARI, R/O-FLAT NO 1502,SHRI LAXMI RESIDENCY, PLOT/ SEC-2B/ INS-06,VASUNDHARA GHAZIABAD-201012 UP,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO POOJA KUMARI. 0040879794-6

I, Isaruddin S/o Rahisuddin R/o-1254, Nai Abadi Dadri, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP have changed my name to Isaruddin Malik. 0071061827-1

I,Afsana Saifi,D/o-Naimuddin, W/O-Rehan Khan,R/o.G-28 Gali no.-18,Parwana road,Jagat puri,Krishna Nagar. East Delhi. DELHI-51, Have Changed My Name to FATIMA,for all future purposes. 0040879795-4

I, Sweta Goel, W/o-Manish Goel, R/o-G-45, Sai Apartment, Sector-13, Rohini, Delhi-110085 have changed my name to Sweta Jain Goel for all purposes. 0040879734-1

I,NANCY,W/o-Hardeep Singh, R/o-1/10374-B, Street No.-1-G, West Gorakh Park, Shahdara, Delhi-110032 have changed my name from NANCY To NANCY KAUR. 0040879787-3

I Shivani Haider W/O, Mohd Asif R/o 12/45 A Dda Flats Sarai Kale Khan Hazrat Nizamuddin New Delhi -110013 have changed my name to Shiza Haider. 0040879791-1

I, SHASHI BALA SHARMA ALIAS SUSHMA SHARMA D/o BRAHMA DUTTA SHARMA W/o RAGHUBIR NARAIN SHARMA R/o C-38, UPPER GROUND FLOOR, GALI NO-3, NEAR CHANDER NAGAR MOTHER DAIRY, WEST CHANDER NAGAR, KRISHNA NAGAR, PO: KRISHNA NAGAR, DELHI, 110051 have changed my name to SUSHMA SHARMA 0071061883-1

I ANKUSH KUMAR JAIN Son of PARVEEN KUMAR JAIN R/o House No. -1/5513A, Gali No. 6, Shivaji Park, Shahdara, Delhi - 110032 have changed the name of my minor son ATHARV JAIN aged 2 years and he shall hereafter be known as TUBHYAM JAIN. 0130069553-1

I,Ajay Kumar,S/o-K N Singh,R/O-Flat No-C-1114,SG Homes,Sec -3, Vasundhra, Ghaziabad, Pin-201012,UP, have changed the name of my minor son from Ojas Kashyap to Anush Kashyap all future purposes 0040879795-8

I, Sachin, S/o Kailash, R/o-I-13, Near-Nirankari Bhawan, Vijay Vihar, Phase-2, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Sachin Kumar, Permanently 0040879699-2

I,Priya Birthara W/o-Rahul Kaushik R/o A-2420 2nd Floor Greenfield Colony Faridabad Haryana-121010 Have Changed My Name To Priya Birthare. 0040879793-6

I, Suresh Yadav W/o No. 1374040F Rank Ex HAV Prem Parkash Yadav R/o House No- 450, Near Yadav Cloth House, Kapashera, Delhi - 110037 have changed my name to Suresh Devi vide affidavit date 21-9-26 before Delhi. 0071061852-1

I,MEHTAV SINGH alias PAPPU SINGH,S/o-LT SH MOHAN SINGH, R/o H. No. 31/238, Trilokpuri,East Delhi-110091,have changed my name to PAPPU SINGH 0040879796-2

I, Parbhat Peterson Gordon, S/o Ramesh Chander, R/o H.No.-1419/B, Street No.-13, Govind Puri, Kalkaji, New Delhi-110019, hereby declares and confirm that Parbhat Peterson Gordon and Parbhat P. Gordon refer to one and the same person i.e. myself for all purposes. 0040879693-1

I,OMINDER RATHI,S/o-NATTHU SINGH,R/o-Gali No.1,Village Gopal Pur,Delhi-110009 have changed my name to OMINDER SINGH RATHI 0040879794-8

I, Bharat Bhushan S/o Gokal Das Ramani, S-533, STREET-3, SCHOOL BLOCK-2, SHAKARPUR, Delhi have changed my name to Bharat Bhushan Ramani . 0071061830-1

I,Naseem Ahmad Khan,S/O-Munna Khan R/o D-96/1, Zakir Nagar, Okhla, Delhi-110025, Have Changed My Name To NASEEM AHMAD. 0040879795-6

I, Urmila Devi alias Urmila Gupta W/o Satya Narayan Gupta R/o D-15/254 Sector-3 Rohini Delhi -110085 have changed my name to Urmila permanently. 0040879726-2

I,Vaibhav Rathi,S/o-Ominder Rathi, R/o-Gali No.1,Village Gopal Pur, Delhi-110009 have changed my name to Vaibhav Rathi S/o Ominder Singh Rathi. 0040879787-5

I,Ajay Kumar Wadhwa S/O Shri Sant Ram Wadhwa R/O C-5/281-282, Sector-6, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Ajay Wadhwa. 0040879794-1

I, Pankaj Kumar S/o Subhash Village Jalpura, Kulesara, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201306, have changed my name to pankaj Singh for all future Purposes. 0071061813-1

I,ANSHOL KUMAR JAIN,S/O-ANIL KUMAR JAIN,R/O-HOUSE NO-50, 3RD-FLOOR BLOCK-A P,SHALIMAR BAGH DELHI-110088, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANSHUL JAIN 0040879793-8

I, ABHINAV VAIDYA F/O SHAMBHAVI VAIDYA R/O R-301, JALVAYU VIHAR, SECTOR-21, NOIDA, DISTT- GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR, U.P.-201301 have changed my daughter's name SHAMBHAVI VAIDYA to SHAMBHAVI BHARDWAJ for all future purposes 0071061858-1

Soniya W/o Deepak Lal, R/o RZ -20,GF Left Portion,Old Jankipuri, Uttam Nager Delhi 110059 Changed my Name as Soniya Rani. 0130069551-1

I,Neerja Yadav,W/O-Ashok Yadav R/O 2039,Rani Bagh, Delhi-110034 Have Changed My Name To Neerja Kapoor For All Future Purposes. 0040879793-1

I, Manbir Singh Bhati S/o Satbir Singh Bhati, R/o Village-Bairangpur Urf Naee Basti, Dadri, Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-203207, declare that my names Manbir and Manbir Singh have been changed/corrected to Manbir Singh Bhati. All names refer to one and the same person. Henceforth, I shall be known as Manbir Singh Bhati for all purposes. 0071061832-1

I,Shahbad Mohamad,S/O-Sh.Ayaz Mohammad R/O 71/D,BG-5, Opposite Post Office,Paschim Vihar,West Delhi-110063.Declare that my Son's previous name in aadhaar card is AQDUS Now I update his e-aadhaar card and now his updated Name is MOHAMMAD AQDUS. 0040879787-11

I, JASJIT KAUR W/O BALJINDER SINGH R/O 2113/164, 2ND FLOOR, GANESH PURA-B, TRI NAGAR, DELHI-110035 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO JASJEET KAUR FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071061804-1

I,NADANDAN GANGULA S/o-Jiwan Singh Gangula, R/o- A-1/82, Panchsheel Enclave, Malviya Nagar, Hauz Khas, New Delhi-17,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as NANDAN SSINGH GANGOLA. 0040879785-1

I, MAHADIK VARSHA DNYANESHWAR ALIAS MAHADIK VARSHA ALIAS VARSHA DNYANESHWAR MAHADIK D/o DNYANESHWAR MAHADIK W/o JATEEN UKRANI R/o 40/156 GROUND FLOOR, C R PARK, VTC: CHITTRANJAN PARK, PO: KALKAJI, DELHI, 110019 have changed my name to VARSHA DNYANESHWAR MAHADIK. 0071061816-1

I,TAYYEBA ATEEQ,W/O-TAUSEEF AHMED,R/O-8954 NAYA MOHALLA PUL BANGASH AZAD MARKET DELHI-110006 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO TAYYEBA FOR FUTURE. 0040879795-1

I,GULSHAN BEGUM,W/0-WASI ULLAH,R/0-1680 GALI SHABAN RODGRAN LAL KUAN DELHI 6 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GULSHAN JAHAN. 0040879787-6

I ANITA CHAUHAN W/O RAVINDAR KUMAR R/O A-1/745, SHALIMAR GARDEN EXTN-1,SAHIBABAD, GHAZIABAD, UP-201005 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANITA KUMARI FOR ALL PURPOSES. 0130069554-1

I,SWATI VATS w/o SHAILESH VATS R/o F-22,1st Floor sector-51,NOIDA GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR- UP 201301, have changed my name to SWATI SUMAN, 0040879787-9

I,AMARESH KUMAR,S/O-ARUN KUMAR JHA,R/O-HOUSE NO-103,THIRD FLOOR, SECTOR 47,GURUGRAM HARYANA-122018,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO AMARESH KUMAR JHA 0040879793-3

I, Sanjeev Kumar, S/o Rampal Singh, R/o 37B, Krishan Kunj Colony, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to Sanjeev Kumar Sancerwal, for all purposes. 0040879731-1

I,hitherto known,as Nitin Kumar,S/o-Raj Kumar Sharma, R/o-C-104,Lal Bagh,Loni, Ghaziabad-201102 U.P.have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Nitin Sharma. 0040879795-10

I,JULEKHA BIBI W/O SHEKH AZAD R/O C-243 GALI NO.3 JAHANGIR PURI DELHI-110033.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ZULEKHA BIBI. 0040879794-5

I, ABDUL QUIYUM S/O ABDUL HAKIM R/O, 1029 GALI CHABUK SAWAR LAL KUAN CHANDNI CHOWK DELHI 110006, have changed my name to ABDUL QAIYUM Permanently. 0071061819-1

I,Sapna Kumari,D/o-Sh.Diwakar Tiwari,R/o E-9,All India Transport,Sita Puri,South West Delhi, Delhi-110045, have changed my name to Sapna. 0040879795-3

I, SARTHAK CHAUHAN, inform that my mother's name is wrongly recorded as "MAMTA CHAUHAN" instead of "MAMTA" in my passport. Both belong to one and the same person vide affidavit dt 21.09.2026 0050298216-1

I,AMIT KUMAR GARG S/o-Raj Kumar Agrawal R/o-CGR-081, DLF-Capital Greens, Shivaji-Marg, Moti Nagar, Delhi-110015,have changed my name to AMIT GARG, permanently 0040879787-2

I,Rajwati W/o-Krishan Kumar,D/o-Deepchander R/o H.No-201 Chowk Wali Gali V.P.O. Punjab Khore, Delhi-110081 Have Changed My Name To RAJPATI. 0040879793-5

I, MEENAKASHI DAVI W/o No. 4546065N Rank Ex HAV (Late) Mahesh Chand R/o Plot No- 15A, Laxman Puri, Vipin Garden, Uttam Nagar, Delhi - 110059 have changed my name to Meenakshi vide affidavit date 21-9-26 before Delhi. 0071061850-1

I,VANDANA MOHAN PRASAD,W/O-VIJAY MOHAN PRASAD,R/O D-5/12,RAIL VIHAR,INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD,UTTAR PRADESH-201014,have changed my name to VANDANA MOHAN for all purposes. 0040879796-1

LOST & FOUND

I,do hereby undertake that,I have purchased e-stamp paper for the purpose of Sale Article-23 vide e-stamp No.IN-DL50879887905784T, dt. 16-Nov-2021,time 03:15 PM in respect of Property-No.4, Aram-Park, Shastri-Nagar,Delhi, has been lost/misplaced. Finder contact: Mrs.Ameena Ahmad wife of,Mr.Shauqeen Ahmad, R/o-H.No.C-573,Gali-No.1, Aram-park, Shastri-Nagar, Delhi-110031, Mobile No.9999025570. 0040879795-11

I,RAMA ACHARYA,W/o-Late PARSHOTAM DASS ACHARYA, the Original Allottee and Lawful Possessor of Flat No.34A, UNA CGHS Ltd.,Plot No.11, Mayur Vihar Phase-I,Delhi-110091,have LOST Original Conveyance deed of said Flat. Finder Please Contact - 9643091252. 0040879793-10

I, Seeta Devi C/O Munna Lal Sharma, R/O 98-99, 2nd Floor, Sector-6, Rohini, Delhi, I Have Lost Some where My Original Gift Deed Of Half Undivided Share In Third Floor Portion Pvt No. 2 With Roof Of Property Number 3978 To 3980, Chawri Bazar, Delhi, Which Is Free From All Encumbrances. Anybody Found The Same Please Return To My Above Said Address Against Handsome Reward. 0071061805-1

I Ramesh Chand Sadh, S/o Sh.Harish Chand Sadh R/o 76, Gali No.4, Gopal Park, Krishna Nagar, East Delhi,-110051 have lost my Agreement and Payment Receipt executed on 16.06.1976 by Sh.Gurditta Mal in favour of Sh.Nand Lal W.R.T. Property No.76, Gopal Park, Near Ram Nagar, Delhi-110051. Finders may contact at above address. 0040879689-1

NOTICE
APPLICATION FOR ALLOTMENT OF CAMERO SI REGIMENTAL SHOP

1. Air Officer Commanding, Air Force Central Accounts Office, Subroto Park. New Delhi-10 invites applications from War Widows/ Widows of Defence personnel killed while on duty, Disabled soldiers/Ex Servicemen and spouses/Widows of Ex servicemen etc for allotment of under mentioned shops in Subroto Park Complex at New Delhi.
   1.1 Bakery Shop at Ganga Shopping Complex.
   1.2 Tour Travels and Packers Movers at Ganga Shopping Complex.
   1.3 Tax Consultant Shop at Sangam Complex
   1.4 Refreshment shop at Sangam Complex
2. The applicable terms and conditions are mentioned in application form.
3. The application form is available from **24 Sep 26** at Service Institute, AFCAO, Subroto Park, New Delhi-10 between 0800 hrs to 1400 hrs on every day except Saturday, Sunday and holidays (Tele No. 011-25690477/23307359). The application form for tendering may be collected on payment of Rs. 500/- per application. The last date of deposit / receipt of completed application is **08 Oct 26** by 1400 hrs along with EMD (Earnest Money Deposit) of Rs. 5,000/- (Rupees Five Thousand only). The EMD should be in the form of Demand Draft drawn in favour of OIC SI Fund, **Payable at New Delhi.** After scrutiny of documents, eligible candidates will be intimated about the date and time of auction through candidate provided E-mail and telephone number (both).

Sd/-
(Amal Srivastava)
Wg Cdr
OIC SI Fund

UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H. O. "UJJAWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006, CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866
Tele.: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender No.853 Date : 22.09.2026

Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer, (M&G) Pathri Power House, Bahadrabad, Hardwar invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders is given below:-

1. Tender No.: 14/EE(Pathri)/2026-27 - Design, Modification, Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of Electro-Thruster Brake System in old draft tube gantry crane operational at Pathri Power House.
2. Tender No.: 15/EE(Pathri)/2026-27 - Supply & Application of protective coating material over the surface of stay vanes of Machine no.2 of Pathri Power House.
3. Tender No.: 16/EE(Pathri)/2026-27 - Annual maintenance works of Machine no.3 of Pathri Power House.
4. Tender No.: 17/EE(Pathri)/2026-27 - Repairing & Overhauling of Winch Machine of Pathri Power House.

Estimated Cost: ₹ 9,63,500/- (GST extra), ₹ 24,36,076/- (GST extra), ₹ 17,65,337/- (GST extra) & ₹ 5,42,500/- (GST extra) respectively.
Date of availability of bid document on website: 23.09.2026
Last date for submission of tender: 13.10.2026, up to 16:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (M&G)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client **Mr. Bhupender Singh** S/o Late Pritam Singh, R/o 866, Sunlight Colony-II, Hari Nagar, Ashram, New Delhi-110014 have severed his relations and connection from his son namely **Charanjeet Singh** & his wife **Smt. Preeti Neha** and disowned them from all his movable and immovable properties, my client shall not be responsible for their any act and whosoever deals with them, shall do so at their own risk.

Sd/-
A.K. Mishra
Advocate
Ch. No. 287, Patiala House Courts, New Delhi-110001

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client **Sh. Inderjeet Singh** W/o Parsandi Devi R/o B-818, Madipur Colony, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110063 has severed all his relations from his son namely **Mukesh Kumar** and his family and debarred him from all his moveable and immoveable properties due to his disobedience and misbehaviour. Anybody dealing with him will do so at his/her/their own risk. My client and his other family members shall not be responsible for his any kind of liabilities, dealings acts, criminal proceedings obligations, financial transactions, claims, etc.

Abhimanyu Sangwan (Advocate)
Ch.No. 315, L.C. Building, Rohini Courts, Delhi.

PUBLIC NOTICE

BE IT known to general public at large that my client **S. Charan Singh** S/o. S. Pritam Singh R/o. H. No. 3051, Gali No.5-A, Ranjit Nagar, New Delhi-110008 have severed all her relations with his sons **S. Jaspal Singh** S/o. S. Charan Singh & **S. Amarjit Singh** S/o. S. Charan Singh, as they both have been disobedient, damaged the reputation of the family, never took due care of me at time when I needed them the most, rude, quarrelsome & are not under the control of my client-aforesaid due to their fraudulent acts and questionable conducts. From here on, my client has debarred the said sons from having any concern with their movable and immovable assets and properties including future moveable or immovable property(ies) and if any person, organization & institution enters into any transaction(s) with them remains at own costs, risks & consequences and not binding upon my client in any manner whatsoever.

Sd/-
Devinder Pal
Advocate
Ch: 24, FF, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public that the Unit/ Shop No. 22, 23 and 24 situated at Antriksh Golf View-II, Sector-78, Noida-201301 (UP), which was allotted to Late Shri Som Prakash Agarwal & Mr. Sajal Agarwal vide allotment letter dated 19/02/2016, 19/02/2016 and 21/12/2015 respectively, is being transferred in the name of Mr. Sajal Agarwal Resident of K-607, Prateek Laurel Society, Sector-78, Noida Gautam Budha Nagar, UP and Smt. Mrs. Deepa Agarwal W/o Late Mr. Som Prakash Agarwal R/o 7/1361, Ansari Road, Near city Kotwali, Pul Dal Mandi, Saharanpur, UP-247001. All persons having any claim in respect thereof by way of sale, exchange, gift, mortgage, charge, trust, inheritance, possession, lease, lien or otherwise howsoever are requested to inform the same in writing to Colourful Estates Private Limited having office at -3/109, Nawada Housing Complex, Uttam, Nagar, New Delhi-110059 within 30 days from the date hereof failing which, the claim or claims if any, of such person/Entity or persons will be considered to have been waived and/ or abandoned and the transfer shall be done in accordance with law.

Sd/-
Nandlal Kumar Mishra
Advocate
SUPREME COURT OF INDIA

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरे मुव्वकिल (1) श्रीमती चंचल पांडे पत्नी श्री ओंकार नाथ पांडे (2) ओंकार नाथ पांडे पुत्र श्री राम बहोर पांडे दोनो निवासी CD-193 1st फ्लोर नियर RDPS पीतमपुरा दिल्ली-110034 ने अपने पुत्र शिवम पांडे को उसके गलत दुर्व्यवहार के कारण अपनी समस्त चल अचल संपत्ति से बेदखल कर अपने सारे पारिवारिक संबंध विच्छेद कर लिए है। भविष्य में यदि कोई व्यक्ति या फर्म शिवम पांडे से किसी भी प्रकार का लेन देन आदि कुछ भी करता है। तो वे स्वयं जिम्मेदार होंगे। मेरे मुव्वकिल एवं उनके परिवार की कोई जिम्मेदारी नही होगी।

KAMAL SINGH
(Advocate)
Enrl. No.D/748/2014

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Vimla Devi W/o Late Sh. Atar Singh R/o E-589, JJ Colony, Madipur, Paschim Vihar, Delhi 110063 being anguished and aggrieved by the misdeeds & misbehaviour of her son - Rakesh & his wife- Reena do hereby disown & debar him and his wife from all movable and immovable properties. They have been out of control of my client and living separately since April, 2026. My client has, therefore, decided to severe all of her ties and relations with them permanently and debar them. Anybody dealing with them shall do so at his/her own risk, cost & liability. My client will not be responsible for their any acts/deeds.

Ved Parkash Verma (Advocate)
Ch. No. 533, Rohini Courts, Delhi

Call or WhatsApp 9717006820 to advertise on classified page
The Indian EXPRESS
JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

"IMPORTANT"
Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-09
कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)
(30 प्र0 सरकार का उपक्रम)
2-शंकरनगर (नियर संदीप गैस एजेन्सी), दिल्ली रोड, सहारनपुर
NIT No.: 1818/E-Tender/188
Date : 19.09.2026

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय) की ओर से जनपद न्यायालय सहारनपुर परिसर में स्थित फास्ट ट्रैक कोर्ट का वृहद मरम्मत एवं रंगाई-पुताई कार्य अनुमानित लागत रू0 52.08 लाख (लेबर सेस सहित एवं जी0एस0टी0 रहित) हेतु दिनांक 01.10.2026 अपरान्ह 17:00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 22.09.2026 से दिनांक 01.10.2026 को 17:00 बजे के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट https://etender.up.nic.in से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते है तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 02.10.2026 को 13:30 बजे कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक यूनिट-09, सी0एण्ड डी0एस0 उ0प्र0 जल निगम (नगरीय), सहारनपुर में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य रू0 5900.00 (रू0 5000.00 + GST (18%) अतिरिक्त देय होगा।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की बेवसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल https://etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है । समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) https://etender.up.nic.in पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, **इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा।** निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

Army Public School, Birpur, Garhi Cantt Dehradun
(Co-education, English Medium Senior Secondary School
(Affilated to CBSE, New Delhi, Affiliation No – 3580012) www.apsbirpur.edu.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

1. Tenders are invited from high quality manufacturing Firm/Vendor/Suppliers for the following items for Army Public School Birpur, Garhi Cantt Dehradun:-

Procurement of Interactive Flat Panel Display and Stands	Last date & Time of Bid submission on 13 Oct 2026 at 1500 hr..	Date & time of opening of bid on 14 Oct 2026 at 1000hr onward.

2. Technical specification can be collected from main office, APS Birpur from **23 Sep 2026** onwards during school hrs. Technical Bid and Financial Bid must be submitted in two separate envelopes finally closed in one envelope. Vendors who qualify in technical evaluation, will only be considered eligible for the opening of financial bids. Technical specifications can also be downloaded from the school website **www.apsbirpur.edu.in**

PRINCIPAL APS, BIRPUR

KALYAN SINGH SUPER SPECIALTY CANCER INSTITUTE
C.G. City, Sultanpur Road, Lucknow-226002.
(An Autonomous Institute of the Govt. of Uttar Pradesh)
Email.id:Procurementservices.ksssci@gmail.com

Cafeteria Services at KSSSCI

It is hereby informed that **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8065916 Dated: 22-09-2026** has been uploaded on GeM Portal under category Revenue Based services - H1 Evaluation for Procurement of Cafeteria Services at KSSSCI. All interested service providers/ bidders are required to submit their bids on GeM Portal in accordance with the terms and conditions of the GeM bid documents. The Director reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids at any stage without assigning any reason thereof.

Note:
1. EMD Submitted through Account Payee, FDR, Banker's Cheque, Bank Guarantee will be accepted Physically and held valid for this Bid. However, UTR No. and a scanned copy must be uploaded with this GeM bid.
2. A pre Bid meeting will be conducted Physically OR Zoom Platform on 25-09-2026 at 11:00 AM, all interested bidders are requested to forward their email ids on **Procurementservices. ksssci@gmail.com** for forwarding the Zoom link.
3. **Site Survey is mandatory**

The Tender documents are available on the website of the Institute **www.cancerinstitute.edu.in**.

Advt. No. KSSSCI/Tender-17/2026-27 **Director**

उत्तराखण्ड पावर कारपोरेशन लिमिटेड
(उत्तराखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम)
कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता, विद्युत वितरण खण्ड (उत्तर)
18 ई.सी. रोड, देहरादून दूरभाष : 2652916 Email:eddndn@yahoo.com

पत्रांक: 4248 / विविख (उ)/ दिनांक 21/09/2026

निविदा सूचना

अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु उत्तराखण्ड शासन द्वारा प्रदत्त विद्युत कार्यों के लिए 'क' श्रेणी के लाईसेन्स धारक, वैध जी.एस.टी., ई.पी.एफ., ई.एस.आई.सी. के अन्तर्गत पंजीकृत, आयकर / पैन कार्ड धारक निविदादाताओं से मुहरबन्द निविदायें दो भागो में (प्रथम भाग में निविदा धरोहर धनराशि संबंधी घोषणा पत्र, नियम एवं शर्तें, उत्तराखण्ड विद्युत निरीक्षक द्वारा निर्गत 'ए' क्लास लाईसेंस की प्रतिलिपि, जी.एस.टी पंजीकरण, पैनकार्ड आदि एवं द्वितीय भाग में दरें जो कि निविदा खुलने की तिथि से कम से कम छः माह तक वैध हो) दिनांक 13.10.2026 को 14.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है जिसका प्रथम भाग उसी दिन 15.00 बजे उपस्थित निविदादाताओं अथवा उनके प्रतिनिधियों के सम्मुख अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा सार्वजनिक रूप से खोला जायेगा। प्रथम भाग के मूल्यांकन के बाद द्वितीय भाग खोला जायेगा। निविदा प्रपत्र किसी भी कार्य दिवस में वैध जी.एस.टी. धारक के द्वारा दिनांक 12.10.2026 (14:00 बजे) तक अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय से निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य नगद (अप्रतिदेय) जमा कर क्रय किये जा सकते हैं। बिना निविदा धरोहर धनराशि व अन्य संबंधित घोषणा पत्र के निविदा भाग-2 नहीं खोली जायेंगी। निविदा खुलने की तिथि में अवकाश होने/अधोहस्ताक्षरी के मुख्यालय से बाहर होने पर अगले कार्य दिवस को निविदा खोली जाएगी। अधोहस्ताक्षरी को यह अधिकार होगा कि वह बिना कारण बताये समस्त अथवा किसी भी निविदा को निरस्त कर सकते हैं। विस्तृत नियम एवं शर्ते निविदा प्रपत्र में वर्णित हैं।

निविदा संख्या 25/EDD(N)/2026-2027, WORK - REPLACEMENT OF BOTTAM DAMAGED POLE DHAKPATTI SECTION UNDER EDSD ANARWALA EDD (NORTH) की धरोहर राशि रू० 30,000.00, निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य रु० 1000.00 G.S.T.EXTRA.

निविदा संख्या 26/EDD(N)/2026-2027, WORK GIVING NEW SERVICE CONECTION WORK IN EDSD ANARWALA, UNDER EDD (NORTH), DEHRADUN की धरोहर राशि रू0 45,000.00, निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य रु० 1,000.00 G.S.T.EXTRA.

किसी भी विद्युत समस्या के लिए सम्पर्क करें टोल फ्रि न० 18004190405
"राष्ट्र हित में बिजली बचायें।"

अधिशासी अभियन्ता
विद्युत वितरण खण्ड (उत्तर)

रजिस्ट्री सं.डी एल.-33004/99 REGE.NO. D.L.-33004/99

भारत का राजपत्र
The Gazette of India
सी.जी.-डी.एल.-अ.-15092026-276230
CG-DL-E-15092026-276230
असाधारण
EXTRAORDINARY
भाग II-खण्ड 3-उप-खण्ड (ii)
PART II-Section 3-Sub-section (ii)
प्राधिकार से प्रकाशित
PUBLISHED BY AUTHORITY

सं. 4754] नई दिल्ली, मंगलवार, सितम्बर 8, 2026/भाद्र 17, 1948
No.4754] NEW DELHI, TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2026/BHADRA 17, 1948

सड़क परिवहन और राजमार्ग मंत्रालय
अधिसूचना
नई दिल्ली, 8 सितम्बर 2026

का.आ. 4944 (E) (अ).— केन्द्रीय सरकार ने, राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग अधिनियम, 1956 (1956 का 48) (जिसे इसमें इसके पश्चात उक्त अधिनियम कहा गया है) की धारा 3क की उपधारा (1) के अधीन जारी की गई भारत सरकार के सड़क परिवहन और राजमार्ग मंत्रालय की अधिसूचना संख्या का. आ. **2915 (E) तारीख 8 June 2026, 3118 (E) तारीख 15 June 2026** जो भारत के राजपत्र, असाधारण, भाग II, खण्ड 3, उपखंड (ii) में प्रकाशित की गई थी, द्वारा उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य के साथ मथुरा जिले के गाँव-आझई कलां, भरितया, तालुका-छाता और गाँव-डांगौली खादर, बेगमपुर खादर, अर्रुआ बांगर, अर्रुआ खादर, भीम खादर, पिपरौली बांगर, तालुक-माँट और गाँव-आटस बांगर, जैत, तालुका-सदर में NH 44 के कि.मी. 0 से कि.मी. 15.34 तक के भूखण्ड पर टोल प्लाजा के निर्माण, अनुरक्षण, प्रबंधन और प्रचालन के लिए उस अधिसूचना से उपाबद्ध अनुसूची में विनिर्दिष्ट भूमि का अर्जन करने के अपने आशय की घोषणा की थी; और उक्त अधिसूचना का सार उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3क की उपधारा (3) के अधीन तारीख 14.06.2026 "को" दैनिक जागरण (हिन्दी)" और "द इंडियन एक्सप्रेस (अंग्रेजी)" व 20.06.2026 को "दैनिक जागरण हिन्दी)" और "द इंडियन एक्सप्रेस (अं ग्रेजी)" दोनों में प्रकाशित किया गया था जबकि सक्षम प्राधिकारी को धारा 3-ग के तहत दायर आपत्ति प्राप्त हुई है, जिस पर विचार किया गया है और उसका उचित रूप से निपटान किया गया; और सक्षम प्राधिकारी उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3घ की उपधारा (1) के अनुसरण में, केन्द्रीय सरकार को अपनी रिर्पोट दे दी है।

अतः अब, केन्द्रीय सरकार, सक्षम प्राधिकारी की उक्त रिर्पोट प्राप्त हो जाने पर और उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3घ की उपधारा (1) द्वारा प्रदत्त शक्तियों का उपयोग करते हुए, यह घोषणा करती है कि उक्त अनुसूची में विनिर्दिष्ट भूमि का पूर्वोक्त प्रयोजन के लिए अर्जन किया जाना चाहिए। और अब केन्द्रीय सरकार, उक्त अधिनियम की धारा 3घ की उपधारा (2) के अनुसरण में यह घोषणा करती है कि इस अधिसूचना के राजपत्र में प्रकाशन पर, उक्त अनुसूची में विनिर्दिष्ट भूमि सभी विल्लंगमों से मुक्त होकर आत्यन्तिक रूप से केन्द्रीय सरकार में निहित हो जायेगी।

अनुसूची
उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य के मथुरा जिले के गाँव-आझई कलां, भरितया, तालुक-छाता और गाँव-डांगौली खादर, बेगमपुर खादर, अर्रुआ बांगर, अर्रुआ खादर, भीम खादर, पिपरौली बांगर, तालुक-माँट और गाँव-आटस बांगर, जैत, तालुक-सदर में NH44 के कि.मी. 0 से कि.मी. 15.34 के लिए अर्जन की जाने वाली संरचना सहित अथवा संरचना रहित विवरण।

फाईल नंबर CE-RO/LKO/NH-19/2024-25/754/3D
शेख अमीनखान, निदेशक

जिला मथुरा https://egazette.gov.in, **प्रकाशन तिथि**- 08/09/2026, https://egazette.gov.in, https://bhoomirashi.gov.in
नोट- इस अधिसूचना की वास्तविक प्रति सीएएलए/पीआईयू/पीएमयू/आरओ/ईडी के कार्यालय में भी उपलब्ध है और भूमि मालिक वहाँ भी अधिसूचना देख सकते हैं।,

MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT AND HIGHWAYS
Notification
New Delhi, the 8 September 2026

S.O. 4944(E) (E). –Whereas by the notification of the Government of India in the Ministry of Road Transport and Highway, **S.O. 2915(E) Dated:8 June 2026, 3118(E) Dated:15 June 2026** published in Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part II, Section 3, Sub-section (ii) issued under sub-section (1) of section 3A of the National Highway Act, 1956 (48 of 1956) (hereinafter referred to as the said Act), the Central Government declared its intention to acquire the land specified in the Schedule annexed to the said notification for building (widening /four-laning, etc.), maintenance, management and operation of NH44 in the stretch of land from Km. 0 to Km. 15.34 in the village(s) namely- Ajhai Kalan, Bhartiya Taluk- Chhata and in the village(s) namely- Arruwa Bangar, Arruwa Khadar , Begampur Khadar, Bheem Khadar, Dangoli Khadar , Piproli Bangar Taluk- Mant and in the village(s) namely- Atas Bangar, Jait Taluk- sadar in the district of MATHURA in the state of UTTAR PRADESH And whereas the substance of the said notification has been published in Dainik Jagaran(Hindi)" and "The Indian Express(English)" both dated 14/06/2026 , and 20/06/2026 under sub-section (3) of section 3A of the said Act; And whereas the Competent Authority has received objections filed under Section 3-C, considered and settled the same appropriately; And whereas, in pursuance of sub-section (1) of section 3D of the said Act, the Competent Authority has submitted its report to the Central Government; Now, therefore, upon receipt of the said report of the Competent Authority and in exercise of the powers conferred by the sub-section (1) of section 3D of the said Act, the Central Government hereby declares that the land specified in the said Schedule should be acquired for the aforesaid purpose; And further, in pursuance of sub-section (2) of section 3D of the said Act, the Central Government hereby declares that on publication of this notification in the Official Gazette, the land specified in the said Schedule shall vest absolutely in the Central Government, free from all encumbrances.

SCHEDULE

Brief Description of the land to be acquired with or without structures falling NH44 in the stretch of land from Km. 0 to Km. 15.34 in the village(s) namely- Ajhai Kalan, Bhartiya Taluk-Chhata and in the village(s) namely- Arruwa Bangar, Arruwa Khadar , Begampur Khadar, Bheem Khadar, Dangoli Khadar , Piproli Bangar Taluk-Mant and in the village(s) namely- Atas Bangar, Jait Taluk-sadar in the district of MATHURA in the state of UTTAR PRADESH 6887GI/202

File Number: CE-RO/LKO/NH-19/2024-25/754/3D
Shaikh Amin khan , Director.

District: MATHURA, https://egazette.gov.in, Publication Date: 08/09/2026,https://egazette.gov.in, https://bhoomirashi.gov.in
Note : The physical copy of this notification is also available at the office of CALA/PIU/PMU/RO/ED and Landowners may also see the notification there.

Lakhimpur Kheri case: SC asks Allahabad CJ to look into claims against trial judge

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 22

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday directed the Chief Justice of the Allahabad High Court to look into concerns raised by families of the victims of 2021 Lakhimpur Kheri violence against the judge conducting the trial in the case.

Appearing for the applicants, advocate Prashant Bhushan alleged that the presiding judge had withdrawn many cases under the SC/ST and NDPS Act to himself and given bail to the accused. He said if the concerned judge continues to hear the case, it will result in acquittal, "The officer has to be changed. There will be a complete miscarriage of justice if this officer continues with this case".

Later, the court said, "Let a copy of this Interlocutory Application... be placed before the CJ of Allahabad HC... request to look into it and take appropriate remedial action."

The three-judge bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana asked the HC Chief Justice to submit a report on action taken in a sealed cover before the next hearing.

The court has also asked the UP government to appoint a senior public prosecutor for the case after it was flagged that the current officer lacks experience, "Let the State government take instructions and place on record its affidavit within two weeks as to which senior, experienced public prosecutor can be allocated for the case".

When Bhushan reiterated concerns regarding the judge, Justice Bagchi said, "We have no superintendence over the officer which is vested with the HC concerned. So, you must take it up with the HC."

The Lakhimpur Kheri case pertains to an October 2021 incident in which four anti-farm law protesters were killed when a convoy of vehicles, including one belonging to former Union Minister of State Ajay Mishra, ran over them. In the ensuing violence, two BJP workers, a driver of one of the vehicles and a journalist were killed. The SC has been monitoring the trial's progress, wherein main accused is Ajay Mishra's son, Ashish.

3 infants killed as fire breaks out at Telangana hospital

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, September 22

THREE INFANTS died after a fire broke out in the special neonatal care unit at Rajiv Gandhi Institute of Medical Sciences in Adilabad, Telangana, late Monday night. Two nurses and several hospital workers suffered burn injuries while rescuing around 28 infants.

The incident is suspected to have occurred after an air-conditioning unit exploded around 11.30 pm, triggering a massive fire.

All the three infants killed in the fire were females and born pre-term, at 28 weeks. Relatives said a door at the hospital had got locked after the explosion. Parents and hospital staff reportedly broke the ward's glass panes to rescue the babies as thick smoke engulfed the incubators. Firefighters battled the blaze for more than an hour before bringing it under control.

Officials said a five-day-old infant died at the scene, while another newborn succumbed during treatment late on Monday night. The third infant died on Tuesday morning due to smoke inhalation. The victims' families are from the Ichchoda, Indravelli and Utnoor areas, said officials.

Adilabad District Collector Rajarshi Shah said several infants among the 28 evacuated from the neonatal ward developed breathing complications. State Health Minister Damodar Raja Narasimha said three babies were shifted to a private hospital in Adilabad and two others were moved to Nizamabad for further treatment.

Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy has ordered an inquiry into the incident and directed officials to ensure the best possible treatment for the affected babies. He has also instructed the authorities to continuously monitor their health and ordered a safety and fire-prevention audit of all government hospitals in the state.

The police and fire department officials are investigating whether an AC unit malfunction or a short circuit triggered the blaze. M Fasil, who lost his five-day-old daughter in the blaze, says he last saw her on Monday night. "The doctor had allowed me into the Special Neonatal Care Unit... I was there for just 5-6 minutes, saw my daughter and prayed for her speedy recovery before coming out."

Born pre-term at a private hospital, Fasil's daughter was shifted to the government-run RIMS for life-saving treatment. "Now she is dead. What do I tell my wife Saba, who is admitted to a different hospital? Who is to blame for this? Who is going to bring my daughter back?" asks Fasil as his brother tries to console him.

His daughter weighed 1 kg when she was brought to RIMS on September 18. She died at 12.30 am, an hour after the fire broke out. He says he heard the first explosion. "The hospital staff is saying one unit exploded but... several AC units exploded inside due to which the fire spread so quickly," says Fasil, who hails from Indravelli — 36 kms from Adilabad.

Another parent who lost her baby is Shaik Bai from Ichoda, 32 kms away. Born pre-term 15 days ago, Bai's daughter weighed 1.3 kgs when she was brought to RIMS last week. She died at 4.35 am on Tuesday.

The third and youngest baby who died in the fire was the daughter of Saba Samreen from Utnoor. Born on Sunday, she weighed 1.3 kgs. After rescuing her from the burning SNCU, her father rushed her to Nizamabad Government General Hospital where she succumbed at 6.15 am.

None of the three babies had been named yet.

"There was chaos when the ACs started exploding. Everyone, including the nurses and doctors, rushed out and then, realising what was happening, went in again to rescue the infants. By then, thick smoke had enveloped the unit and nothing was visible," says a relative of Shaik Bai.

Hospital workers and fire fighters rescued 28 infants from the Special Newborn Care Unit at the state-run hospital in Adilabad. PTI

Starting this week, IAF to host second edition of multinational air exercise Tarang Shakti

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 22

THE INDIAN Air Force (IAF) will host the second edition of its largest-ever multinational air exercise, Tarang Shakti-26, beginning later this week in Jodhpur.

Around 40 countries are expected to participate in the exercise, which will bring together a range of advanced combat aircraft, including US F-35s, French Rafales and UAE F-16s, along with other aerial assets, for joint aerial operations, tactical training and interoperability drills.

The exercise, to be held between September 26 and October 12 at Air Force Station, Jodhpur, and adjoining air bases will see participation from eight forces — India, Australia, Bangladesh, France, the US, Germany, Sri Lanka and UAE. Thirty-two countries will attend the event as observers. Around 10 Air Chiefs or equivalents are likely to attend the exercise.

The maiden edition of the exercise took place in August-September 2024 in two phases.

India's Rafale, Mirage-2000, Jaguar, Tejas, MiG-29, Su-30 MKI will participate in the exercise, along with the US's F-35, France's Rafale, the UAE's F-16 and Bangladesh's C-130J, besides other air assets.

Explaining the criticality of the exercise, Vice-Chief of Air Staff Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit told mediapersons on Tuesday that Tarang Shakti has changed the earlier approach of having an operational engagement with foreign air forces largely through bilateral exercises.

Talking about the first edition of the exercise, when 11 countries participated with their air assets and covered a wide canvas of air operations, he said it was an important transition from exercises primarily being bilateral to planning, operating and integrating with multiple air forces simultaneously for the IAF. "So Tarang Shakti-26 is the next logical step," he said.

The exercise aims to analyse tactical employment philosophy against modern Air-to-Air and Surface-to-Air weapons, to enhance interoperability among the participating forces and to identify best practices in operations. It will involve Beyond Visual Range and within Visual Range combat missions, air mobility operations and dynamic targeting, air-to-air refuelling missions and combat search and rescue operations.

Air Marshal Dixit emphasised that as world changes rapidly and nature of warfare evolves, recent conflicts have highlighted the critical importance of precision, integrated air defence, unmanned systems, information dominance, space-based capabilities and the ability to integrate these elements into multi-domain operations. "Operation Sindoor has reinforced many of these realities for us. It demonstrated the importance of intelligence-led operations, precision, integrated air and missile defence, counter-UAS, and jointness across domains."

"We do not conduct Tarang Shakti to demonstrate what we already know. We conduct it to discover what we still need to learn. Our operational experience, including Operation Sindoor, gives us lessons," he said adding: "Our partners bring their own operational experience. Bringing these together in a realistic training environment allows us to test assumptions, challenge procedures, understand different methods of employing air power and improve interoperability."

Vice-Chief of the Air Staff Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit addresses a press conference in the Capital on Tuesday. PTI

Don't upload docs on AI, MP DGP tells personnel

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 22

THE MADHYA Pradesh Police has tightened its rules governing social media use by its personnel, explicitly barring officers and employees from uploading confidential government documents on AI tools such as ChatGPT and Gemini, while also restricting reels, monetisation, political symbols, and disclosure of sensitive police operations.

The 24-point "M.P. Police Social Media Guideline-2026", issued by Director General of Police Kailash Makwana on Monday, lays down rules covering Facebook, WhatsApp, X, Instagram, YouTube and other social media platforms.

One of the guidelines states: "Government documents shall not be scanned, screenshotted or shared on social media in any other manner if they contain any information that is required to be kept confidential under government rules or is sensitive from a security perspective. Besides this, such documents/information shall not be uploaded on AI tools such as ChatGPT, Gemini, etc."

Personnel have been told not to disclose nature of sensitive assignments or their locations online, and to keep location and geo-tagging options switched off while using social media at "sensitive" workplaces.

POCSO case against foreign coach over sexual assault of minor athlete in Patiala

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, September 22

PUNJAB POLICE has booked a foreign coach on charges of raping a minor athlete at a training camp in Patiala.

The national sports federation with which the coach was employed for training the athletes has confirmed the development and said that the "coach was absconding", but "they have his passport and other relevant documents in their possession".

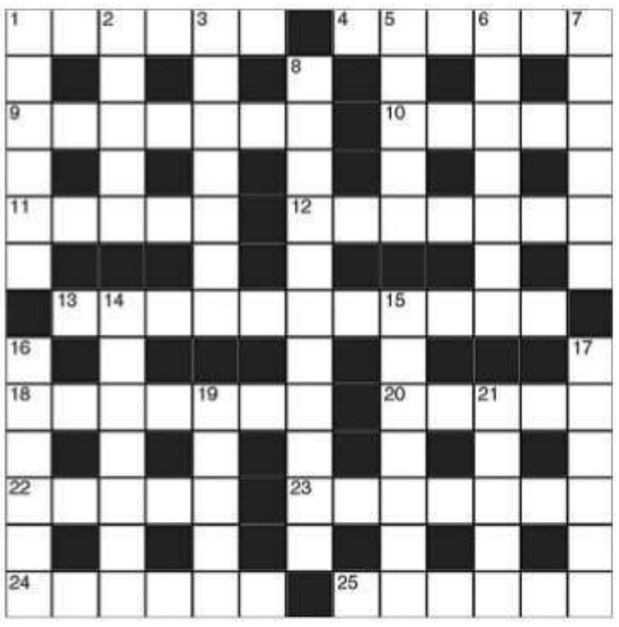
The incident took place on September 13 in Patiala and the matter was reported to the federation's key officials on September 18. One of the senior office bearers of the federation said, "The incident was reported to the federation on September 18 and the same day a complaint was lodged with the police and an FIR was registered within a few hours. We also filed a complaint with the Internal Complaints Committee of the federation for an investigation into the coach's conduct." Punjab police officers also said that the coach is "absconding".

Patiala City SP said, "When the complained was reported to us, the coach was in Delhi. The federation authorities approached us and informed us that the coach had been absconding after the incident. The FIR was lodged at PS-Civil Lines on September 18 under Section 64 (rape), 352 (intentional insult) of the BNS Act and Section 6 (aggravated penetrative sexual assault) of POCSO Act. We are investigating the case and necessary action is being taken to nab the accused."

The foreign coach had joined the federation in November, last year. At the time of the FIR, he was in Delhi at a training camp ahead of the Asian Games in Japan.

The federation officials said that "after the allegations came to our notice, we revoked the coach's travel clearance".

• CROSSWORD 6101



ACROSS
1 Nod when told to go (6)
4 Family stress (6)
9 Break silence before treat is ruined (7)
10 Frosted look seen when I'm in debt? (5)
11 Brush and clean thoroughly (5)
12 Straightens things out and becomes more friendly (7)
13 His work is above most people (11)
18 Men said to be not men at all (7)
20 There are four to each deck used for lifting (5)
22 The ban is also about opening two letters (5)
23 One benefits from such a policy (7)
24 Yarn that's embroidered (6)
25 Ill-suited for obligations (6)

DOWN
1 Part of the mass is identified with St. Francis (6)
2 Heavenly body; one seen in flight (5)
3 Distinguished though plainly ineffective (7)
5 Feverish activity in temples? (5)
6 Girl can put up a calendar (7)
7 He's barely seen in camp (6)
8 Foreign money in great volume could be awkward (11)
14 Handy cover for a sewer (7)
15 One may get belted taking part in this sport (7)
16 A sick benefit prescription? (6)
17 Quiet comments made when on a date in Rome (6)
19 Take sweetheart and run (5)
21 Tooth one has right in the middle — a canine (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6100 **ACROSS:** 1 Against, 5 Award, 8 Close quarters, 9 Tryst, 10 Arsenal, 11 Eponym, 12 Apathy, 15 Postern, 17 Exact, 19 Reinstatement, 20 Ratty, 21 Treadle **DOWN:** 1 Ascot, 2 Anonymous gift, 3 No entry, 4 Toucan, 5 Arras, 6 A means to an end, 7 Display, 11 Emperor, 13 Precede, 14 Intact, 16 Essay, 18 Title

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

A ___ ____ is usually thinking about something else - Kin Hubbard (4,8)

REDYE

ENNILT

DGOOS

EEUDGN

SOLUTIONS: Reedy, Goods, Linnet, Dengue
ANSWER: A **good listener** is usually thinking about something else - Kin Hubbard

• OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

• CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON

• MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

SUDOKU 6450

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s
INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

		9					3	
2				8				7
	5				6	8		
	6	2	8		7	1		
	1			5			8	
		7	6		3	9	5	
		8	5				6	
3				7				5
	2					4		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6449

3	7	4	8	2	1	6	5	9
8	1	6	7	5	9	2	4	3
5	2	9	3	6	4	1	7	8
2	9	8	1	4	7	5	3	6
7	3	1	6	8	5	4	9	2
6	4	5	9	3	2	7	8	1
4	8	3	5	1	6	9	2	7
1	5	7	2	9	8	3	6	4
9	6	2	4	7	3	8	1	5

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): There's a Moon alert all day, so restrict spending to food and gas, and postpone important decisions. However, you are the artisan of the zodiac, and it is an excellent time for socialising. Tonight: Enjoy solitude

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): The Moon is at the top of your chart today, which means people notice you, whether you're aware of this or not. Some know personal details about your private life. Avoid important decisions and shopping. Tonight: Be friendly.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): This is a creative day for you! Express your ideas and artistic talents. It's also a great day to socialise. Get out and enjoy sports events. Tonight: You're admired.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): There's a Moon Alert in effect all day, which means it's wise to restrict your spending to food and gas. You'll be tempted to negotiate, borrow or discuss how to share something. Caution! Tonight: Explore and learn.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): The Moon Alert all day is opposite your sign, which means communications with those who are closest to you are subject to misinterpretation. Don't volunteer or agree to do anything important. Tonight: Check your finances.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today's Moon Alert might create goofy mistakes at work along with delays and shortages, which might be a bit frustrating for you. Be aware of this and give yourself extra time for wiggle room to deal with the unexpected. Tonight: Be cooperative.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): This is a wonderful day to socialise and enjoy the company of others. The theater, the arts, sports events and fun occasions will delight. Restrict your spending to food and gas because there is a Moon Alert all day. Tonight: Get better organised.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Home and family are your focus today. However, you also might want to hide at home and relax among familiar surroundings. Due to Moon alert, restrict your spending and avoid important decisions. Tonight: Socialise.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): This is a popular time for you and you're out there flying your colours talking to everyone. Meanwhile, this entire day is a Moon alert, so be careful in your communications. Postpone important decisions and commitments. Tonight: Relax at home.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Be careful today. This entire day is a Moon alert and do not be tempted to shop. Restrict your spending to food and gas. Commit to nothing financially; however, it's okay to window shop and do your homework. Tonight: Learn and discuss things.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): This is a tricky day as there's a Moon alert in effect all day. You'll enjoy socialising, the arts and opportunities to be creative. Restrict spending to food and gas. Tonight: Check your belongings.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Travel if possible, because you have a desire to expand your world and seek out new experiences. Competitive sports will also appeal. Meanwhile, this entire day is a Moon Alert. Keep your head down and your powder dry. Tonight: You win.

ALWAR BALASUBRAMANIAM, *Not Just for Us*

SKARMA SONAM TASHI, *Echoes of Home*

AN INDIAN PORTRAIT FROM VENICE

The India pavilion at Venice Biennale, the most prestigious art event in the world, has come in for high praise. TRISHA MUKHERJEE & DIVYA A on how India made it to Venice after seven years, and why a national pavilion at the 'Olympics of the art world' matters

WHAT'S HOME? Or the idea of it? As delicate and haunting as Sumakshi Singh's white threads that hold up fragments of a broken home, as real as 33 Link Road, Delhi, the artist's now-demolished house where she spent her summer vacations in the 2000s, the one her grandparents, Partition refugees from Pakistan, built in 1951.

Her installation, *Permanent Address*, is one of five artworks that are part of the India pavilion at this year's Venice Biennale, one of the oldest, largest, and most prestigious contemporary cultural and art events in the world. India's presentation, titled 'Geographies of Distance: Returning Home' and curated by Amin Jaffer, marks the country's return to the event, the 'Olympics of the art world', after seven years.

The five artworks, all rooted in Indian craft traditions, explore the idea of home. Besides Sumakshi Singh's embroidered recreation of a lost home, there is Ranjani Shettar's floating garden, Asim Waqif's bamboo scaffolding that mourns the slow erosion of rural architecture, Skarma Sonam Tashi's Ladakhi homes that rise like a settlement resting on a mountain slope, and Alwar Balasubramaniam's display of cracked soil sourced from rural Tamil Nadu.

Critics and patrons, including Saffronart's Minal Vazirani and former British prime minister Rishi Sunak, and the global media have described the India pavilion as "dazzling", "spectacular" and a must-see, with the artworks being hailed for their innovation and craftsmanship.

Is this then Indian art's golden moment? What does this success mean and does India have a plan for a sustained presence at the Biennale?

SUMAKSHI SINGH, *Permanent Address*

To pull off an art show

While Indian artists have regularly showcased in their individual capacities at the Venice Biennale's central exhibitions, this is only the third time in the 131-year history of the art event that India has participated with a national pavilion.

A national pavilion, one that is organised and funded by the government to showcase its artists, is the ultimate exercise in soft power and cultural diplomacy. Even smaller countries such as Uruguay and Angola either have permanent pavilions at Venice or participate consistently.

China has been showcasing its pavilion since 2005. Though the country is not among the 30 that own permanent buildings at the historic Giardini park in Venice, its pavilion has for long had a permanent home at the Arsenale, a complex that offers spaces on rent during the six-month-long biennale. It's at the Arsenale, inside a brick-walled former maritime warehouse that's a five-minute walk from the China pavilion, that India is hosting its pavilion this year.

The last time India put up a pavilion was in 2019, when the Ministry of Culture partnered with the Kiran Nadar Museum of Art (KNMA) and the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) under a public-private partnership model.

This time, the government has gone with two institutional partners — Nita Mukesh Ambani Cultural Centre (NMACC) and Serendipity Arts.

Culture Secretary Vivek Aggarwal says the process of setting up a national pavilion involved months of discussions and evaluation. "We received multiple expressions of interest and carefully assessed proposals against the vision that the government sought to present at Venice," he says.

Ministry officials say the proposal by Amin Jaffer, the London-based curator who was eventually chosen to head the India pavilion, dealt with Indians as migrants. Officials say that with the theme of 'Returning Home', they expected visitors to walk in through the India pavilion, pause and reflect on their own sense of belonging.

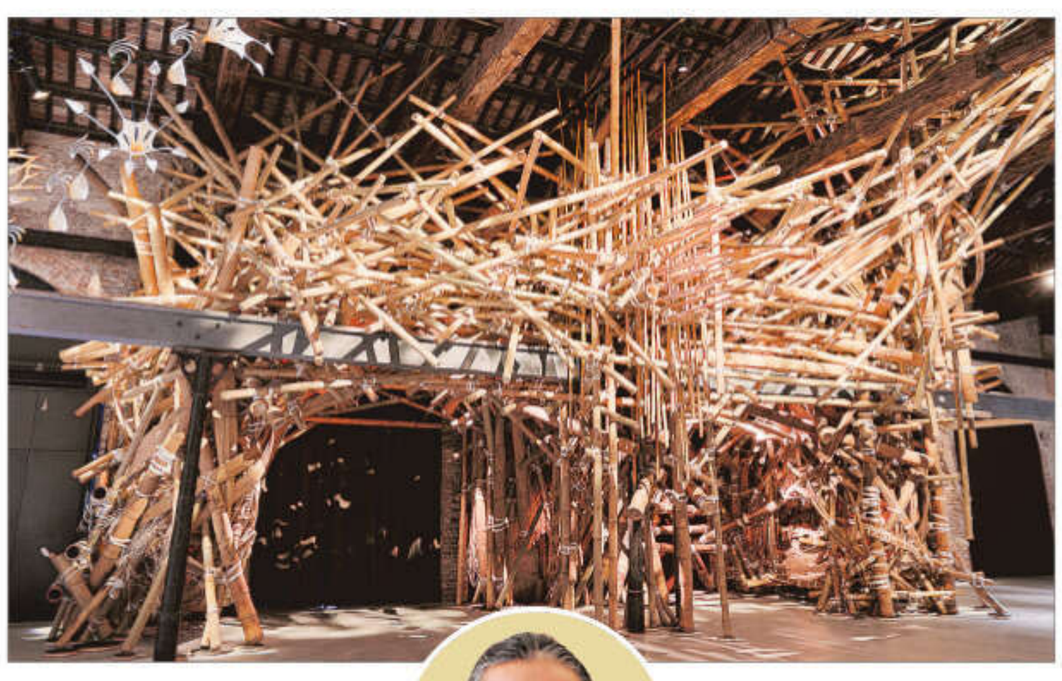
Jaffer, who was born in central Africa and raised in North America and Europe but whose roots go back to Kutch, Gujarat, says he has drawn from his personal history to ask "whether belonging is determined solely by geography or can also be sustained through memory, practice and emotional attachment".

When Jaffer initially submitted his proposal, it was for a single artist. "But the ministry felt India's diversity called for a multi-artist presentation. I then developed the proposal further, expanding its narrative," he says, talking of how the other four artists came on board.

If the ministry set the ball rolling, NMACC and Serendipity, with their experience in delivering projects of international scale, took over.

A national pavilion at the biennale is the ultimate exercise in soft power and cultural diplomacy. The last time India put up a pavilion was in 2019... But China has been consistently showcasing its pavilion since 2005

RANJANI SHETTAR, *Under the Same Sky*



ASIM WAQIF, *Chaal*

Each of the installations on display required both artistic creativity and engineering ingenuity. For instance, Asim Waqif's *Chaal* uses 12 tonnes of bamboo, sourced largely from Assam and West Bengal, all of which were bent and tied to form a 30-foot-high structure. Waqif's work is a commentary on the disappearance of rural architecture, with construction rules that favour steel and aluminium in place of bamboo for scaffolding.

"I use one simple lashing technique — tying two bamboo, sometimes whole and sometimes split, together with a composite nylon strap used in shipping. We don't make any holes in the bamboo or use joinery, nuts or bolts," says the Delhi-based, Hyderabad-born Waqif, explaining how his team, along with "three Italian riggers who are trained in climbing and ropes and knots", built the installation.

Geopolitical events led to logistical challenges, particularly in the shipment and installation of Waqif's bamboo work. Ministry officials say several species of bamboo had to be transported and installed within very specific timelines ahead of the biennale that was to start in May. But in February, the US-Iran war broke out and the artworks and other objects had to be flown in, instead of shipped as planned earlier.

Sumakshi Singh's work, in which she embroidered an entire house on water-soluble fabric, also called for a high degree of sophistication and planning. For the installation, she recreated the house down to the gates, stairs, walls, doors and windows. "Even the *chatkani*s (door bolts)," she says.

The Ladakh-born Skarma Sonam Tashi says that before he could start on the project, he and the others were taken to the venue in Venice. "Once that happened, I knew exactly what I wanted to make. Because my studio in Delhi's Garhi was small, I had to rent a bigger apartment to work. Thankfully, my work reached Venice in a week," he says.

His *Echoes of Home* is a prototype of a Ladakhi settlement with homes that are traditionally built using earth, stone, timber, and collective knowledge passed down generations. For his work, Tashi used recycled materials, including papier-mâché, egg trays, cardboard and old paper.

The installation of Ranjani Shettar's monumental floral vine suspended from the ceiling and Alwar Balasubramaniam's two-panelled installation of cracked earth, including one that covers an entire wall at the pavilion, too, required constant innovations. Shettar and Balasubramaniam could not be contacted for this story.

"A presence at Venice requires much more than selecting artists. It requires curatorial expertise, production capabilities, international partnerships, sustained funding and the ability to build audiences and relationships around the work," says Sunil Kant Munjal, founder and patron, Serendipity Arts, one of the primary organising partners.

Pietrangelo Buttafuoco, President, Venice Biennale, says India's presentation is "a perfect expression of what India represents today — grounded in its ancient heritage... while at the same time looking to the future".

THE BIENNALE

- Known as 'Olympics of the art world', it is among the largest and most prestigious art events
- It began in 1895. In its current format, it hosts the International Art Biennale, International Architecture Biennale, national pavilions and collateral events
- In the biennale's 131-year-old history, India has participated with a national pavilion only thrice — 2011, 2019, and 2026

India in Venice, now and then

The first time India had a national pavilion was in 2011. That year, the UPA government, which had drawn flak for reportedly failing to accept the biennale's invitation in 2007, was determined to make it work.

According to Jawhar Sircar, who was Culture Secretary then, "Until then, going to a biennale was not part of the government routine. Many Indian artists would go themselves. But India as a nation was absent."

In 2015, artist Dayanita Singh said in an interview that she felt "ashamed" at the absence of a national pavilion, saying it showed where India placed its contemporary art.

In 2011, Sircar teamed up with Ashok Vajpeyi, then chairman of the Lalit Kala Akademi, to choose historian-art critic Ranjit Hoskote as the curator. "I was free to come up with any concept and any choice of artists. I am grateful to have had a great deal of freedom," says Hoskote.

For India's debut, he provocatively looked at who had the right to call themselves Indian. The pavilion was as bold in its choice of artists, leaving out some of the biggest names.

For Sircar, "the best thing was that we learned how to do it".

However, what could have been a marquee moment became a blip as India went back to Venice only after eight years.

When it did so, in 2019, the NDA government decided that the 150th anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi was the occasion for it.

The Ministry of Culture brought on board KNMA as the principal partner and financial backer, while CII managed co-organisation, corporate advocacy, and execution.

The presentation explored the continued relevance of Gandhi in a world navigating conflict. Despite featuring works by leading Indian artists, including Jitish Kallat, Atul Dodiya, M F Husain and Shakuntala Kulkarni, the pavilion was largely dismissed by critics as "government-mandated", "unoriginal" and "bureaucratic".

Roobina Karode, Artistic Director and Chief Curator, KNMA, who curated the 2019 India pavilion, recalls feeling restrained. "I did bring it up with the ministry that a given theme wasn't the standard practice for a national pavilion at Venice. I was told the funds were coming from Gandhi's 150 year commemoration. So I convinced them that the curation must have a critical lens," she says.

Part of the praise coming Jaffer's way is in the perception that his curation at this year's biennale feels "innovative" vis-a-vis the "safe" 2019 presentation.

Critics, however, say the pavilion curated by Hoskote may have been far more radical. Hoskote had presented Desire Machine Collective's *Residue*, a short film shot in a defunct thermal power plant on the outskirts of Guwahati, had taken a dig at the Indian State's thoughtless industrialisation.

The Venice Biennale has a rich history of political subversion, with artists often using the State-funded platform to challenge governments. In 1993, artist Hans Haacke's *Germania* was an indictment of the German government's inaction in the wake of racial violence against immigrants in the country.

Where does India go from here?

Despite these contradictions, the Venice Biennale and the soft power it represents make it vital for the country and its artists to be seen there.

"Continuity and consistency over time," Buttafuoco notes, "certainly carry their own significance".

Culture Secretary Aggarwal says India has confirmed its participation in the 2028 edition of the biennale. He says India plans to build on the success of the biennale and is preparing to host its own India Art, Architecture and Design Biennale in Delhi from December 4, 2026, to March 21, 2027, where the India pavilion could be showcased.

With India determined to go back to Venice, Sircar calls for a permanent space at the biennale that would not only be "more economical but... will compel you to return".

But getting a permanent space in the Giardini park is increasingly difficult. Getting a space would require navigating a labyrinth of diplomatic, legal and administrative clearances, which is what Qatar did, in 2025. Before that, the last country to enter Giardini was three decades ago: South Korea in 1995.

A permanent address for the India pavilion may be a long shot, but the success of this year's biennale may be a sign that Indian art can aspire for a home in Venice.

But then, as the handwritten note on a postcard left behind at the reception of the India Pavilion in Venice says, "Home — where is home? Does it travel with you? Do you remember the smell? To return to or build a home?"

FM: INDIA'S NEXT PHASE OF GROWTH MUST BE BUILT ON QUALITY

Growth durability at risk if cos focus only on urban elite

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, September 22

URGING CORPORATE leadership to avoid designing "only for the formal urban elite", Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday said if corporates pursue "premiumisation for the urban tier alone, growth will lose its structural durability".

Sitharaman said the country stands at a structural inflection point and the next phase of consumption will be driven by upward mobility into higher-income brackets where there is more discretionary spending.

She pointed out the changing demographics of the population stating that with a rising median age, lower youth dependency and greater longevity will move household budgets toward healthcare, personal wellness, consumer durables, and quality services.

"India's consumption base rests on working families across agriculture, rural construction, transport, and informal enterprise. If corporate India pursues premiumisation for the urban tier alone, growth will lose its structural durability," she said at the Platinum Jubilee Convention of the All India Management Association (AIMA).

As the government opens up sectors such as space and nuclear energy to greater private participation, more of India's development needs can be met through the market — and industry must step forward to meet them, she added.

Private Final Consumption Expenditure (PFCE) — which accounted for 55.6% of India's GDP in the first quarter of 2026-27 in current prices — posted a real growth rate of 7.1% in April-June, up from 6.8% a year ago.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman addressing a gathering at an All India Management Association event in New Delhi. ANI

Sitharaman also highlighted the need to focus on "quality" across factories, boardrooms, research and development, adding that it must become the country's next national movement. "India's next phase of growth must be built on quality. Every factory floor, boardroom, service centre, R&D team, etc. must aim for higher standards, fewer defects, and greater reliability. Management professionals and corporate leaders should make quality consciousness a shared discipline, embedded in products, processes, services and institutions," she said.

India's gross expenditure on R&D stands at 0.83% of GDP, far below the 2.7% average of OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development), 2.6% of China, and 3.5% of the US, reflecting a persistent shortfall in private-sector R&D depth, where the domestic private sector contributes just 36% compared to over 70% in leading advanced economies, Sitharaman said.

"Therefore, corporates need to spend more on R&D, either in-house or through collaboration with academia. This will help in driving innovation and improving existing products," she added. Higher R&D expenditure should also translate into more intellectual property being created in and from India, she said.

Talking about corporate governance, Sitharaman said businesses must engage constructively with the government and regulators. "Legal recourse will always remain available, but every disagreement need not begin as litigation. There is considerable value in engaging early, placing evidence on the table, participating seriously in consultations and working towards solutions before differences become disputes," she said. Underlining that businesses must provide predictability, transparency and a willingness to listen, she said a mature economy should be capable of disagreement without immediately becoming adversarial.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Will weigh all pros and cons of cross ownership of airports, airlines: Naidu

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, September 22

THE GOVERNMENT will weigh all the pros and cons and will focus on maintaining market balance while deciding on the issue of cross-ownership between airlines and airports, Civil Aviation Minister K Rammohan Naidu said Tuesday.

Naidu's comments at an industry event came in response to a question on whether the government had decided on the Adani group's request for a waiver from cross-ownership restrictions as it was evaluating participating in the airline business. Naidu said that no decision has been taken and the matter is under deliberation.

"...one thing from the government is clear: that we need more airlines to come into the picture. Now, operating airports and airlines together needs some deliberation. We are going to see the pros and the cons of it...You see the first idea is to provide the passenger with more airlines as an option and if there is someone who is interested to do it, then the government supports the idea.

"But when the (airport) operator only has to do it, then what are the cons also that might come out? We need to create a system where the cons are also taken care of," the minister said.

Naidu also reiterated the government's stated position that there was no blanket policy restricting airport operators from holding substantial equity in airlines, although cross-holding restrictions are part of contracts for some airports operated by private sector players, like in the case of Mumbai airport operated by the Adani group.

Last month, the Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) informed Parliament that the state-owned Airports Authority of India (AAI) had received a request seeking a waiver of the cross-holding cap provision, but didn't name the Adani group.

The government has been calling for more airlines in the Indian skies, given the duopoly of IndiGo and the Air India group, which have a cumulative domestic market share of over 90%. But allowing airport operators to run airlines can have pitfalls, specifically those related to fair competition and non-discriminatory access to carriers, according to experts.

In a letter addressed to the AAI chairman in June, Adani Airport Holdings's CEO Arun Bansal had sought a waiver or clarification in the Mumbai airport's operation, management and development agreement (OMDA) to pave the way for the group to directly or indirectly invest in, acquire, promote, or control a scheduled airline, it is learnt. Bansal also sought similar waivers, approvals, and clarifications for all existing and future airports, given that the conglomerate may in future operate more airports, according to sources.

However, Adani group flagship Adani Enterprises had said in July that it was not evaluating any proposal to enter the airline business.

As per the OMDA for Mumbai and Delhi airports, scheduled airlines and their group entities can't hold more than 10% stake in the airport operator. This also effectively restricts the airport operator and its group entities from investing in or promoting a scheduled airline.

The Adani group has 74% stake in the Mumbai airport, while GMR has 74% in the Delhi airport.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• STRIKING A BALANCE

THE GOVERNMENT has been calling for more airlines in the Indian skies, given the duopoly of IndiGo and the Air India group, which have a cumulative domestic market share of over 90%

BUT ALLOWING airport operators to run airlines can have pitfalls, specifically those related to fair competition and non-discriminatory access to carriers, according to experts

AS PER the OMDA for Mumbai and Delhi airports, scheduled airlines and their group entities can't hold more than 10% stake in the airport operator

Centre places SpiceJet under operational & financial scrutiny

Reuters
Bengaluru, September 22

INDIA'S AVIATION ministry has placed troubled carrier SpiceJet under operational and financial scrutiny following its long-running cash flow troubles, worsened by the ongoing West Asia conflict, a government official said on Tuesday.

Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu said the government was closely monitoring SpiceJet's operations and finances through the aviation regulatory body to ensure safety is not compromised.

The ministry's focus comes amid heightened attention on aviation safety in India after recent industry disruptions, with regulators keen to ensure financial stress does not affect operations or passenger safety. Naidu said there were limits to how far the government could intervene in privately run businesses, but noted that authorities had extended the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme, under which SpiceJet has received 1.5 billion rupees in support.

The remarks at a press conference comes months after Reuters reported that the company was actively pursuing government funding.

'Fears over GST on merchant fee for big UPI payments misplaced'

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 22

FEARS THAT a Goods and Services Tax (GST) of 18% on the fee merchants pay when they receive UPI payments of more than Rs 2,000 will be "additional burden" on sellers are "misplaced", the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) said on Tuesday as it looked to address concerns that accepting digital payment will become costlier for small shopkeepers and vendors.

Reiterating that the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) as per the revised framework is only applicable on person-to-merchant UPI payments of over Rs 2,000, the NPCI said that these transactions only make up 4% of P2M payments.

As such, 96% of UPI payments to sellers will not attract any merchant fee and therefore no GST.

For the 4% of transactions to merchants that are above Rs 2,000 and facing an MDR — and therefore a GST — the seller will not have to bear the additional tax cost as it can claim input tax credit. This means, the GST paid on the MDR can be adjusted against the tax to be paid on the sale of goods "in the same manner that input taxes are set off against output tax liability".

In most states, sellers of goods with an annual turnover of under Rs 40 lakh don't have to register under GST. The threshold is Rs 20 lakh for service providers. Only those sellers who are registered under GST can claim input tax credit.

Further, small merchants who receive less than Rs 1 lakh per month as UPI payment are exempt from MDR and therefore do not have to pay GST.

"Hence, apprehensions that GST on MDR will impose an additional burden on merchants are misplaced. The overwhelming majority of UPI transactions and small merchants remain unaffected," the NPCI said in a post on social media platform X. A merchant facing an MDR of 0.4% on a UPI payment of Rs 10,000 will have to first pay a fee of Rs 40 and GST of Rs 7.2 on that Rs 40. For those categories of payments where the MDR is a flat Rs 5, the GST will be 90 paise. According to Deni Shah, Head of Customs & International Trade at Bhuta Shah & Co LLP, while the GST revenue to the government from a 0.4% MDR on UPI payments of over Rs 2,000 has been estimated to be as high as Rs 5,000 crore, the actual net revenue "could be close to zero as registered businesses can fully claim the same as an input tax credit".

However, some UPI transactions will generate revenue for the government, Shah noted. "While large, registered entities will be able to offset the input GST, mid-sized vendors earning over Rs 1 lakh monthly but falling below the annual GST registration threshold cannot claim ITC, meaning their high-value digital sales directly benefit the Government exchequer." Shah also warned that the GST on MDR "adds a major operational layer to a company's financial routines" and increases administrative compliance burden. While merchants involved in business-to-business dealing only have a few large bills every month, the number of payments exceeding Rs 2,000 handled by consumer-facing sellers is "massive".

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• 55 Indian cities in world's fastest-growing 100

Of 100 fastest-growing cities, 55 are in India. But, in overall rankings that take into account economics, human capital, quality of life, environment, and governance, the top-ranked Indian city was Delhi at 268, according to Oxford Economics' 2026 Global Cities Index.

- The likes of New York, London, and Paris were the top-three overall, with cities from Europe and North America accounting for 78 of the top 100. But the rest of the world is not standing still.
- "Chinese and Indian cities will be at the forefront, combining large population sizes with significant gains in productivity and income. Shanghai, Beijing, and Delhi are all currently ranked outside the top 100 in our index, but they will see some of the largest increases in GDP through to 2050," the economic advisory firm said last week.

INDIA'S TOP CITIES (global rank)

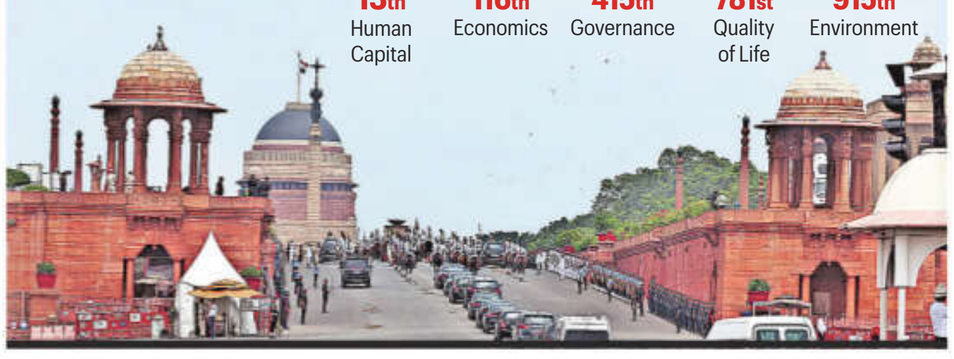
Rank	Cities	Score
268	Delhi	57.6
311	Bengaluru	53.2
330	Mumbai	51.2
381	Chennai	47.3
421	Hyderabad	45.1
427	Pune	44.9
477	Thrissur	42.2
489	Kochi	41.6
496	Kolkata	41.3
499	Kozhikode	41.1

WORLD'S TOP-10 CITIES

Rank	Cities	Score
1	New York	100.0
2	London	98.8
3	Paris	93.4
4	Seattle	92.8
5	San Francisco	91.9
6	Dublin	91.3
7	Boston	90.7
8	San Jose (US)	89.6
9	Tokyo	89.5
10	Zurich	89.1

DELHI RANKING

13th	116th	415th	781st	915th
Human Capital	Economics	Governance	Quality of Life	Environment



Scheme to promote processing of lithium and nickel soon: Secy

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, September 22

THE CENTRAL government is set to launch a new scheme for lithium and nickel, two critical minerals considered important to the battery manufacturing ecosystem, Keshav Chandra, Secretary, Ministry of Mines, said at the 60th Annual General Meeting of the Federation of Indian Mineral Industries (FIMI).

Further details of the scheme will be announced after the required approvals are received, Chandra told the media on the sidelines of the event.

Talk of the scheme to promote the processing of these two minerals has been around for some time. In April, former Mines Secretary Piyush Goyal had said the ministry was in the advanced stages of framing a policy to promote critical mineral processing and had shortlisted two minerals considered critical for electric vehicles, without naming them.

The development comes as the government has already identified four states — Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, Gujarat and Maharashtra — to promote setting up of critical mineral processing plants. Chandra said the government is looking at every park as a complete ecosystem for a particular mineral.

Accordingly, Gujarat and Andhra Pradesh are looking at rare earth processing, while Odisha and Maharashtra are set to focus on nickel and lithium, respectively. Explaining the rationale, Chandra said Gujarat already has the availability of heavy rare earth elements and has developed beneficiation and processing technology. Andhra Pradesh, he said, has also been identified for developing a rare earth corridor.

Odisha is being considered for nickel as the state has its own nickel reserves and its location in eastern India could make it easier to process imported nickel from Indonesia and other countries, where the mineral is available in abundance, he explained. "So the entire ecosystem for a particular mineral is being developed in these four parts," he added.

India has little processing capacity for critical minerals and is 100% import-dependent for some key critical minerals such as cobalt, lithium, nickel, rare earth elements and silicon.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Government flags new fiscal strains for states from ageing, AI, climate risks

Prasanta Sahu
New Delhi, September 22

States will need to overhaul their spending priorities and strengthen their finances as demographic ageing, rapid technological change, urbanisation and climate risks reshape expenditure demands, according to a background paper the Centre shared with the states over the weekend.

With states accounting for around two-thirds of general government expenditure, the paper said their fiscal capacity, quality of spending and investment decisions would be critical to sustaining growth, building human capital and ensuring inclusive development as India seeks to become a developed economy by 2047.

The paper, shared by the Union Finance Ministry ahead of the conference with state finance ministers on September 18-19, was authored by Sangeeta Das and V Dhanya from the RBI's Department of Economic and Policy Research. The paper estimates that India would need to grow at around 8% annually in real terms to achieve its 2047 development goal, putting the onus on states to maintain sustainable public finances. FE

• BRIEFLY

Mumbai local body set for debut bond sale in early 2027

Mumbai: India' richest city will launch its debut bond sale in the last quarter of the financial year, two sources aware of the matter said on Tuesday, joining a growing market. Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation, which governs Mumbai, plans to raise around 95 billion rupees ($992 million) — the most by any local body — over one or more tranches, with the first sale due by March, the sources said, requesting anonymity. The corporation did not reply to a email seeking comment. REUTERS

Govt makes BIS certification must for smartphone screen protectors

New Delhi: The government has mandated compulsory Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) certification for smartphone screen protectors, requiring entities to secure regulatory approval before selling such products in India. The move is expected to curb sales of low-quality smartphone screen protectors and help domestic manufacturers like Optiemus Infracom, which has started production in India. Smartphone screen protectors are the 66th item to be notified under the rule. PTI

SEBI PROBE INTO DISCLOSURE & CORPORATE GOVERNANCE VIOLATIONS ALLEGED BY HINDENBURG

Five Adani companies settle SEBI proceedings for Rs 1.5 crore

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, September 22

FIVE LISTED Adani Group companies have settled adjudication proceedings initiated by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) over alleged disclosure and corporate governance violations arising from its examination of issues highlighted in the Hindenburg Research report.

Under a settlement order dated September 22, SEBI said Adani Enterprises Ltd (AEL), Adani Total Gas Ltd, AWL Agri Business Ltd, Adani Green Energy Ltd and Adani Energy Solutions Ltd have paid a combined amount of Rs 1.508 crore to settle the proceedings. The companies settled the cases without admitting or denying the findings of fact or conclusions of law.

The proceedings stemmed from SEBI's examination of allegations relating to related-party transactions (RPTs), disclosures and corporate governance in the Adani Group following the Hindenburg report. The regulator had examined seven Adani Group companies, including Adani Ports & SEZ and Adani Power. The latest settlement order covers five of them.

The settlement amounts recommended by SEBI's High Powered Advisory Committee and subsequently accepted by the regulator were: Adani Enterprises Rs 76.05 lakh, Adani Total Gas Rs 9.75 lakh, AWL Agri Business Rs 9.75 lakh, Adani Green Energy Rs 45.50 lakh and Adani Energy Solutions Rs 9.75 lakh

The proceedings are separate from the two SEBI orders reported in September 2025, in which the regulator dismissed allegations of stock manipulation, fraudulent or unfair trade practices and certain related-party transactions involving Gautam Adani, Rajesh Adani, Adani Ports and Adani Power. SEBI had said the allegations in those proceedings could not be established.

In the case of Adani Enterprises, SEBI alleged that related-party transactions between Adani Estates Pvt Ltd, a subsidiary of AEL, and Vakoder Investment Ltd, a related party, were not disclosed in the company's annual report for 2012-13 as required under the applicable accounting standard.

AEL was also proceeded against over audit and limited-review reports signed by audit firms that did not hold valid Peer Review Certificates at the relevant time. Similar allegations relating to limited-review reports were made against Adani Total Gas and AWL Agri Business. Adani Green Energy was proceeded against over its audit report for 2018-19 and limited-review reports for certain quarters between 2018 and 2019, which SEBI said were signed by Dharmesh Parikh & Co LLP without a valid Peer Review Certificate.

Adani Energy Solutions, formerly Adani Transmission, faced proceedings over its June 2015 limited-review report on similar grounds. The companies subsequently informed SEBI that the amounts had been remitted, and the regulator confirmed receipt. The settlement does not amount to an admission of the alleged violations by the five companies. Under the settlement mechanism, the applicants agreed to pay the specified amounts and bring the adjudication proceedings to an end without admitting or denying the findings or legal conclusions. SEBI's order also makes clear that the regulator retains the power to restore or initiate enforcement proceedings if representations made during the settlement process are subsequently found to be untrue, undertakings are breached or a discrepancy is found in arriving at the settlement terms.

The latest order needs to be read separately from SEBI's September 2025 orders concerning allegations made by Hindenburg.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
74,529.08	23,329.00	₹1,52,136	₹95.59
-329.91	-85.30		
-0.44%	-0.36%		
		Silver ▼	**Oil ▼**
		₹2,32,922	$117.36

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

@ieExplained
#ExpressExplained
If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to
explained@indianexpress.com

• TECH

Soaring demand for AI chips: What 'supercycle' means

EXPERT EXPLAINS

SHRUTI MITTAL
RESEARCH ANALYST, CARNEGIE INDIA

SEMICON INDIA, the flagship conference of the India Semiconductor Mission or ISM (under the IT Ministry), was held in New Delhi last week. It came amid exceptional global demand for semiconductors, or chips, driven by artificial intelligence (AI) and the infrastructure it requires. Some call this a semiconductor "supercycle" — a multi-year period of investment and growth thanks to a fundamental tech shift that alters the underlying structure of demand. It was seen with computers in the 1990s, and smartphones in the 2010s.

What is driving the chip boom?

Data centres are generating a large share of the demand. These physical facilities house equipment to store and process digital data (think servers and computers). AI data centres have the specialised infrastructure needed to support AI technology.

One such element is the AI chip or accelerator that undertakes the massive calculations needed to run AI models. These processors must also receive data rapidly — something traditional memory hardware struggles with because of its distance from the processor. High-bandwidth memory (HBM) chips instead stack layers of a computer's working memory close to the processor, allowing large volumes of data to move rapidly between the memory and processor. Processors and memory stacks are combined using highly advanced packaging techniques.

The HBM market has three big players: South Korea's SK Hynix and Samsung, and Micron in the US.

How is demand being secured?

Memory manufacturers traditionally relied on consumer sales, but the AI buildout is shifting the market towards business-to-business sales. According to S&P Global data, Microsoft, Amazon, Google, and Meta plan to spend nearly $635 billion on AI infrastructure in 2026 alone, including data centres. Chipmakers are, in turn, entering into long-term take-or-pay agreements, where customers must buy the agreed chips regardless of their current demand or pay hefty penalties. Such contracts may make demand more predictable, but AI infrastructure spending remains concentrated among a few companies, and the fortunes of the industry will ultimately depend on the revenue AI services actually generate.

Where does India fit?

Under ISM 1.0, India approved 12 semiconductor projects and some packaging facilities began production. India does not produce chips, but has focused on establishing manufacturing capacity in assembly, testing, and packaging. For instance, Micron's Sanand facility in Gujarat will process imported wafers used for chipmaking.

So far, India is not capturing profits from advanced chips. A parliamentary reply in July said demand for AI servers and data centres was tightening memory supplies and raising prices. In capital markets, too, some foreign investment withdrawals from Indian markets in 2026 have been linked to interest in the semiconductor-heavy markets of Taiwan and South Korea. Launched in February, ISM 2.0 aims to build on the existing base, with its packaging scheme offering financial support. Another scheme will support R&D in chiplet technologies. Conventional chips are made using a single piece of silicon. Chiplets combine smaller, specialised chips to lower costs and waste.

Chip design offers another entry point, as nearly a fifth of the global chip workforce is based in India. Under the design-linked incentive scheme, startup Netrasemi is developing edge-AI processors for cameras and drones. These processors perform AI computations on the device instead of sending data to the cloud, allowing faster responses and reducing the need for data transmission over the internet. Germany's Infineon also recently acquired the Bangalore-based fabless company (one that designs and sells chips) C2i, which may illustrate another part of an emerging value chain.

• LEGAL

How SC has strengthened safeguards around re-arrest

Under Article 22, a person must be informed about grounds of arrest. The SC ruling means that arrests flouting this right are invalid in law

AMAAL SHEIKH

THE SUPREME Court has strengthened the Constitutional safeguards governing arrest, holding that an accused released for violation of the fundamental right to be informed of the grounds of arrest is not released on bail, but from an "illegal and unconstitutional detention".

A bench of Justices Ujjal Bhuyan and Atul S Chandurkar held on Monday that the safeguards under Article 22(1) are "fundamental principles which are required to be followed" whenever a person's liberty is curtailed.

The court laid down a procedure requiring judicial approval before investigating agencies can arrest such a person again and held that High Courts may award compensation "as part of the public law remedy in a case of violation of Article 22(2) of the Constitution, with liberty to the accused to avail his remedy under the private civil law."

The bench was hearing an appeal filed by an accused in a POCSO case in Punjab in May. The ruling builds on a line of judgments that have progressively strengthened the rights of arrested persons, particularly the requirement that they be informed, in writing, of the grounds of their arrest.

The legal framework

The case turns on the interplay between the right to life under Article 21 and the protection against arrest and detention under Article 22. Article 22(1) requires police to inform an arrested person of the grounds of arrest, and Article 22(2) requires production before a magistrate within 24 hours.

The question of whether an accused must be given a written copy of the grounds of arrest came up before the SC in *Pankaj Bansal v. Union of India* (2023). The case turned on Section 19 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, which says that a person must be informed "of the grounds of such arrest", but does not spell out how that information is to be conveyed.

The court noted that Article 22(1) of the Constitution guarantees an arrested person the right to know why they are being arrested. It said that this safeguard would mean little if the grounds were merely read out and not handed over in writing. The Court said a written copy of the grounds of arrest must be furnished to the accused "as a matter of course and without exception".

That position was watered down in *Ram Kishor Arora v. Directorate of Enforcement* (2023); the Court held that the *Pankaj Bansal* ruling would apply prospectively. Since the arrest predated that judgement, the court found that informing the accused of the grounds of arrest and allowing him to read them was sufficient compliance with PMLA Section 19, even though no copy was furnished to him.

However, the SC in 2025 settled the position in *Mihir Rajesh Shah v. State of Maharashtra*, where it held that the constitutional requirement of communicating the grounds of arrest is mandatory to arrests under all statutes. The SC said that "the grounds of arrest must be communicated in writing to the arrestee in the language he/she understands," and that non-compliance would render "the arrest and subsequent remand ... illegal." It allowed grounds to be conveyed orally in exceptional cases, provided a written copy followed within a reasonable time, at least two hours before the accused is produced for remand.

Senior Advocate Nitya Ramakrishnan told *The Indian Express* that the requirement of furnishing written grounds of arrest is especially important in serious offences, where securing bail is often difficult. Referring to earlier judgments such as *Pankaj Bansal* and *Prabir Purkayastha*, she said the courts had recognised that the safeguard assumes significance in cases where an accused's ability to challenge arrest or oppose remand may otherwise be constrained. "The significance of its application to serious offences was not only recognised, but reiterated and reemphasised with greater rigour," she said.

"The grounds of arrest under Article 22 were not considered the ground for release," Senior Advocate Sidharth Luthra told *The Indian Express*. "It was not given that high and an appropriate stature. Later on, through SC decisions, it was sought to be given some content. Then there has been dilution, then an attempted reconsideration of its standards."

What the court held

Monday's ruling builds on *Mihir Rajesh Shah*. It held that any violation of Article 22(1) or 22(2) invalidates the arrest itself. It said: "Any breach or non-compliance would entail immediate release of the arrested person because such arrest is unconstitutional. We cannot tinker with the most important safeguards provided under Article 22."

The State had argued that the seriousness of the offence meant Article 22(2) should not give the accused "blanket immunity" from re-arrest. The court rejected this, holding that where an arrest is unconstitutional, police cannot simply re-arrest the accused on their own.

It laid down a procedure tightening the process — agencies that believe custody is necessary must first furnish the grounds of arrest, then move the jurisdictional magistrate with an application explaining the need for custody and the reasons for the earlier non-compliance, endorsed by the officer's immediate superior.

"The significance of the judgment is mainly in the context of re-arrest," Ramakrishnan said. Unlike a release on bail, she said, the Court has treated such cases as involving an arrest that is invalid in law itself.

"The arrest ceases to be. So, you are not being released on condition. Because it is in law that arrest is bad, so it is as though you were never arrested," she said.

She said the decision marks a supervision of the judiciary over the State's power to deprive a person of liberty, though not over the investigation itself. "Because arrest is done during the course of investigation of cognizable offences... but it's not in relation to the integrity of the investigation. It's really more judicial supervision over the state's police power to affect personal liberty." The judgement also requires a superior officer to endorse a re-arrest application to transfer the investigation to another officer and order a departmental enquiry.

Luthra said the judgment reinforces the constitutional nature of arrest safeguards. "The Constitution is the fundamental core of our law. Breach of constitutional provisions and rights should have consequences. Because if there is a right, there has to be a remedy and a result," he said.

According to him, the ruling makes clear that Article 22 protections cannot be applied selectively or diluted depending on the nature of the offence. "This judgment comes at a point where it says that these are sacrosanct principles which ought not to be diluted, and you cannot make it offence specific unless Parliament chooses to do so," he said.

He also said courts unfortunately do not award compensation enough in cases of illegal arrest or detention.

Ramakrishnan said: "Conceptually, it is meant to give greater accountability to the police powers of the State."

• Written grounds for arrest: SC's evolving jurisprudence

- **Article 22** is a fundamental right under the Constitution that provides for an accused to be produced before a magistrate within 24 hours of arrest, to get legal representation — and to be informed about the grounds of arrest.
- **The question** of whether an accused must be given a written copy of the grounds of arrest first arose in 'Pankaj Bansal v Union of India' (2023), where the court held a written copy must be furnished "as a matter of course and without exception".
- **That position** was diluted in 'Ram Kishor Arora v Directorate of Enforcement', which held that 'Pankaj Bansal' would apply only prospectively.
- **The court** in 'Prabir Purkayastha v State (NCT of Delhi)' in 2024 reaffirmed that an arrested person must be provided the grounds of arrest in writing at the earliest.
- **The Supreme** Court finally settled the position in 2025, in 'Mihir Rajesh Shah v State of Maharashtra', holding that grounds of arrest must be communicated in writing "in the language he/she understands", and that non-compliance would render "the arrest and subsequent remand ... illegal".
- **It allowed** grounds to be conveyed orally in exceptional cases, provided a written copy followed within a reasonable time, at least two hours before the accused was produced for remand.

Strict guidelines

The court laid down strict guidelines for re-arresting a person if they were earlier released for not being provided grounds of arrest.

•

In such cases, the bench said, the authorities should provide the accused with written grounds of arrest, seek magistrate's nod, and transfer the probe to a different officer.

• GLOBAL

Evolution of Houthis: Local movement to Red Sea power

Moinuddin Ahmad
New Delhi, September 22

THE RAPID advances made by the Yemeni armed group Houthis along the Red Sea coast and around the Bab el-Mandeb Strait have left Saudi Arabia's oil exports and shipping exposed in the critical sea lane. This comes after Iran's effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz since the war in West Asia broke out in February.

Origins as localised group

Ansar Allah's journey began in the 1990s as a Zaidi Shia religious and cultural revivalist movement against the alleged neglect the community faced at the hands of the Sunni rulers, who came to power in 1962 after a revolt against the Zaidi Imamate that ruled Yemen for over a thousand years. The Zaidi Shias, who felt marginalised amid the rapid expansion of Saudi-funded Sunni proselytisation, looked up to their leaders, including Hussein Badreddin al-Houthi, who established a group called al-Shabab al-Mu'min (The Believing Youth) in 1992 aimed at preserving cultural identity.

By the early 2000s, the movement began political activism against certain policies of Yemeni President Ali Abdullah Saleh and the 2003 US invasion of Iraq. The group criticised Saleh's government for its alignment with the US and Saudi Arabia. Tensions grew into an armed insurgency in 2004 when Yemeni security forces attempted to arrest Hussein al-Houthi. His death in a battle later that year militarised and consolidated the movement under his family's leadership, launching six successive wars against the Saudi-backed government between 2004 and 2010.

Prasanta Kumar Pradhan, research fellow and coordinator, West Asia Centre, at the Manohar Parrikar Institute for Defence Studies and Analyses (MP-IDSA), told *The Indian Express*: "During the six Saada Wars (2004-2010), the central Yemeni government struggled to suppress the insurgency. Saudi Arabia directly entered the conflict in late 2009 after Houthi fighters crossed into the border region of Jizan. The Saudi military relied on heavy airpower and artillery but faced operational challenges in the rugged mountainous terrain, previewing the tactical difficulties that would characterise future campaigns."

Parallel state

Over a decade of territorial control, the Houthis transitioned from an insurgent militia into a governing authority that manages a highly lucrative war economy. Through systematic restructuring of the state, the group, which included institutions and the private sector, established a comprehensive parallel economy.

Rana Friefer, writing for *Al Majalla*, notes that recent economic assessments indicate that the Houthi administration generates roughly $2.5 billion annually through parallel tax and collection mechanisms. The Houthis are said to have prioritised the energy sector. Through state-run bodies like the Yemen Petroleum Company, the Houthis manage the distribution of fuel, divert shipments to black markets, and manipulate prices. The US Treasury Department has also accused the Houthis of generating more than $2 billion annually through the illicit trade of Iranian oil.

'Axis of Resistance'

While Houthis are generally dubbed as a direct Iranian proxy, some see the relationship through the prism of strategic alignment, technical dependency, and mutual benefit. Tehran provides support that elevates Houthi capabilities. The Houthis give Iran a strategic footprint along the Bab al-Mandeb and the southern flank of Saudi Arabia. This presence provides Tehran with asymmetric leverage over global trade routes.

Domestically, the Houthis exhibit autonomous decision-making. Despite depending on Iranian assistance, the Houthi leadership makes decisions based on domestic needs and political survival.

A regional player

According to Pradhan, the Houthi capture of Mayun Island, along with their seizure of the strategically important port of Mokha along the Red Sea coast, has considerably strengthened their position along these critical maritime corridors.

"Much as Iran has demonstrated that it holds effective power over the Strait of Hormuz and the capacity to disrupt maritime security in its vicinity, the Houthis are now projecting themselves as the dominant force in the Bab el-Mandeb and the Red Sea... the growing instability in the Red Sea and the Bab el-Mandeb poses an increasingly complex security challenge for the Yemeni government, Saudi Arabia and for the wider regional order," he said.

The Houthis' participation in regional security dynamics complicates diplomatic engagement between the US and Iran. A major diplomatic hurdle is the disconnect between Iranian influence and true Houthi independence. Although Washington blames Tehran for supplying the Houthis with weapons, the group acts with substantial operational freedom — meaning Iranian pledges to reduce tensions do not guarantee Houthi restraint.

FULL VERSION ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

The Houthi worldview

- The group's worldview is articulated in its controversial slogan, the Sarkha: 'God is great, death to America, death to Israel, a curse upon the Jews, victory to Islam'.
- Its modern ideology borrows heavily from global anti-imperialist rhetoric and Iran's 1979 Islamic Revolution.
- The Houthis view themselves not merely as a local political faction but as a sovereign vanguard fighting against Western hegemony and monarchies in the neighbourhood.

• HISTORY

Secular, religious, non-religious: How Constituent Assembly debated UCC

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, September 22

ARTICLE 44 of the Constitution, part of the Directive Principles of State Policy, says: "The State shall endeavour to secure for the citizens a uniform civil code throughout the territory of India." Directive Principles guide the State but are not enforceable by courts. The Constituent Assembly placed the UCC there after a long and spirited debate on November 23, 1948, when it took up what was then draft Article 35.

Against the UCC

STATE 'TYRANNY': Mohammad Ismail Khan, the United Provinces Member from the Muslim League, argued it was unnecessary "to compel people to give up their personal law" with the objective to "secure harmony through uniformity".

B Pocker, Madras Member from the Muslim League, said "a guarantee" of the liberty to follow personal laws was available even during the British rule. "...and let it not be taken that I am only voicing forth the feelings of the Mussalmans. In saying this, I am voicing forth the feelings of ever so many sections in this country who feel that it would be really tyrannous to interfere with the religious practices, and with the religious laws, by which they are governed now," he said.

ARTICLE 19: Naziruddin Ahmad, Member from West Bengal representing the Muslim League, argued that interfering with personal laws clashed with Article 19 of the Draft Constitution, which provided for freedom of conscience and the right freely to profess, practise and propagate religion.

Aspects of the British Civil Procedure Code, Ahmad said, had already "interfered with our personal laws and very rightly so", but during the 175 years of British rule, they "did not interfere with certain fundamental personal laws." What the British in 175 years, he said, "failed to do or was afraid to do, what the Muslims in the course of 500 years refrained from doing, we should not give power to the State to do all at once".

B R Ambedkar, chairman of the Drafting Committee. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

SECULARISM: Mahboob Ali Baig, who represented Madras, said his view was that the words "Civil Code" do not cover the "strictly personal law of a citizen" and as far as the Muslim community was concerned, their laws of succession, inheritance, marriage and divorce "are completely dependent upon their religion."

Syed Hussain Imam, Member from Bihar, said a secular State does not mean that "it is anti-religious... not irreligious but non-religious and as such there is a world of difference between irreligious and non-religious." "...we should first await the coming of that event when the whole of India has got educated, when mass illiteracy has been removed, when people have advanced, when their economic conditions are better, when each man is able to stand on his own legs... Then, you can have uniform laws," he said.

For the UCC

'TYRANNY OF MAJORITY': KM Munshi, a Congress Member from Bombay, questioned the argument that the enactment of a Civil Code would be tyrannical towards minorities. He said nowhere in advanced Muslim countries had the personal law of each minority been recognised "as so sacrosanct as to prevent the enactment of a Civil Code." "When you want to consolidate a community, you have to take into consideration the benefit which may accrue to the whole community and not to the customs of a part of it. It is not therefore correct to say that such an act is tyranny of the majority."

ARTICLE 19: Munshi sought to clarify in regard to Article 19 that the House had already accepted the principle that if a religious practice covers a secular activity or falls within the field of social reform or social welfare, it would be open to Parliament to make laws about it without infringing this Fundamental Right of a minority.

SECULARISM: Munshi said the main question was whether the members of the Constituent Assembly were going to "consolidate and unify our personal law in such a way that the way of life of the whole country may in course of time be unified and secular." "We want to divorce religion from personal law, from what may be called social relations or from the rights of parties as regards inheritance or succession. What have these things got to do with religion I really fail to understand..." Munshi said.

WOMEN'S UPLIFTMENT: Munshi also sought to underline that a common code for the entire country was required to uplift the status of women in independent India.

Ambedkar on UCC

Responding to Hussain Imam, B R Ambedkar said India already had a uniform code of laws covering "almost every aspect of human relationship" in the form of a uniform and complete Criminal Code. The only province the Civil Law had "not been able to invade so far", he noted, was Marriage and Succession. "It is this little corner which we have not been able to invade so far and it is the intention of those who desire to have Article 35 as part of the Constitution to bring about that change..." he said.

There were, to Ambedkar, other possibilities, in which a future Parliament "may feel the ground" by making adherence to a common civil code "purely voluntary".

FULL VERSION ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Kalyan Singh Super Specialty Cancer Institute

C.G. City, Sultanpur Road, Lucknow-226002
(An Autonomous Institute of the Govt. of Uttar Pradesh)
Website: http://cancerinstitute.edu.in Email Id: procurementservices.ksssci@gmail.com

CAMC of HV AC including Ductable Split AC and VRF AC and One Time replacement of PVC fills of cooling towers at KSSSCI

It is hereby informed that **bid No. GEM/2026/B/8063922 Dated 21.09.2026** has been uploaded on GeM Portal under Customized AMC/CMC for Pre-owned Products- CAMC of HV AC including Ductable Split AC and VRF AC and One Time Replacement of PVC fills of Cooling Towers at KSSSCI.

All Interested service providers/bidders are required to submit their bids on GeM Portal in accordance with the terms and conditions of the GeM bid documents. The Director reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids at any stage without assigning any reason thereof.

Note:

1. **EMD Submitted through Account Payee, FDR, Banker's Cheque, Bank Guarantee will be accepted Physically and held valid for this Bid. However, UTR No. and a scanned copy must be uploaded with this GeM bid.**
2. **Site visit is mandatory.**

The Tender documents are available on the website of the Institute **www.cancerinstitute.edu.in**

Adv. No: KSSSCI/Tender-16/2026-27 DIRECTOR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

The Divisional Track, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work.

Invitation of tender through E- Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

1.	Name of work with its location	Supplying of machine crushed hard stone track ballast-34335 Cum confirming to RDSO's Railway specification (IS/RDSO-GE/0001: 2023) February 2023 and latest correction slip as directed from identified source from Ramkumarpura mining area, located at Village Ramkumarpura, Tehsil Khetri, District Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan, including leading to loading point and loading the same into BOBYN type Railways wagons from NIZAMPUR/MAONDA Railway Stations (in NWR Region). The rate is inclusive of all cost, contractor labour, tools plants and machinery complete including all lead, lift, taxes, royalty charges and duties including making approach road and other arrangements for stacking ballast at site as required for complete job as directed by Engineer in charge. (NIT-11-26-27-WC)
2.	Approx. cost of work	(1) Rs. 3,11,33,947.95/-
3.	Earnest Money	(1) Rs. 6,22,700/-
4.	Date and Starting time for filling e-tender & Tender opening time	Starting time for filling e-tender is Date- **28.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.** & Tender opening time is Date- **13.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs.**
5.	Website particulars, published e-tender notice location etc. Complete details of tender can be seen and website where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No.: 128-W/Sr.DEN-C/NIT-11-26-27/WC Dated: 21.09.2026 3285/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

इंडियन बैंक Indian Bank ALLAHABAD

ZONAL OFFICE : RECOVERY DEPT.
2nd Floor, Mumbai Samachar Marg, Fort, Mumbai-400 023. **Phone No.:** (022) 2218 7401, 22187104, **Fax No. :** (022) 2218 8550

APPENDIX- IV-A" [See proviso to rule 8 (6)]

SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002

NOTICE is hereby given to the **Public in General** and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the Below Described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Secured Creditor, the **SYMBOLIC** (whichever is applicable) possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of **Indian Bank, CBD BELAPUR Branch,** Secured Creditor, will be sold on **"As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is"** on **28.10.2026** for recovery of **Rs. 4,53,65,894/- (Rs. Four Crore Fifty Three Lakh Sixty Five Thousand Eight Hundred and Ninety Four Only)** as on **17.09.2026** due to the Indian Bank, **CBD BELAPUR Branch**, Secured Creditor, from **1. M/s. BRIDGEVIEW SHIPS AND PORTS PRIVATE LIMITED** (Borrower) ▪ **Regd. Office :** Office No. B-904, The Great Eastern Summit, 9th Floor, Plot No. 66, Sector No. 15, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai-400 614 (address); **2. MR. VIVEK ANAND,** (Guarantor), ▪ **Address** : No. 21/202, Seawoods Estates, NRI complex, Palm Beach Road, Nerul, Navi Mumbai-400 615. **3. MS. NEETU RASHMI** (Guarantor), ▪ **Address :** No. 21/202, Seawoods Estates, NRI complex, Palm Beach Road, Nerul, Navi Mumbai-400 615. **4. MR. ARVIND KUMAR AGARWAL** (Guarantor / Mortgagor), ▪ **Address :** T-13, Parvana Vihar Sahyog CGHS, Plot No. 52, Sec. 9, Rohini Rajapur Kalan, New Delhi-110 085; **5. MS. SEEMA AGARWAL** (Guarantor / Mortgagor), ▪ **Address :** T-13, Parvana Vihar Sahyog CGHS, Plot No. 52, Sec-9, Rohini Rajapur Kalan, New Delhi-110 085. **6. M/s. Bridgeview Maritime Pvt. Ltd.** (Guarantor), ▪ **Regd. Office :** Office No. B-904, The Great Eastern Summit, 9th Floor, Plot No. 66, Sector No. 15, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai-400 614.

The specific details of the property intended to be brought to sale through e-auction mode are enumerated below:

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY / IES

FOR PROPERTY NO. 1 : Unit No. 105, First Floor, Plot No. H-6, Aggarwal Tower, Netaji Subash Palace, District Central Wazirpur, New Delhi, **Admeasuring** 24.75 Sq. Mtrs.

FOR PROPERTY NO. 2 : Flat Bearing No. Sun 0301, Tower Sun 8, 3rd Floor, **Total super area approximately** 129.97 Sq. Mtr., Migsun Twiinz, Plot No. GH-01B (1), situated at Sector-ETA-II, Greater Noida, District Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh.

ENCUMBRANCES ON PROPERTY	NIL
RESERVE PRICE	**For Property No. 1 :** Rs. 84,78,750.00 **For Property No. 2 :** Rs. 1,10,25,700.00
EMD AMOUNT	**For Property No. 1 :** Rs. 8,48,000.00 **For Property No. 2 :** Rs. 11,00,000.00
BID INCREMENTAL AMOUNT	Rs. 50,000/-
DATE AND TIME OF E-AUCTION	28.10.2026 / 10.00 a. m. to 05.00 p. m.
PROPERTY ID NO.	**For Property No. 1 :** IDIBBVIEW **For Property No. 2 :** IDIBBVIEW1

Bidders are advised to visit the website **(https://baanknet.com)** of our e auction service provider **PSB Alliance Pvt. Ltd.** to participate in online bid. For Technical Assistance Please call **PSB Alliance Pvt. Ltd. Helpdesk No. 8291220220**, **email ID: - support.baanknet@psballiance.com** and other help line numbers available in service providers help desk. For Registration status with PSB Alliance Pvt. Ltd. & EMD status, please contact **support.baanknet@psballiance.com.** For property details and photograph of the property and auction terms and conditions please **visit: https://baanknet.com** and for clarifications related to this portal, please contact Helpdesk No.8291220220.

Bidders are advised to use Property ID Number mentioned above while searching for the property in the website with **https://baanknet.com.**

Date : 17.09.2026 Sd/-
Place : Mumbai, Maharashtra Authorized Officer, **Indian Bank,**
Contact Person: 1. Authorised Officer : A. Yogeswaran (Mob. No. 9894987330)

कार्यालय सक्षम प्राधिकारी भूमि अवाप्ति एवं उपखण्ड अधिकारी, महवा जिला दौसा (राज०)

क्रमांकः भूमि अवाप्ति/921/2026/102 दिनांकः 11.09.2026

-: सार्वजनिक सूचना :-

खातेदार/हितधारक व्यक्तियों के लिए

सभी सूचित होवे कि राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग संख्या 921 पर तहसील महवा क्षेत्र में Upgradation to 4 lanes with paved shoulders from design km 0.850 to km 50.246 of Mahwa-Mandawar-Rajgarh section of NH-921 and construction of flyover from design km 0.000 to 1.700 of NH-21 (near junction with NH-921) in the state of Rajasthan के कार्य में आ रही भूमि बाके 7 ग्रामों (रसीदपुर, राजगढ अकबरपुर रामगढ भापुर धन्तुरी एवं ठेकडा) की अवाप्ति किये जाने के बाद धारा-3 जी के तहत नियमानुसार मुआवजा निर्धारण कर अंतिम अवार्ड दिनांक 11.09.2026 को अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता द्वारा जारी कर दिया है। उक्त भूमि अवाप्ति के बारे में निम्न प्रकार समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशन करवाया जा चुका है:-

धारा	दिनांक	अखबार
3ए	24.12.2025	जयपुर महानगर टाईम्स हिंदी
	24.12.2025	दी इंडियन एक्सप्रेस
3डी	18/07/2026	दैनिक भास्कर
	18/07/2026	दी इंडियन एक्सप्रेस

इस सार्वजनिक नोटिस के द्वारा सभी खातेदार / हितधारको का ध्यान आकर्षित करने के मुख्य उद्देश्य निम्न प्रकार हैः-

- मुआवजा निर्धारण के अंतिम अवार्ड की घोषणा की जानकारी।
- मुआवजा निर्धारण के अंतिम अवार्ड की घोषणा के 60 दिवस के अन्तर्गत सभी हितधारक व्यक्तियों को अपना मुआवजा प्राप्त करने हेतु सूचना।
- सभी हितधारक व्यक्तियों को अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता को भूमि का कब्जा-सुपुर्दगी हेतु अनुरोध।
- अवाप्तशुदा भूमि के रहन होने पर संबंधित बैंक द्वारा मुआवजा हेतु दावा प्रस्तुतीकरण।

अतः सभी खातेदार/हितधारकों को सूचित किया जाता है कि आप उक्त निर्धारित 60 दिवस की अवधि से पूर्व अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता के कार्यालय पर राजकीय अवकाश के अलावा किसी भी कार्यदिवस में कार्यालय समय प्रातः 9.30 से सायं 6.00 बजे तक उपस्थित होकर अपना मुआवजा निम्न दस्तावेजों को जमा करवाकर प्राप्त कर सकते हैं:-

1. खातेदार / हितधारक की जमाबंदी की सत्यापित / ई-साइन्ड प्रति।
2. खातेदार / हितधारक के पट्टा/स्वामित्व दस्तावेज की सत्यापित प्रति।
3. खातेदार / हितधारक के निर्माण के संबंध में स्वामित्व / एन.ओ.सी की सत्यापित प्रति।
4. खातेदार / हितधारक बैंक खाते की पासबुक की प्रति।
5. खातेदार/हितधारक का पैन कार्ड व आधार कार्ड की प्रति।
6. खातेदार/हितधारक द्वारा 50 रुपये के स्टाम्प पर शपथ-पत्र ।
7. भूमि के रहन होने की स्थिति में संबंधित बैंक का नो-डयूज प्रमाण-पत्र या जिस बैंक/शाखा में भूमि रहन है उसी बैंक/शाखा में बैंक खाते की पासबुक की प्रति।

उक्त निर्धारित 60 दिवस की अवधि से पूर्व अपना मुआवजा प्राप्त करना सुनिश्चित करें। दिनांक 11.09.2026 के पश्चात उक्त मुआवजे पर कोई ब्याज देय नही होगा। दिनांक 11.09.2026 के पश्चात मुआवजा प्राप्त करने की जिम्मेदारी आपके स्तर पर लंबित मानी जावेगी।

इसी प्रकार सभी खातेदार / हितधारक धारक को को दिनांक 11.09.2026 से तुरन्त प्रभाव से अवाप्त शुदा भूमि से अपना कब्जा अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता या सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग के कार्मिकों को सुपुर्द करने हेतु सूचित किया जाता है। इसमें असफल रहने पर राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग अधिनियम 1956 की धारा-3ई की उपधारा-2 के अधीन पुलिस बल की सहायता ली जाकर सुपुर्दगी अमल में लाई जावेगी।

(प्रेमराज मीना RAS)
सक्षम प्राधिकारी भूमि अवाप्ति
एवं उपखण्ड अधिकारी महवा (दौसा)

DIPR/C/16180/2026

SOUTH COAST RAILWAY

VISAKHAPATNAM
Follow us on @SCoRailwayindia
website: www.scor.indianrailways.gov.in

PUB/SCoR-318

Tender No. : ETCECIIVSKP2026006.

CAO/Con/SCoR/VSKP acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders against Tender No. ETCECIIVSKP2026006 **Closing Date/Time 12-10-2026 15:00 Hours.** Bidders will be able to submit their original / revised bids upto closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.

Name of work : Construction of R.O.B in Lieu of LC.No.485 - Balance left over works on Railway portion - Superstructure of span No.1 as 1x 25.00 m C/c PSC 'I' Girder with deck slab, Span 2 Composite girder with Steel 'I' girders with deck slab completed + Span 3 to 5 as 3 x 31.00 m C/C PSC 'I' girder with deck slab, Construction of one left over pier with bed block and Construction of Approaches (R&B Portion) - 6 x 30.0 m PSC Girders on Chowdavaram side, 6 x 30.0 m PSC Girders on Visakhapatnam side with RE wall on both sides and other miscellaneous works in lieu of LC No.485 (Laxmi Devi peta gate) at Km.745/16-18 between Bayyavaram and Anakapalli stations at Anakapalli yard.

Advertised Value : Rs. 52,77,15,002.98. **Cost of tender document :** Rs. 0.00. **Earnest Money to be Deposited :** Rs. 1,05,54,300.00. **Completion period of the work :** 12 Months. **Tender Closing Date & Time :** 12-10-2026 15:00 hours.

Complete information including e-tender documents of the above e-tender is available in website **http://www.ireps.gov.in.** Any corrigenda will be issued online only.

The tenderers should read all instruction carefully and ensure compliance of all instructions.

Chief Administrative Officer, SCoR-A363 (Con), Visakhapatnam.

For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, please visit the website https://www.ireps.gov.in or www.scor.indianrailways.gov.in

verka

Har Din Da, Har Dil Da www.verka.coop

THE PUNJAB STATE COOPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS FEDERATION LTD.
SCO 153-155, SECTOR 34-A CHANDIGARH - 160022 EPABX NO. 0172-5041812, 66

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tenders are hereby Invited for the purchase and supply of following items :-

Sr.No.	Name of Work/Item	Period/Tentative Qty
1.	For Verka Head Office, Chandigarh **Annual Rate Contract for :-**	
	1. Procurement of Import HF & Jersey Conventional and Sexed Semen Doses (USA & Canada/ Europe).	i. Conventional Semen 70,000 Doses ii. Sexed Semen-30,000 Doses
	2. Procurement of Conventional and Sexed Semen Doses exclusively from HF & Jersey Bulls imported into India.	i. Conventional Semen- 90,000 Doses ii. Sexed Semen- 10,000 Doses
	3. Procurement of Conventional Semen Doses of HF, Jersey, Sahiwal and Buffalo (Murrah & Nili Ravi) along with Sexed Buffalo Semen from DAHD'A' Graded Semen Station.	i. HF, Jersey Conventional Semen- 2,00,000 Doses ii. Sahiwal Conventional Semen 20,000 Doses iii. Buffalo Conventional Semen (Murrah & Nili Ravi)-2,00,000 Doses iv. Buffalo Sexed Semen (Murrah & Nili Ravi)-5,000 Doses

NOTE : 1. For complete details regarding above tender (NIT), please visit our website i.e. **www.verka.coop** & e-Tendering portal i.e. **eproc.punjab.gov.in.** 2. Corrigendum, if any, will be uploaded on website only. **General Manager (Purchase)**

KARNATAKA STATE NATURAL DISASTER MONITORING CENTRE (KSNDMC)

(A Regd. Society of Govt. of Karnataka)
Major Sandeep Unnikrishnan Road, Near Attur Layout, Yelahanka, Bengaluru - 560 064. Ph.: 080-67355000

No. KSNDMC/ADM/7/2025-ADM Date: 22.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTIFICATION

KSNDMC invites tenders for the following through e-procurement portal on **"https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in."** Tender is invited for **1)** Providing Manpower Services for Data Centre Support and IT Technical Services at KSNDMC vide tender No. KSNDMC/2025-26/SE0027, pre bid meeting is on **29.09.2026 at 11:00 AM** at KSNDMC, last date and time for submission is **5:00 PM of 09.10.2026**

2) Supply, Installation, commissioning and Comprehensive Maintenance of analogue addressable fire alarm system. Tender No. KSNDMC/2025-26/IND0006. Last date for submission of bid is **05:00 PM of 03.10.2026.** Further the tender document details can be obtained through e-procurement portal of GoK.

DIPR/DD-C.P/2882/KSMCA/2026-27 **Sd/- Director**

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION GANDHI NAGAR JAMMU

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Short e-NIT No. DGN/77 of 2026-27 **Dated 21-09-2026**

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised cost (Rs. In lakh.)	Cost of Tender document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1.	Providing and laying Interlocking Tile works surrounding Atal Memorial Park upto H.No. 613 Sector-3, Channi Himmat (Under Capex Budget 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	40.00	600	80000 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	02 Months	(1200 Hrs) on or after 01-10-2026	"A" & "B" Class
2.	Construction of Lane in Sector-5 Ext. Trikuta Nagar Jammu (Shiv Colony) near Transit Camp 1341 from the H. No. 12 Sh. Ravi Sharma upto Culvert near Grand Hotel (Under Capex Budget 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	40.00	600	80000 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	02 Months	(1200 Hrs) on or after 01-10-2026	"A" & "B" Class

Position of AAA :- Accorded by Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B) Circle South Jammu vide order No. 105 of 2026 dated 07-09-2026 amounting to Rs. 40.00 Lacs for item No. 1 and 2 respectively.

Position of TS :- Sanctioned by this office vide order No. 84/PWD Div. Gandhi Nagar/2026-27 dated 19-09-2026 amounting to Rs. 40.00 Lacs for item No. 1 and No. 83/PWD Div. Gandhi Nagar/2026-27 dated 19-09-2026 amounting to Rs. 40.00 Lacs for item No. 2.

Project Authority :- Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B) Circle South Jammu for item No. 1 and Superintending Engineer PWD (R&B) Circle South Jammu for item No. 2.

Major Head of Account :- Under Capex Budget 2026-27 for item No. 1 & 2.

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website **http://jktenders.gov.in** as per below schedule :

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	21-09-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 21-09-2026 to 30-09-2026, 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	25-09-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
4	Bid submission Start Date	21-09-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	30-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	01-10-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

Sd/-
(Er. Karanjeet Singh)
Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division

DIP/J-11007/26 – DATE 22 SEP 2026

Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D Bijnor

Letter No. 2633 /E-Tender/26-27 **Dated: 16-09-2026**

(Very Short Term E-Tender)

1. The Executive Engineer Provincial Division, U.P. P.W.D. Bijnor on behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh invites the percentage rate bids online from the eligible and approved Contractors registered in Road Works with UP PWD, class A,B,C,D The Bidder may submit bids for any or all of the works. Bidders are advised to note the minimum qualification criteria specified in Clause 4 of the Instructions to Bidders to qualify for the award of the contract.
2.

SL No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. In Lakhs)	Bid Security (Rs. In Lakhs)	Cost of Bid Document	Time of Comp-letion	Address of Executive Engineer of the Executing the work	Address of Superin-tendin g Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on SH/MDR ODR in block Moh Pur Devmal in Distt Bijnor (AE-1)	20.00	2.00	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
2	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on Village Roads in block Moh Pur Devmal in Distt Bijnor (AE-1)	20.00	2.00	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
3	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on Village Roads in block Allehpur (Dhampur) in Distt Bijnor (AE-1)	25.00	2.50	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
4	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on SH/MDR ODR in block Aanku (Nehtaur) in Distt Bijnor (AE-2)	25.00	2.50	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
5	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on Village Roads in block Aanku (Nehtaur) in Distt Bijnor (AE-2)	25.00	2.50	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
6	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on Village Roads in block Noorpur in Distt Bijnor (AE-2)	25.00	2.50	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
7	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on SH/MDR ODR in block Jaleelpur in Distt Bijnor (AE-3)	25.00	2.50	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
8	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on Village Roads in block Jaleelpur in Distt Bijnor (AE-3)	25.00	2.50	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
9	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on SH/MDR ODR in block Allehpur (Dhampur) in Distt Bijnor (AE-3)	11.00	1.10	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
10	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on Village Roads in block Allehpur (Dhampur) in Distt Bijnor (AE-3)	11.00	1.10	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
11	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on Village Roads in block Aanku (Nehtaur) in Distt Bijnor (AE-3)	25.00	2.50	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad
12	Bijnor	Pot Holes Repair, Patch Repair and Patrie Repair on Village Roads in block Moh Pur Devmal in Distt Bijnor (AE-3)	20.00	2.00	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	03 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Moradabad

➢ The Rate adopted in the BOQ include all Other taxes but excluding GST.
➢ Tender cost should be deposited online through Net Banking as per Column No. 5 & 6 in the table.

Bids must be downloaded online from 10:00 AM on date 28.09.2026 to 12:00 PM on dated 03.10.2026 and the technical bids will be opened online on date 03.10.2026 at 12:30 PM in Office of Executive Engineer Provincial Division PWD Bijnor and Financial bids of the qualified bidders will be opened on date & time as notified. According to the provisions of Government Order no. 1/2018/3070/78-2-2018/42 IT/2017 (22) Date 03-01-2018 after opening of the technical and financial bids, the qualified bidder has to submit original documents personally in department/ office. In the event of non submission of original documents by the bidder, the appropriate action will be taken in accordance with the provisions of G.O.
All terms & conditions can be seen on website http:/etender.up.nic.in

UPID--256650 Dt. 21/09/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

Executive Engineer
Provincial Division, PWD, Bijnor
Ph. 01342-262776
Email-pdbijnor@gmail.com

HIMACHAL PRADESH
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer HP.PWD., Division Nadaun District Hamirpur H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the Percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class for the works as detailed below on the table below:-

Sr. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.)	Starting Date for downloding Bid	EMD (Rs.)	Deadline for Submission of Bid
1	C/O 30 m span bridge on link road Jiana Sukarla road at RD 2/420 including approach roads.Time Limit: Nine Month Cost of tender form: 7000/-	4,87, 60,000/-	30-09-2026 from 10:30 AM	9,75,200/-	08-10-2026 upto 04:30 PM

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website.

HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK

Executive Engineer,
Nadaun Division,
HPPWD, Nadaun. Pin Code 177033
Telephone No. 01972-298570
e-mail: ee-pwdndn-hp@hp.gov.in
On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pardesh

No. 3578/2026-2027/HP

OFFICE OF THE INSPECTOR GENERAL OF POLICE

Police Computer Wing, Karnataka State Police, Gate-1, 7th Floor, M.S. Building, Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Veedhi, Bengaluru-560001. Phone: 080-.22353871, email: igppcw@ksp.gov.in

No.20/STS/IGP/PCW/2026-27 **Dated : 22.09.2026**

TENDER NOTIFICATION

The Inspector General of Police, Police Computer Wing, Karnataka State Police, Bengaluru invited the following tenders through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal **(www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in)** for supply, installation and Maintenance of various items as detailed below.

Sl. No.	Description	Tender No. and Date	Approx. Tender value in Rs Lakhs	Last Date for tender submission
1	Procurement of Mail Server Application	KSP/2026-27/ IND0646	88.00	05.10.2026 17.30 HRS
2	Procurement of Video Conferencing Equipment's, Desktop Computers & LED Display (TV)	KSP/2026-27/ IND0655	79.95	12.10.2026 17.00 HRS
3	Supply, installation, testing, commissioning of LAN Cabling & OFC extension along with Network components	KSP/2026-27/ IND0619 CALL-2	140.00	22.10.2026 17.30 HRS

The information on Pre-Bid meeting, Tender Schedule and other details can be obtained at KPP portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** for more information, please contact the above office.

Sd/-
Inspector General of Police
Police Computer Wing, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/2874/SA/2026-27

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

GORKHA RIFLES

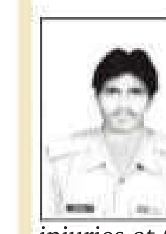
Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 9406005 Late Rfn Gaj Bahadur Limbu of 5/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice on 23 Sep 1965 in OP (J&K).

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 9406929 Late Rfn Nand Kumar Rai of 5/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice on 23 Sep 1965 in OP (J&K).

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 9403322 Late NB/Sub Jai Bahadur Rai of 5/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice on 23 Sep 1965 in OP (J&K).

Colonel 11 GR & Sikkim Scouts and All Ranks

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



CONSTABLE BISWAMBAR PRADHAN 137 BN BSF 05.07.1970 – 23.09.1991

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Biswambar Pradhan on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Ferozepur area (Punjab) and later succumbed to his injuries at Civil hospital, Ferozepur (Punjab).

CONSTABLE /DRIVER RAM MEHAR 55 BN BSF 01.01.1970 –23.09.2006

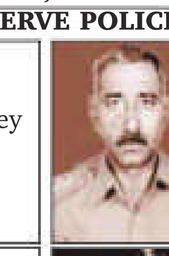
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable/Driver Ram Mehar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in Sopore area (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CONSTABLE GHAR SINGH 119 BN BSF 22.07.1982 – 23.09.2016

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Ghar Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice while on operational duty in area of FDL KB, Baramulla (J&K).

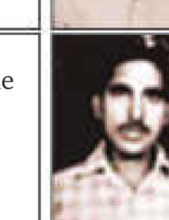
CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Inspector B.R. Rankhambey 93 Bn 1-6-1945 To 23-9-2001

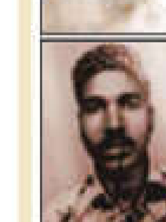


Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Tejpal Singh 93 Bn 1-1-1948 To 23-9-200

Veer Balidani Head Constable Shakti Chand 93 Bn 2-8-1959 To 23-9-2001



Veer Balidani Head Constable Awadh Kishore 93 Bn 3-1-1964 To 23-9-2001



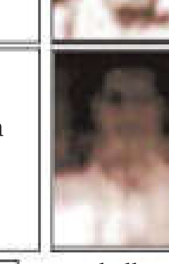
Veer Balidani Head Constable Subodh Chandra Murmu 93 Bn 10-2-1958 To 23-9-2001

Veer Balidani Constable Balwinder Singh 93 Bn 21-11-1971 To 23-9-2001

Veer Balidani Constable D.K. Nair 93 Bn 29-11-1959 To 23-9-2001

Veer Balidani Lance Naik S.K. Laikuddin 93 Bn 27-4-1972 To 23-9-2001

Veer Balidani Constable Darshan Singh 93 Bn 14-8-1969 To 23-9-2001



Veer Balidani Constable Asha Kumar Sharma 93 Bn 1-1-1968 To 23-9-2001

Veer Balidani Constable Basvaraj Haliyappa 93 Bn 1-2-1968 To 23-9-2001

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to 11 valiant troopers of 93 Bn, who combated gallantly with Maoists despite being grievously injured in an IED blast in Hazaribagh district, Jharkhand and made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

CENTRAL INDUSTRIAL SECURITY FORCE

HC/GD DIBAKAR NAYAK PGCIL WAGOORA 23rd SEPT, 2013

CISF proudly remembers the supreme sacrifice of this brave-hearts. On this day, he laid down his life at the altar of duty while fighting with the terrorists at PGCIL Wagoora, Srinagar. His courage and bravery would remain an abiding source of inspiration for the force. The force will remain eternally indebted to him for his noble deed.

S. E. RAILWAY - E-TENDER

Tender Notice No. PCMM/GENL/TP/2026/36 **Dated: 21/09/2026**

TENDER FOR "E" PROCUREMENT SYSTEM

The Principal Chief Materials Manager, South Eastern Railway, Hd. Qrs. Office (5th Floor), New administrative Building, 11, Garden Reach Road, Kolkata-700043 for and on behalf of the President of India invites open E-tenders which have been uploaded on website **www.ireps.gov.in** as follows. All the tenders will be Closed at 14.00 hrs.

SL No.	Tender No	Closing Date	Brief Description	Qty.	EMD (in Rs.)
1.	60265293	06/10/26	WIDER PRESTRESSED CONCRETE SLEEPER FOR SHARP CURVES OF RADIUS LESS THAN 350 m FOR 25T AXLE LOAD FOR 60 kg (UIC)/60E1/52 kg RAILS etc.	18000 Nos.	1660970/-
2.	65255020A	21/10/26	Supply, Installation, Commissioning & Proving out of airless Centrifugal Shot Blasting and Peening Plant for coil Springs (Turnkey basis).	02 Nos.	137360/-
3.	75261718	27/10/26	Densified thermal bonded Polyester Block, Size: 1981 mm x 660 mm x 30 mm etc.	8800 Nos.	145800/-
4.	79261779A	20/10/26	Fire Retardant Curtain Fabric for all AC Coaches etc.	25678 Mtr.	238570/-
5.	GEM/2026/ B/8014381	03/10/26	3 x 300 Sq. mm. 6.35/11 KV Grade (Earthed System), HT, Three Core Power Cable with improved fire performance category C2.	2500 Mtr.	108000/-
6.	75261718	27/10/26	Densified thermal bonded Polyester Block, Size: 1981 mm x 660 mm x 30 mm etc.	8800 Nos.	145800/-
7.	75263049A	07/10/26	Flexible Poly Vinyl Chloride (PVC) Flooring Sheet in rolls etc.	902 Nos.	837700/-
8.	30263111A	07/10/26	Spherolastic Silent Block for CBC, etc.	200 Nos.	139240/-
9.	77265001	08/10/26	Supply and application of Antigraffiti clear coating for exterior Side Wall of coaches.	950 Set	533600/-
10.	5626RGC_SL BPAC_RT	26/10/26	Running Contract / Price Agreement for Supply, Transportation, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of Block Proving by Digital Axle Counter etc.	14 Set.	342130/-
11.	HB266839A	15/10/26	Supply, installation testing and commissioning of C-ARM Fluroscope with motorized mechanical motion etc. (Pre-Bid Conference Date & Time 28/09/26 at 15:30 hrs).	01 No.	316220/-
12.	75261721	08/10/26	Densified Thermal Bonded Polyester Blocks for seat and berths of SCN Coaches with Density of 60 kg/cu.mtr. etc.	117 Nos.	240660/-
13.	GEM/2026/ B/8035522	12/10/26	Manpower Outsourcing Services - Fixed Remuneration - Healthcare; Staff Nurses etc.	01 Year	881112/-
14.	90261940	16/10/26	M.S. Flat steel 40 x 6 mm. in length of 3 mtrs. and above etc.	157 MT.	188020/-
15.	38263980	07/10/26	Flap Door Chainless Cotter Rivet.	170000 Nos.	105130/-
16.	38263185	12/10/26	Locking Bolt & its Bracket for Flap door Arrangement etc.	102000 Nos.	167310/-
17.	38263223	12/10/26	Non-Asbestos 'K' Type Composition Brake Block for Freight, Stock (840 mm wheel diameter).	12000 Nos.	179520/-
18.	8263951A	14/10/26	Door Check Spring for BOXN Wagon etc.	28545 Nos.	194690/
19.	36263346	26/10/26	Automatic Pressure Modification (APM) Device for KNORR BREMSE Design BMBS.	547 Nos.	161730/-
20.	GEM/2026/ B/8049849	12/10/26	Custom Bid for Services - Outsourcing of daily indoor activities Housekeeping Service Mechanized dry and wet cleaning etc.	02 Years.	1818858/-
21.	29264590A	07/10/26	Fire detection unit mother board typeE537-AD2L.	91 Nos.	138600/-
22.	25263609	08/10/26	Silicone Rubber Compound Sealant etc.	24131 Kg.	188670/-
23.	GSD-KGPUNLOADLOAD26-28D	22/10/26	Loading-Unloading and Stacking Of Railway material for 02 Years at 09 Depot in General Stores Depot/KGP under Dy.CMM/GSD/KGP.	24000 MT.	114100/-
24.	65265035	27/10/26	TANDEM CNC UNDER FLOOR WHEEL LATHE (Pre-Bid Conference Date/Time - On 06-10-26 at 12:00 in PCMM Meeting Room/SER/GRC).	01 No.	2000000/-

Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full Details/ Description/ Specification of the tenders and submit their Bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **N.B:** Prospective Bidders may regularly visit www.ireps.gov.in to participate in all other tenders & any Corrigendum published thereafter. **(PR -795)**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunil S/o Rewati Prasad R/o O-241, O-Block, Gali No.5, Sunder Nagri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 5179/2020 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Bharat Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Sunil** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sunil** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sunil** of **FIR No. 5179/2020 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Bharat Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **06.11.2026.**

By Order,
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Addl. Chief Judicial Magistrate
North-West, Room No. 101
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12732/NW/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Deepak S/o Veerpal Singh R/o Jaggo Devi Bua Ka Makan, Gali No. 3, Noorani Masjid, Sriram Colony, Kacchi Khajoori, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 398/2020, U/s 379/411 IPC, PS Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Deepak** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Deepak** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Deepak** of case **FIR No. 398/2020, U/s 379/411 IPC, PS Kashmere Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **07.12.2026.**

By Order
Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
Central, Room No. 138
Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi

DP/13432/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Deepak Kumar S/o Sh. Rajender Kumar R/o H. No. 371, Gali No. 1, Tahirpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR No. 222/2018 U/s 279/337 IPC & 3/181 & 146/196 M.V. ACT PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Deepak Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Deepak Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Deepak Kumar** accused of **FIR No. 222/2018 U/s 279/337 IPC & 3/181 & 146/196 M.V. ACT PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.12.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
JMFC-11, Room No. 138, First Floor
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/13423/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Manjeet Kaur S/o Makhan Singh R/o H.No. B-3, Chander Vihar, Nilothi Extension, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 488/2017, U/s 323/341/506/34 IPC, PS Hari Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Manjeet Kaur** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Manjeet Kaur** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Manjeet Kaur** of case **FIR No. 488/2017, U/s 323/341/506/34 IPC, PS Hari Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **24.10.2026**.

By Order
Moksha Bains
JMFC-11 West, Room No. 31
Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi

DP/13289/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunil, S/o: Badam Singh, R/o: B-77, Deep Vihar, Pansali, Begumpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 475/2022, U/s: 323/341 IPC, Police Station Begumpur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sunil** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunil** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sunil** of **Police Station Begumpur, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
ACJM, North West, Room No. 101,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13230/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Janki Lal Pal @ Mam, S/o Daya Ram Pal, R/o P-4, South Anarkali, Jagatpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 517/2015, U/s 324 IPC, P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Janki Lal Pal @ Mam** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Janki Lal Pal @ Mam** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Janki Lal Pal @ Mam** accused of **FIR No. 517/2015, U/s 324 IPC, P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.10.2026.**

By Order - Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Shahdara District, Room No. 07
Karkarduma Courts, Delhi

DP/13415/SHD/2026

WEST BENGAL STATE ELECTRICITY DISTRIBUTION COMPANY LIMITED

(A Govt. of West Bengal Enterprise)
Regd. Office : Vidyut Bhavan, Block-DJ, Sector-II, Bidhannagar, Kolkata - 700 091
CIN : U40109WB2007SGC113473, www.wbsedcl.in

WBSEDCL

Pre-Tender Conference

WBSEDCL is contemplating to procure '**12KV & 42KV Polymer Lightning Arrester**'. The Technical Specifications of the items are available on **www.wbsedcl.in**. Proposals are hereby invited from the interested manufacturers to put forward their suggestions addressed to the **Chief Engineer, Procurement & Contracts Dept., WBSEDCL**, Vidyut Bhavan, Biddhannagar, Kolkata-700091 (e-mail: procurementdept@wbsedcl.in) by **29.09.2026** positively and to send their technical representative(s) at the **PRE-TENDER CONFERENCE** to be held on **30.09.2026** (**11:30 hrs.**) at the Conference Room of P&C Dept., WBSEDCL, 4th Floor, 'D' Block, Vidyut Bhavan, Biddhannagar, Kolkata-700091.

For details, visit **www.wbsedcl.in** ICA/N 254(3)/2026

SBI

IT Quality Assurance Centre of Excellence Dept., State Bank of India, Global IT-Centre, Sec-11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai-400 614
E-mail: dgmit.qacoe@sbi.co.in; Website: https://sbi.bank.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

RFP NO. SBI/GITC/IT-Quality Assurance CoE/2026-27/1492
DATED: 18.09.2026

Bids are invited by State Bank of India from the eligible bidders for Procurement of IT manpower for software application testing services. Bidders, who are interested to submit bids, visit Procurement news at **https://sbi.bank.in** and e-Procurement agency portal **https://etender.sbi/SBI/**.

Commencement of download of RFP: 23.09.2026 From 10:00 Hrs

Last date and time for Bid submission: 13.10.2026 up to 17:00 Hrs

IT Quality Assurance Centre of Excellence Dept.

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LTD.

(REGD. OFFICE: PSEB HEAD OFFICE, THE MALL, Patiala)
Corporate Identification Number: U40109PB2010SGC033813
(Contact No 96461-07129)

PSPCL

Tender Inquiry No. 06/TLC/BTI/2026-27 Dated: 22/09/2026

Dy CE/TL Circle, PSPCL Officer's House No. B-14, Thermal Colony, Bathinda invites E-tender for Replacement/augmentation of existing 66kV Line from Sardulgarh to 66kV Sangha from 14KM/0 15sq"/SC on SC/Tower to 0.2sq"/SC on DC/towers. (TWL no. 54/WZ/2025-26 Annex-B). For detailed NIT & Tender specifications please refer to **https://eproc punjab.gov.in** from 23/09/2026 from 9.00 AM onwards.

Note:- Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in

No. 15468/PB C-906/26

PUBLIC NOTICE

Directorate of Town and Country Planning, Haryana
Government of Haryana

It is hereby brought to the notice of the general public that the Department of Town and Country Planning, Haryana, had granted licence No. 10 of 2008 dated 25.01.2008 to M/s Snowtemp Engineering Company Ltd., 14 Mile Stone, Delhi-Mathura Road, under the provisions of the Haryana Development and Regulation of Urban Areas Act, 1975, for development of an IT Park over land measuring 13.287 acres situated in Sector-27B, Faridabad. The said licence was valid up to 24.10.2010.

As per the terms and conditions of the licence and the LC-IV Agreement executed by the licencee company with the Director, Town and Country Planning, Haryana, the licencee was required to deposit/pay various prescribed fees and charges to the Department in stipulated instalments and comply with other terms and conditions of the licence and the LC-IV Agreement.

However, the licencee failed to comply with the prescribed terms and conditions of the licence and the LC-IV Agreement. Accordingly, after affording ample opportunities of hearing to the licencee company, the Director General, Town and Country Planning, Haryana, vide order dated 04.06.2013, cancelled the aforesaid Licence No. 10 of 2008 on account of non-compliance with the conditions of the licence and the LC-IV Agreement.

Accordingly, the general public, including any person having any claim, right, interest, objection or relevant fact in respect of the aforesaid licensed project, is hereby given an opportunity to submit the same, along with supporting documents, if any, to the O/o Senior Town Planner, Faridabad, Room No. 303, 2nd Floor, HSVP Complex, Sector-12, Faridabad, Haryana-121007 the undersigned within 15 days from the date of publication/issuance of this Public Notice.

sd/-
Senior Town Planner,
Faridabad

No.49560/HRY

Office of the Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr

No- 8757 /96M(iv)-BSR Circle/2026-27 **Dated- 01.09.2026**

E-Procurement Inviting Tenders

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending EngineerBulandshahr Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate bid online through http://etender.up.nic.infrom the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Setu work Category as applied from Date 25.09.2026 to 01.10.2026 upto 12:00 Noon as per the prescribed T-2 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 01.10.2026 at 12:30P.M. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakh)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender document fee including GST (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	जनपद गौतमबुद्धनगर में उटरावली से दूबली सम्पर्क मार्ग के किमी0-2 में स्थित बरसाती नाले पर लघु सेतु का निर्माण कार्य।	76.00	5.80	12 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18 % G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	Executive Enginner Provincial Division, P.W.D., Gautambudh nagar	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahar Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahar	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A,B Setu Work
2	जनपद गौतमबुद्धनगर के अन्तर्गत खुर्जा-जेवर मार्ग के किमी0-21 में सेतु का पुनः निर्माण का कार्य ।	381.00	21.05	12 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18 % G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	Executive Enginner Provincial Division, P.W.D., Gautambudh nagar	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahar Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahar	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A Setu Work

1. Time allowed for completion of Whole work is mention in col. No. 5 with including rainy season.
2. The Tender Document fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.
3. All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost of work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender. Details of e-tender uploaded on **http://etender.up.nic.inshall** also be uploaded on UP PWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
4. Terms & other conditions related to bid are available on **http://etender.up.nic.in**
5. During execution of work contractor should ensure the all safety Measures for COVID-19issued by the Uttar Pradesh government.
6. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/**.
7. For the SI No 2 work, it is mandatory to have experience certificate of pile foundation/well Foundation.

(Kanchan Singh)
Executive Engineer
P.D., PWD,
Bulandshahr

UPID-256670 Dt. 21/09/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(Maneesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahar Circle, PWD,
Bulandshahar

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HPGCL	REPLACEMENT OF THE UPS SYSTEM OF CONTROL ROOM UNIT-7 AND 8, PTPS, PANIPAT WITH NEW-ONE.	18.09.2026 28.09.2026	1,52,28,000/-	www.hpgcl.org.in & https://etenders. hry.nic.in	01802566015 xenmtcplg1@ gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49535/HRY

SETU

GSPL Transmission Limited

TENDER NOTICE

Inviting Tenders for Construction of 400 Aanganwadi Centres across the State of Gujarat by using Light Gauge Steel Framing (LGSF) Technology

Online tenders are invited by SETU for Design, Supply, Construct, Erection and Commissioning of Modular Structure through Light Gauge Steel Framing (LGSF) Technology for Anganwadi Centres (Nandghar) at various locations in the State of Gujarat.

The detailed schedule of Notice Inviting Tender is available at **www.gujarat-energy.com** / **https://gspltrans.com** and Tender document will be available on **www.tender.nprocure.com** from **23/09/2026.**

Queries for the Tender document can be addressed at: **setu@gujenergy.com**

Last date of submission of bids (Online): **07/10/2026, 18:00 Hrs.**

Socio Economical Transformation and Upliftment Society (SETU)
GEL Bhavan, Sector-11, Gandhinagar-382010, Gujarat, India.
Tel.: +91-79-66701005

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.

OBRA-SONEBHADRA

E-Tender Notice

1. **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8040200,** The work of breakdown maintenance of Coal Crushers of CHP, A/BTPS, Obra, Tender Cost: Rs. 0.00, EMD- Rs. 72,000.00, Amount:- Rs. 36,06,419.00, Last Date of Uploading Bid : 30.09.2026.
2. **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8044028,** Round the clock BMD Shift and Pyrite hopper Operation of 5x200MW, BTPS, Obra, Tender Cost: Rs. 0.00, EMD- Rs. 50,000.00, Amount:- Rs. 37,97,299.00 (with GST), Last Date of Uploading Bid: 12.10.2026

For Information regarding Addendum/Corrigendum/Rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit Website **https://etender.up.nic.in**

सं. 97/जल०सं०का०/निविदा/ **Dated: 22.09.2026**

"Save Electricity for Nation"

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER DOCUMENT FOR CONSULTANCY SERVICES: SPACE UTILIZATION AND ASSET IDENTIFICATION AT JAT, SVDK & SINA STATIONS

Tender Notice No.	NR/JAT/NFR/CONSULT/Commercial Space/2026/01
Name of Work	Tender for Engagement of Consultancy Services for providing professional consultancy services for preparing Concept plans, Master plan, survey report and detailed project report etc. for optimum commercial utilization of space for JAT, SVDK and SINA station in Jammu Division of Northern Railway.
Estimated Cost	₹ 9,80,000/- (including GST)
Cost of Tender Document	Nil
Earnest Money Deposit	₹ 19,600/- (2% of Estimated Cost)
Completion Period	90 Days
Validity of Offer	45 Days from date of opening
Date and Time of Closing	12.10.2026 and 15:00 hrs.
Tender Authority	Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, Jammu Tawi, B Building, Second Entry, Railway Station, Jammu Tawi-180012. Email id: srdcmjat@gmail.com
Website for submission of offer	**www.ireps.gov.in**

3298/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System.

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
14265009	SUPPLY AND DECANTING OF HYDROGEN GAS	120000 KG	14.10.2026
19264426	CYLINDRICAL ROLLER BEARING NUP-326 WITH C4	338 NOS	19.10.2026
09262387	DISTRIBUTOR VALVE TYPE DOUBLE STAGE	564 NOS	19.10.2026
07261047	AXLE BOX HOUSING FINISH MACHINED	650 NOS	21.10.2026
15265070A	SUPPLY, FITMENT AND COMMISSIONING	1 SET	22.10.2026
15265111	DESKTOP BASED SIMULATOR FOR 3 PHASE ELECTRIC LOCOMOTIVES	25 NOS	22.10.2026
04260105A	API - CI4 PLUS GRADE OF LUBRICANT OIL	78330 LTR	22.10.2026

NOTE:- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual Offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice NO. 44 /2026-2027 Date: 22.09.2026 3291/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd.,

VS, VIJAYAWADA - 520004
(A Govt. of A.P. Undertaking)

APGENCO

NIT/Tender ID: 989780

Name of the work: "Manual unloading of coal from wagons at Road No.4.4A.24 & Ext. Road No. 23 with proclainers from the date of commencement of work to 31.03.2027 (or) till the completion of quantities whichever is later" through e-procurement. Schedule available Date & Time : **21.09.2026** -18.00 Hrs onwards, Bid submission Closing Date & Time: **30.09.2026** - 13.00 Hrs.

For other details visit the website: **www.apgenco.gov.in** or **https://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in**

R.No.- 5451PP/Dt: 22.09.2026

जन सूचना

जन साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि फरीदाबाद में आयुषमान आरोग्य मंदिर बडखल, भांखरी, अनखीर, बडोली, जसाना व फरीदपुर के लिए भवन किराए पर लिया जाना है। भवन मे शौचालय सहित 02 कमरे बने हो। जो भी व्यक्ति अपना भवन किराए पर देना चाहता है वह सिविल सर्जन, फरीदाबाद के कार्यालय मे 16 दिनो के अन्दर इस बारे मे अपना सहमति पत्र, भवन के ब्योरे सहित जमा करवाएं ताकि कमेटी द्वारा भवन का निरीक्षण करके किराया तय किया जा सके।

सिविल सर्जन,
फरीदाबाद

No.49520/HRY

Municipal Corporation, Faridabad

B.K. Chowk N.I.T Faridabad -121001, Haryana-India
Tel.: 0129-2411649, 2411664, 2415549
Fax: 0129-2416465

MCF FARIDABAD

TENDER NOTICE

REGARDING ILLEGAL CONVERSION OF LAND, UNAUTHORIZED USE OF BUILDING & UNAUTHORIZED CONSTRUCTION RAISED IN CONTRAVENTION TO HARYANA MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ACT, 1994 & HARYANA BUILDING CODE-2017 AMENDED FROM TIME TO TIME.

Whereas no land/plot/building/premises situated within the limits of Municipal Corporation, Faridabad, shall except with the prior permission of the Competent Authority, be used for purpose other than those for which it was used on date of publication of the notification of Controlled Area/MC Limit & no person shall erect or re-erect or commence to erect any building on his land without obtaining prior permission/approval from Competent Authority under the applicable provisions of Haryana Municipal Corporation Act, 1994 and Haryana Building Code-2017 amended from time to time.

Whereas no person/plot owner/ applicant shall occupy or allow any other person to occupy any building or part of a building or any portion whatsoever, until such building or part thereof has been certified by the Competent Authority as having been completed in accordance with the permission granted and an 'Occupation Certificate' has been issued after submission of valid NOCs and the documents as specified in Haryana Building Code-2017 amended from time to time.

Whereas this Corporation has been carried out survey of the unauthorized buildings constructed without obtaining the requisite CLU/Conversion Permission, approval of building plans, NOCs issued by Fire Department, Haryana State Pollution Control Board etc. in non-confirming and confirming land use area on regular intervals and it has been noticed by this Corporation that number of the plot/land/building owners have neither obtained conversion/CLU permission nor obtained any approval of building plans & occupation certificate from the Competent Authority and the requisite NOCs issued by concerned Departments as required for use of building/premises, therefore, this Corporation is regularly taking action against such violators indulging in unauthorized use/construction/occupation over the land/plot/buildings/premises situated within the limits of this Corporation.

Whereas this Corporation has further observed that the Insurance Companies and Public Listed Companies/Financial Institutions without ascertaining the above referred approvals, have sanctioned loan/insurance/leased in favour of such unauthorized buildings/premises or part thereof, therefore, the Insurance Companies/Public Listed Companies/Financial Institutions are hereby advised to ensure that prior to release of any loan or insurance or lease or any financial assistance to such illegal buildings/premises or part thereof and further shall ensure that the plot/land owners have possessed all valid approvals and valid NOCs issued by Competent Authority. If they have approved/sanctioned any fund/loan or insurance or any financial assistance to plot/land/building owners of such premises/against such illegal buildings than the Insurance Companies/Public Listed Companies/Financial Institutions shall be fully responsible/liable for the Govt./MCF/Competent Authority shall not be liable for any loss or damage, if so, incurred to the insurance companies/Public Listed Companies/Financial Institutions on this account thereof whatsoever. Furthermore, if any loss occurred to MCF, suitable action as deemed fit shall be taken against them, same,

Whereas this Corporation has further noticed that the plot owners of plots/land/premises through their Architect have obtained approval of building plans under self-certification through Online Building Plan Approval System for their illegally sub-divided plots/illegally converted commercial land and furthermore have raised construction in contravention with the applicable Building Bye Laws without leaving any statutory setbacks, without making parking provision within the premises, without having valid NOCs, put to use the building/premises without obtaining any approval from Competent Authority therefore through this Public Notice all such plot owners as well as the Architect who are indulged in such activities are hereby directed to revoke such building plans and bring the construction inconformity with applicable land use/building bye laws, to obtain the requisite NOCs failing which this Corporation shall definitely initiate stringent action against the violators following due course in law. The cost of enforcement occurred towards removal of such violations shall also be recovered from the violators by land arrears and the delinquent Architect should be blacklisted. Non-compliance shall also invite legal panel action against the violators/offenders.

Sd/-
Commissioner
Municipal Corporation Faridabad

NO. 49518/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	UHBVN	APPOINTMENT OF A CALL CENTRE AGENCY TO PROVIDE A AI-BASED VOICE BOT SOLUTION & CENTRALIZED CUSTOMER SERVICE CALL CENTRE (CSCC) TO UHBVN CUSTOMERS IN PANCHKULA, AND BIJLI SUVIDHA KENDRA IN EACH OF ITS 10 CIRCLE LOCATIONS.	CLOSING DATE 09.10.2026	(RUPEES TEN LAKH ONLY)	www.uhbvn.org.in NIT No.- 57/SE/Projects/CSCC/2026	9115115800 seprojects@ uhbvn.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49533/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HPGCL	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PROVIDING SECURITY SERVICES FOR RESIDENTIAL COMPLEX, ADMINISTRATIVE BUILDING, SERVICE BUILDING, PLANT MAIN GATE PARKING AND ASH DYKE OF 2X300 MW DCRTPP, HPGCL, YAMUNA NAGAR FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS.	CLOSING DATE 30.09.2026	302.93 LACS (EXCLUSING GST)	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8222024035 xencmd2.dcrtpp@ hpgcl.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49568/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	UHBVN	EMPANELMENT OF ELECTRICAL CONTRACTORS FOR ELECTRICAL WORKS UPTO 11 KV UNDER THE JURISDICTION OF 10 OPERATION CIRCLES OF UHBVN.	CLOSING DATE 19.10.2026	RS. 0.50 LAKH	www.uhbvn.org.in (EOI NO. 497/EMP/P&D/2026-27)	01722570431 cepdc@uhbvn.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49567/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HPGCL	SUPPLY AND INSTALLATION OF GUILLOTINE GATES FOR PA FAN DISCHARGE DUCT OF UNIT-1 AND 2, RGTPP, KHEDAR, HISAR	18.09.2026 06.10.2026	1,11,46,580/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8222023837 xenbmd2.rgtpp@ hpgcl.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49552/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA POLICE HOUSING CORPORATION, PANCHKULA	COMPREHENSIVE MAINTENANCE OF STP IN POLICE LINES, MOGINAND, PANCHKULA + 56 WORKS	21.09.2026 28.09.2026	61,02,36,193/-	hups://etenders.hry.nic.in &www.hphc.org.in	9463200487 dbpanchkula@ yahoo.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49551/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	GMDA GURUGRAM	UPGRADATION OF MASTER ROAD DIVIDING SECTOR 114 OUTER (ASSET ID 145), GURUGRAM AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO.	19.09.2026 05.10.2026	8,80,19,312/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8595330024 xen1.gmda@ gmda.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49538/HRY

Site of India's maiden gold

MEDAL TALLY

POS	COUNTRY	G	S	B
1	China	32	13	8
2	Japan	11	16	19
3	S Korea	6	4	17
4	Kazakhstan	6	1	5
5	Thailand	4	1	1
8	India	1	4	2

DAY 4 CAPSULE

Haul: 1 Gold

CRICKET TITLE

- The women's cricket team successfully defended its title, thrashing Sri Lanka by a record 147-run margin. It was the Indian contingent's first gold at this edition.

BADMINTON

- The women's team, spearheaded by PV Sindhu, went down 1-3 against Japan in the quarterfinals to crash out of medal contention.
- The men's team, on the other hand, blanked Japan 3-0 to enter the semifinals and guarantee themselves a podium finish.

WUSHU

- Hangzhou Asian Games silver medallist Roshibina Devi Naorem entered the semifinals of the women's 60kg category, confirming another medal for India.

TODAY'S PICKS

DAY 5

Badminton: Men's team semifinal (11:30 AM)

- Medal assured, the Indian men take on China for a place in the final.

Shooting: 10m Air Pistol Women Team Final (6:15 AM)

- Esha Singh, Suruchi Phogat and two-time Olympic medallist Manu Bhaker will compete in hopes of getting India's first shooting gold in Asiad 2026.

Table Tennis: Mixed doubles Round of 32 (6:30 AM and 7:10 AM)

- Harmeet Desai will partner Yashaswini Ghorpade as they take on Maldives. Manush Shah and Diya Chitale will play Sri Lanka later in the day.

Weightlifting: Women's 49kg Final (11 AM) Women's 53kg Final (1:30 PM)

- The nation's most prolific weightlifter Mirabai Chanu will take the stage hoping to add a first Asian Games medal to her portfolio. Later, 2026 CWG medallist Gyaneshwari Yadav will take part in her first Asiad.

Boxing: Men's 80kg Round of 32 (8:30 AM onwards)

- 2026 CWG gold medallist Ankush Panghal will start his campaign with a bout against Bahrain's Hamsa Vogel.

Between bench and baseball cage: Cricket makes a sprightly splash in an anachronistic venue—green, open and tranquil

(Top) The baseball cage and player bench at Korogi Athletic Park; the toilet at the venue. EXPRESS

EXPRESS AT ASIAN GAMES

Mihir Vasavda
Nisshin, September 22

THERE IS a toilet, a bench and a baseball cage, the only permanent structures. And then there is the cricket pitch — the latest addition. Korogi Athletic Park is almost too open, too green, too tranquil to be an international sporting venue. Even Harmanpreet Kaur, the India captain, knew this was a nation hardly associated with cricket. "But knowing Japan, we knew they would manage something," she said.

They had managed something that looked quite a lot like a quaint English county ground.

On Tuesday afternoon, in this unlikely setting in the middle of a public park in Nisshin, on the outskirts of Nagoya, India won the first gold medal of its Asian Games campaign. They beat Sri Lanka by 147 runs, so comprehensively that the suspense had disappeared long before the celebrations.

When the celebrations came, Radha Yadav and Renuka Thakur started sprinting towards the middle with the Indian flag. Then they slowed to a walk, as if they realised there was no need to hurry. The final was so one-sided that even the celebration seemed to have time to spare. But the people watching did not seem to mind.

A Sri Lankan family had driven for a couple of hours from Nara to be here. There were Indians from England, on holiday in Seoul, who had made their way to Nisshin to watch India play.

And then there were the Japanese. For many, this was their first cricket match. "I have come to watch because my daughter has married a Sri Lankan man," said one spectator. An elderly couple, Naofumi and Chisato, had seen children practise baseball hits and came for cricket out of curiosity. "We know nothing about it," Naofumi said.

Beginner's guide

They had been handed a beginner's guide in Japanese explaining the rules and were repeatedly looking down at them, then back at the field, trying to make sense of what had just happened. A wicket, a boundary, a change of bowler — moments that require no explanation to a cricket audience were being learnt in real time.

Mimi Hirayama, the public announcer, was helping them along. "Mainly rules, because the Japanese audience is not familiar with this sport," Hirayama said. "But they are very familiar with baseball. So I'll keep giving them my hints to understand what's going on." So a six became a home run. "And when the batter hits four, it's like a three-base hit or something like that," Hirayama said.

It was an ingenious way of introducing cricket to an audience that already understood another bat-and-ball sport.

Hirayama could make the comparisons because she had spent many years in England and was familiar with cricket. Before the Games, she also watched matches involving India and other countries to learn more about the sport.

For a few hours, then, Korogi contained several different versions of cricket fandom at once: Indians celebrating, Sri Lankans supporting their team, an overseas diaspora making an unexpected detour, and Japanese spectators discovering the game through baseball.

It was an unusual scene for a ground that, until recently, was not a cricket ground at all.

Korogi is a public ground that has facilities for baseball, tennis and football, which is where the teams trained, too. When cricket was added to the Asian Games programme at the last minute, Indian Olympic Association president PT Usha said she helped finalise this ground as the venue. And so, the baseball ground was converted for the Games between September last year and March 2026. The 305 million yen (approximately Rs 18 crore) project involved relaying 14,984 square metres of grass, installing practice nets and building an equipment store. It hosted six matches of the ICC Men's T20 World Cup East Asia-Pacific Qualifier in May as its first major test.

Now it has hosted an Asian Games final — and India's first gold of these Games.

Harmanpreet said the only adjustment the team had to make was playing on the hybrid pitches. "But we knew how the pitch would behave because recently in England, we played on hybrid pitches too. The other facilities weren't of top level but they managed it pretty well, she added.

Once the flags come down, Nisshin mayor Hiroki Kondo said the cricket will continue. "This is the second ground in Japan after Sano. After the Asian Games we will continue playing cricket here along with baseball," Kondo said.

How often?

"About 18 days."

A month?

"No. This is Japan — 18 days a year."

It might not be much, but Hirayama hopes it will be just enough to keep the link with the sport alive. "I hope many people here in Japan, who have found this sport exciting and think they will enjoy it enough to play," Hirayama said. "So I hope this ground will also be used for cricket in the future."

Soon, Jasprit Bumrah and India's men will walk out onto the same strip. And, somewhere between the baseball cage and the toilet, cricket has found a place to stay.

Destructive Smriti-Shafali pair powers title defence

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 22

ASK WHO has worn the crown of best opening pair, and the answers scatter in every direction. "Best", after all, is a subjective term, and cricket's own architecture — split neatly by formats — allows myriad choices. In T20Is, though, there is little room for debate. At the summit, stands Smriti Mandhana and Shafali Verma. Their 99-run opening stand set the template for India's 147-run demolition of Sri Lanka, and with it, the nation's first gold medal at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games.

Sri Lanka, in their last couple of T20Is against India, have had to face the wrath of the opening pair that has scored the most runs in this format. A 162-run partnership in December last year, and more recently, a 129-run stand in the final of the Women's Asia Cup.

If they were to have any real stake in proceedings at Korogi Sports Park on Tuesday, they needed to be third time lucky. They were not.

Consecutive sixes off left-arm spinner Sugandika Kumari in the third over — a match-up that made precious little sense from Chamari Athapaththu's end of the equation — announced Mandhana's intent in the simplest of terms.

Chamari went with pace in the next over, entrusting Mithali Ayodha with the task of breaking the partnership, but the teenager did not have any answers against the leading run-scorer of women's T20Is.

There was, in essence, a reversal of roles from the meeting in Dubai nine days prior. While Shafali had lit the fuse in the Asia Cup final, Mandhana sparked the onslaught on Tuesday — the pair's telepathic ability to seamlessly trade roles in the aggressor-anchor set-up being among the many reasons responsible for their dominance.

With her opening bowlers offering little resistance, Chamari eventually took the ball herself in the fifth over, standing directly in the firing line. Minutes later, she would regret her action, for the over yielded fire aplenty. Three sixes — two off Shafali's bat, and the other off Mandhana's.

The powerplay produced 67 runs — only two shy of what Sri Lanka would eventually muster — while the ease of fielding restrictions did not necessarily translate to an ease of carnage by the Indian openers. Mandhana recorded her 37th T20I half-century in the final — yet another exhibit in her growing case file as a player for the big occasions.

Notably, was her fifth fifty in an eleventh T20I final appearance, and also the third consecutive, having recorded half-centuries in the previous two Asia Cup finals. Her average and strike rate in finals — 39.1 and 136.23 — sit comfortably above her respective career figures of 31 and 127.47.

In that same over, however, Chamundi Praboda denied what would have been the seventh triple-figure T20I partnership by the pair, and the 22nd T20I half-century for Shafali. In an attempt to reverse sweep the left-arm spinner, Shafali holed out to backward point.

Captain Harmanpreet Kaur's stay was brief, in which she scored a 17-ball 19. Richa Ghosh, however, conjured the kind of knock that first announced her as indispensable to this side. The wicketkeeper-batter scored 49 runs off 22 deliveries, 40 of those coming from boundaries, in what was the first instance of her scoring north of 40 since December 2024.

The score India had accumulated — 216/3 — happens to be their highest-ever away from home. The next hour or so was, hence, academic. As if she had not inflicted enough damage on the Lankans with the bat, Shafali starred with the ball as well, dismissing Imesha Dulani and Hasini Perera inside the powerplay.

Moments later, Deepti Sharma accounted for the one Lankan batter capable of mounting any real resistance — Chamari Athapaththu. What unfolded thereafter could be described by various metaphors, perhaps the most suitable being crumbling like a house of cards — seven wickets in a span of 26 runs. A gold medal aside, it also marked India's biggest victory in terms of runs in women's T20Is.

At the heart of it sat a pair now alone at the summit of the format. Shafali Verma and Smriti Mandhana have amassed 4,080 T20I runs together as an opening partnership. To contextualise their supremacy — not one pair has been able to breach even 3000. Neither among women, nor among men.

BRIEF SCORES: India 216/3 in 20 overs (Smriti Mandhana 79, Shafali Verma 48; Chamudi Praboda 1/34) beat Sri Lanka 69 all out in 15.4 overs (Chamari Athapaththu 29; Deepti Sharma 3/6) by 147 runs.

Smriti Mandhana (above) and Shafali Verma put together a 99-run partnership to set up India's massive win in the final. AP

The score India had accumulated — 216/3 — happens to be their highest-ever away from home. The next hour or so was academic.

IN WOMEN'S T20IS

4080
Most runs by an opening pair

6
Joint-most 100+ runs stands for the first wicket

32
Most 50+ runs stands for the first wicket

8.34 rpo
Highest scoring rate among opening pairs with a minimum of 1,000 partnership runs

349
Most runs by an opening pair in T20I finals

ONE-OFF T20I

Warning or wake-up call? India sweat to beat Japan

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, September 22

IN THE press conference on Monday, India captain Shreyas Iyer had spoken about the unknowns surrounding their first-ever meeting with Japan in Sano on Tuesday.

The match was part of celebrations marking 75 years of diplomatic relations between India and Japan, but once the players stepped onto the field, friendship was put aside.

And it was those unknowns that nearly came back to hurt India. On a pitch offering plenty of turn, Japan pushed them all the way and threatened a massive upset before Axar Patel held his nerve in the final over to pull off a two-run win in a five-over contest.

Japan needed eight runs from the final over after reaching 25/3 in their chase of 33. Axar came back for a second over with little room for error.

He began with a dot ball before Benjamin Ito-Davis and Alexander Shirai-Patmore took singles. There was then some confusion over wides down the leg side, with Iyer and wicketkeeper Sanju Samson questioning the calls. One decision was eventually reversed after the umpires had a discussion.

Japan were left needing four from the final ball. Shirai-Patmore could only manage a leg bye, allowing India to escape after being pushed far closer than they would have expected.

Shreyas Iyer (R) and Axar Patel celebrate a Japan wicket. CREIMAS

Defending only 32, India turned entirely to spin on a surface where the ball was gripping and turning appreciably. Axar gave India the start they needed. He conceded only two runs in the first over, which also included Lachlan Yamamoto-Lake being run out after challenging Ishan Kishan's arm from the deep. Kishan hit the stumps directly to leave Japan 2/1.

Washington Sundar then struck in the second over. Ibrahim Takahashi slog-swept him for four but tried to repeat the shot off the next ball and found Ravi Bishnoi at deep square leg.

Japan, though, refused to go away. Captain Kendel Kadowaki-Fleming took on Bishnoi in the third over, scooping him for four as the hosts collected 10 runs. At 18/2 after three overs, Japan needed 15 from the final 12 balls to pull off a huge upset.

Benjamin Ito-Davis and Kadowaki-Fleming kept the chase alive against Sundar. Japan collected seven from the fourth over, though Sundar dismissed Kadowaki-Fleming for 12 off the final ball. That left Axar with eight runs to defend, and the left-arm spinner did just enough.

Spin quicksand

Earlier, Iyer's decision to bat first in the rain-shortened contest did not go to plan as Japan's spinners used the turning pitch well to restrict India to 32/4.

Left-arm spinner Charlie Hara-Hinze set the tone in the opening over. Samson hit the first boundary of the innings, but Hara-Hinze struck with the final ball when Abhishek Sharma was caught for a golden duck.

Ibrahim Takahashi kept the pressure on in the second over. The off-spinner gave away only five runs and dismissed Samson for nine. The right-hander tried to hit him down the ground, but the ball turned and took the inside edge, with Ito-Davis taking the catch at deep mid-wicket.

There was little relief also against Ito-Davis' off-spin. Ishan Kishan tried to create scoring opportunities with reverse sweeps but struggled against the turn. He eventually tried to go inside-out off a flighted delivery, only to mistime it to extra cover and depart for three off six balls.

India were 14/3 after three overs. Their top three had scored only 12 runs, the lowest aggregate by India's top three against an Associate nation in T20Is.

Iyer tried to lift the scoring rate, but Japan continued to keep India quiet. He finally found a boundary against Hara-Hinze in the last over, hitting him over extra cover for four. Two balls later, however, he tried to go inside-out and was caught at deep extra cover for 16 off 12.

Hara-Hinze finished with 2/17, while India's batsmen could score only two boundaries in the five overs, underlining how difficult batting had become on the surface.

For Japan, the performance was notable not only for how close they came, but for the way their spinners controlled an Indian batting line-up packed with experience in difficult conditions throughout the innings.

What had begun as a historic first meeting between the teams had turned into a genuine contest. Japan's spinners first exposed India's difficulties on the turning pitch before their batsmen took the chase to the final ball. India eventually avoided the upset, but only just.

BRIEF SCORES: India 32/4 in 5 overs (Shreyas Iyer 16; Charlie Hara-Hinze 2/17) beat Japan 30/3 in 5 overs (Kendel Kadowaki-Fleming 12; Washington Sundar 2/13) by two runs.

Why wide rule changes when batsman plays a reverse sweep

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, September 22

AS INDIA won by two runs in Sano, the decision by the on-field umpire to overturn a wide decision caused plenty of stir. While India benefited and Japan narrowly missed out on a tie, according to one of the ICC umpires, the decision to overturn the wide call was right. "It shouldn't have been a wide in first place because the batsman had attempted a reverse-sweep. There ends the discussion, " the umpire said.

Final over drama

Japan needed eight runs from the last over. After Axar Patel conceded a single off the second ball, Alexander Shirai-Patmore attempted a reverse sweep to a delivery down the leg side, which was called wide. This was a wrong call as well, but one India didn't contest.

Axar then bowled another delivery down the leg side as Shirai-Patmore again attempted the reverse sweep. It was initially called wide too. Axar and Sanju Samson questioned the decision before captain Shreyas Iyer spoke to square-leg umpire Chris Brown. Brown and the other umpire, Chris Thurgate, then discussed the call before it was reversed and the delivery counted as a dot ball. And speaking to *The Indian Express*, one of the ICC umpires revealed the right call was made.

"As per the laws of the game, be it a switch-hit or reverse-sweep, once you attempt or abort or even end up playing it, both sides become off-side. So the 17-inch mark for wide deliveries will be accounted for. Unless the ball goes past that mark, it will remain a legal delivery," the umpire said.

That meant the ball going down what would normally have been the batsman's leg side was not enough for it to be called wide.

Reverse sweep

According to the umpire, once a batsman attempts a reverse sweep or switch hit, both sides are treated as the off side for deciding a wide. The relevant reference point then becomes the 17-inch mark. Unless the delivery passes outside that mark, it is a legal delivery.

"Whether the batter changes the grip or alters the position doesn't matter. Once he attempts any of these shots, both the sides become off-side," the umpire said.

Does it matter if the batsman does not complete the reverse sweep? No. According to the umpire, the same interpretation applies once the batsman attempts the shot, even if he later aborts it.

In Shirai-Patmore's case, he had already attempted the reverse sweep when Axar's delivery went past him. The umpires therefore had to judge the delivery using the wide line applicable to the reverse sweep.

Decision change

MCC Law 2.12 allows an umpire to change a decision as long as it is done promptly. So the original wide signal did not make the decision final. Axar and Samson questioned the call immediately, after which Iyer spoke to Brown. The two umpires then discussed the delivery and reversed the decision.

Was the final decision to reverse the wide correct? Yes. Since Shirai-Patmore had attempted a reverse sweep, both sides were treated as the off side for judging the wide. The delivery had not passed the relevant 17-inch mark and should therefore have been considered legal.

Japan eventually needed four runs from the final ball but managed only a leg bye, allowing India to win by two runs.

ALWAYS ON DUTY

2 am calls, 120 kg of medicines: How doctors keep Asiad squad fit

The 6-member medical team has to take care of a 700-strong contingent spread across Japan

Mihir Vasavda
Nagoya, September 22

"IT'S LIKE a war zone. You've got multiple fronts at multiple areas, and you have to have real-time monitoring."

This is how Dr Dinshaw Pardiwala, India's chief medical officer (CMO), describes the challenge he and his six-member team — including two more doctors — face when monitoring 700 Indians at the Asian Games, including the athletes and officials.

Pardiwala has his hands full as there is no athletes' village — where everyone is under one roof — at these Asian Games. Instead, India's best are in hotels across Nagoya, the Aichi prefecture and Tokyo.

For the most scattered Asian Games in history, India has taken to Japan 450 kg of recovery and physiotherapy equipment, and 120kg of medicines. "It's a bit of a challenge. It's impossible for three doctors to be evaluating those patients and handing out medicines," says Pardiwala, who has treated some of India's top athletes, including Virat Kohli, Jasprit Bumrah, Mirabai Chanu, PV Sindhu and Vinesh Phogat.

"We've got medicines for a broad range of problems to cover the entire contingent of 700-plus. For aches and pains, for upper respiratory tract infection, for GI (gastro) upsets, we've got stuff for gynecological issues," Pardiwala, whose day starts early and ends after midnight, says.

Dr Dinshaw Pardiwala heads India's medical team at Asiad. EXPRESS

At 9 pm every day, India's CMO joins a virtual meeting with around 45 people — chef de mission and deputies, team leaders from different sports, doctors and physiotherapists.

"All of the events of the day have been discussed. What's going to happen the next day is discussed, what challenges have been faced, and immediate resolution of those challenges also needs to be done," Pardiwala says.

By then, the six-member medical team may already have dealt with 15 or 16 athletes — the average calls per day here during the Asian Games. The night is not necessarily quieter. Pardiwala has had calls at 2am. Doctors are conducting tele-consultations with athletes in different parts of Japan, medicine starter packs have been distributed to teams and physiotherapy equipment is being moved from one location to another.

The initial plan, Pardiwala adds, was to have a central recovery room at the Athletes Plaza, where the Indian Olympic Association's (IOA) organisational spaces are located. But last-minute accommodation requirements meant that space had to be converted into rooms. The recovery room was gone, and the medical team had to be spread out to cater to the needs of different Indian teams.

To help with the recovery of the contingent, there are four folding physiotherapy beds and a fifth portable one that can be moved between teams. Five portable ice baths have been brought to Japan, including single-person baths set up in Tokyo for the swimmers.

Three devices provide cryocompression, combining cold therapy and compression to help with painful joints and muscles. One is kept at the central location, while two are moved to wherever they are required. There are six Normatec air-compression devices for upper and lower-limb recovery, along with therapeutic ultrasound and electrotherapy equipment.

The logistics do not end with getting the equipment into Japan, which itself cost approximately Rs 50 lakh according to an IOA official. It has to be also brought back home for using it at future Games.

Carrying medicines presented a particular challenge. Japanese regulations require them to be kept under lock in one central location. So while the recovery equipment is spread around, India maintains a central medical store at the container accommodations at Garden Pier. The doctors too have to get temporary licences.

Respiratory infections

Pardiwala and his team keep an eye out for symptoms of respiratory infections. Previous 'medical surveillance' at major Games, he says, has shown upper respiratory tract infections to be the most common ailment among athletes, followed by aches and pains and then injuries. "It's surprising. You think that it's going to be injuries and muscle aches. But if you look at every contingent, not just the Indian contingent, the number one illness is upper respiratory tract infection."

The medical team has mapped hospitals across Aichi and Nagoya according to where the athletes are staying and competing. But even that is not as straightforward as knowing the nearest hospital.

"As per the prevailing rules, we cannot go there directly. If we have to go to a hospital, we have to inform the Asian Games Central Medical Committee, then they will get the appointment and tell us where to go," Pardiwala says. "Since we have already identified hospitals, we tell them that we are at this place, and this is where we need to go."

Sen drops the burden of 'sensational' versus Japan in 3-0 win

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, September 22

ON TUESDAY, playing Japanese World No.7 Kodai Naraoka in the quarterfinals of the Asian Games with India needing a good start, Lakshya Sen shrugged off the burden of being 'sensational.' The World No 14, played the most conventional, non-fancy endgame in the last 6-7 points, to wrap up a 11-21, 21-5, 21-19 win that set the tone for India's 3-0 tie win over the hosts. Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty then defeated Takuro Hoki—Yugo Kobayashi 21-18, 24-22 in the first doubles, and Ayush Shetty, ranked 20, reined in his own adventurous streak to beat World No. 16 Koki Watanabe 21-10, 21-19, sending India into the semifinals and a second straight pursuit of team gold after Hangzhou.

But while Satwik-Chirag were dependable, and Ayush (the Japanese call him 'Two Word Shetty' for some reason) had a debonair Asiad debut, the win was shaped by Sen, and his ability to keep things simple.

For far too long, Sen's game has leant on turning flashy and risky when things get difficult. It's as if he believes, he needs to pull rabbits out of the hat constantly, show depths of dazzling sorcery, before he convinces the world he is good — or good enough. Far too often, he would drop the self-belief that even his basic game could suffice, seeking validation for his attack. But playing Kodai, and needing to close out from 13-19 down, Sen dropped the act.

At the World Championships in Delhi playing an American pretender, he had gotten too tight and succumbed to nerves, that his coaches had never seen before. At the Paris Olympics, he got too desperate and faltered.

Lakshya Sen was down 13-19 before the comeback. REUTERS

At Nagoya, the coaches simply told him to show some energy, maybe hop about and lose that stress. And play the game he knows best. The game that covers 10-16, 13-19 leads, using his superior understanding of rallies and underrated ability to outlast.

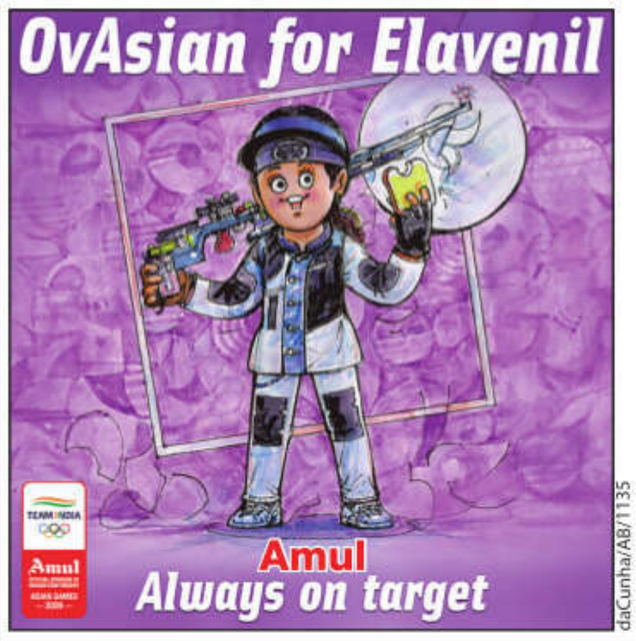
The dazzling dives and backhand blocks and fuzzy flicks are just the trimmings of defense. The zero-errors was the real deal. Sen went on to out-defend the defensive machine that is Kodai to an extent that the Japanese tried playing too cute with a show-off trick shot that backfired. Sen eschewed racquet antics.

Nothing fancy

Both players — Sen last beat Kodai in 2023 — had skimmed past the first two sets, so exhaustion wasn't an issue. What he did in last 6 points though was beautifully simple.

Overdoing nothing, keeping shuttle in play and keeping it down, nothing fancy, nothing special — Sen frustrated Kodai with stubborn-headed defense that saw the Japanese crack.

When the decider fetched up, his 13-19 situation relegating both earlier sets to a distant memory, Sen dipped into grit and the attitude to keep a straight face and wreak havoc. Kodai didn't know what hit him.



DDCA writes to BCCI about corrupt approach

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 22

THE DELHI & District Cricket Association (DDCA) has written to the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) regarding an alleged fixing approach. "We are in touch with the BCCI. We wrote to them the very day we were informed about a corrupt approach," said Ashok Sharma, secretary of the DDCA. Though Sharma didn't specify details, it is learnt that a player was allegedly approached during this year's Delhi Premier League. The player in turn informed the DDCA and the anti-corruption unit.

This comes even as a sting operation conducted by Tehelka showed a former Ranji Trophy player claiming to have insider knowledge of playing XIs in the Delhi Premier League (DPL) and the Indian Premier League (IPL).

In the sting operation, Rachit Bhatia — a Delhi-based cricketer who represented Nagaland in domestic cricket — claimed to have fixed five matches of the 2025 IPL involving the Chennai Super Kings. The player also offered classified information on the Central Delhi Kings franchise of the DPL. In response, the DDCA issued a statement on Tuesday, saying that the allegations are "unverified."

"The Delhi & District Cricket Association (DDCA) has taken note of recent reports concerning alleged irregularities involving certain players and a franchise associated with the Delhi Premier League (DPL). DDCA would like to clarify that the allegations referred to in these reports are unverified and have not been established by any competent authority. The Association believes it would be inappropriate to draw conclusions about any individual, player or franchise based solely on such allegations," the statement read.

Confirming that it had also contacted the relevant authorities, the DDCA statement further read: "Given the seriousness of the matter, DDCA has written to the respective authorities and shared the information that has come to its notice, requesting that the matter be examined through the appropriate established processes."

Vol XCIV, Issue No. 272. Regd.No. DL-21046/03-05 RNI Regn. No. DELENG/2018/76281. Printed and Published by Ramesh Chander Malhotra on behalf of The Indian Express (P) Limited and Printed at The Indian Express (P) Limited Press, A-8, Sector-7, Noida -201301 and Published at The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 &10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110002. Editorial office: The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9&10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Phone: 0120-6651500. Advertising office: The Indian Express (P) Ltd.,Express Building, B1/B, Ramnath Goenka Marg, Sector 10, Noida-201301. Phone:01206651291. Chairman of the Board: Viveck Goenka, Chief Editor: Raj Kamal Jha, Editor: Unni Rajen Shanker, Editor (Delhi):Monojit Majumdar** ** Responsible for selection of News under the PRP Act. Copyright: The Indian Express (P) Limited. All rights reserved. Reproduction in any manner, electronic or otherwise, in whole or in part, without prior written permission is prohibited. The Indian Express®